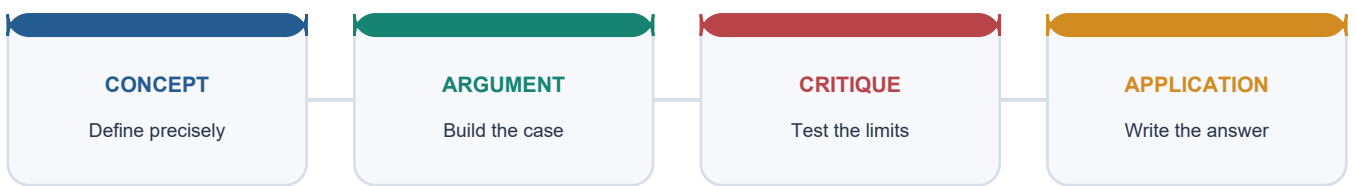


COMPLETE LEARNING SESSION

Jainism - Complete Learning Session

UPSC Philosophy Optional | Paper I, Section B | Complete learning session, practice and register notes

LEARNING PATH



Deterministic fallback visual: move from precise concepts through argument and critique to exam application.

Source order: repository knowledge -> official current linkage -> clearly marked analysis. No fabricated PYQs or statistics.

CONTENTS / SESSION INDEX

Major learning parts and meaningful subtopics are listed in document order. Page numbers are generated from the final PDF layout; PDF bookmarks mirror the same hierarchy.

Jainism - Complete Learning Session	4
What this package contains	4
BASIC LEARNING SESSION	4
CONCEPT SPINE - ENGLISH FIRST, SANSKRIT IMMEDIATELY AFTER	4
HOW TO READ THIS SESSION	5
ONE-SCREEN MAP	5
SESSION 1 - WHAT JAINISM IS: CONQUEROR (jina), FORD-MAKER (tīrthaṅkara) AND THE TEXTUAL ANCHOR	5
SESSION 2 - THEORY OF REALITY I: MANY-SIDEDNESS (anekāntavāda) AND THE REAL AS ORIGIN, DECAY AND PERSISTENCE	9
SESSION 3 - THEORY OF REALITY II: SIX SUBSTANCES, SOUL AND NON-SOUL, AND MATTER	13
SESSION 4 - KNOWLEDGE: THE JAINA INVERSION OF DIRECT AND INDIRECT, AND THE FIVE KINDS OF KNOWING	17
SESSION 5 - STANDPOINT THEORY (nayavāda): THE SEVEN STANDPOINTS	21
SESSION 6 - CONDITIONAL PREDICATION (syādvāda) AND THE SEVENFOLD PREDICATION (saptabhaṅgī)	26
SESSION 7 - EVALUATING NON-ABSOLUTISM: SELF-REFUTATION, THE ABSOLUTISM CHARGE, AND THE PLURALIST-REALIST VERDICT	29
SESSION 8 - BONDAGE: ACTION-MATTER AS SUBTLE MATTER, AND THE MECHANICS OF ADHESION	33
SESSION 9 - LIBERATION: THE THREE JEWELS, THE DISCIPLINE, THE FOURTEEN STAGES AND THE PERFECTED SOUL	39
SESSION 10 - JAINISM AMONG ITS RIVALS: NAMED CRITICISMS, REPLIES AND THE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE	44
BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION	49
32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills	49
PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE	65
Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below	65
OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER	74
1. Is the sevenfold predication a logic, or a discipline of assertion?	74
2. The spatiality of the soul	75
3. Many-sidedness beside Buddhist anti-essentialism	75
4. Controlled Western comparison	75
5. What not to over-study	76
CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES	76

A. System identity	76
B. The real	76
C. Substance, quality, mode; the six substances	76
D. The soul	77
E. Knowledge	77
F. Standpoints	77
G. Conditional predication and the sevenfold predication	77
H. Evaluating non-absolutism	77
I. Bondage	78
J. Liberation sequence	78
K. Ethics and the fourteen stages	78
L. Criticism, comparison and answer discipline	79
COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM	79

Jainism - Complete Learning Session

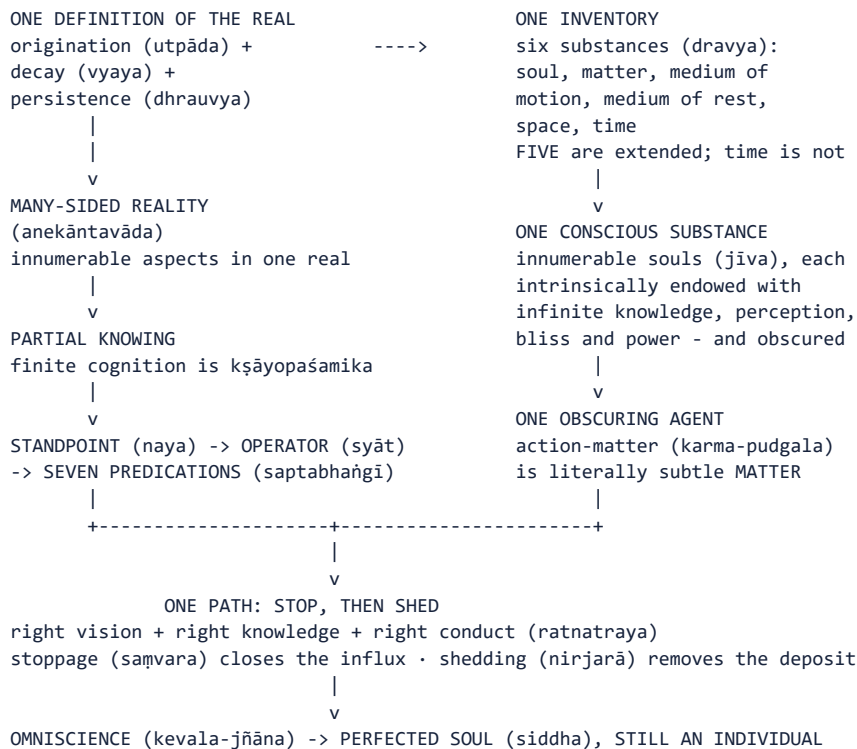
Syllabus, verbatim: *Jainism : Theory of Reality; Saptabhanginaya; Bondage and Liberation.* - UPSC Philosophy Paper I, Section B, item 13. **Evidence discipline:** FACT: marks convergent doctrine, ANALYSIS: marks analytical reconstruction or evaluation, and CAUTION: marks a contested or sectarian point. Doctrine is stated from the systematic Jaina tradition anchored in the *Tattvārthasūtra* and the standard expositions; sectarian, textual, historical and interpretive disputes are flagged rather than resolved. Model answers are independent learner practice and are never official UPSC keys. **Terminology rule:** the English concept leads; the accurate Sanskrit or Prakrit term in IAST follows immediately in parentheses.

What this package contains

Component	Count
Progressive teaching sessions in the Basic block	10
Original diagnostic MCQs - 24 core plus 8 remedial drills	32
Directly owned verified PYQs solved in full	9
Supporting routed PYQ solved in full	1
Original solved Mains models - two each at 10, 15 and 20 marks	6
Consolidated register parts	12 (A-L)
ASCII master flow panels	12

BASIC LEARNING SESSION

CONCEPT SPINE - ENGLISH FIRST, SANSKRIT IMMEDIATELY AFTER



Concept spine: the English concept leads and the Sanskrit term in IAST follows immediately. Read it downward - the definition of the real at the top generates the logic on the left and the soteriology on the right.

Answer-worthiness. The theory of reality, many-sidedness, the substance-quality-mode analysis, the sevenfold predication, material action-matter, bondage and liberation are **core syllabus**. The Jaina means-of-knowledge

scheme, the seven standpoints, the karma taxonomy and the fourteen stages are **core supporting depth** wherever they explain a routed PYQ. Sectarian minutiae, cosmographic enumeration and unverified legal detail about voluntary passionless death are **excluded** from answer targets.

HOW TO READ THIS SESSION

ANALYSIS: Reconstruction discipline. Jainism, unlike Cārvāka, is a living tradition with a surviving systematic literature, so doctrine can be stated positively. What still requires qualification is sectarian divergence, the dating of thinkers, and the modern legal-ethical status of voluntary passionless death. Where those appear, they are marked **CAUTION:** and reported rather than settled.

Complete the Basic block first. Optional interpretive depth is deliberately withheld until the clearly labelled optional block after the practice sections, so that the core doctrine stays easy to learn and immediately usable in a competent answer. Nothing in the optional block is required for a full-marks core answer.

ONE-SCREEN MAP

WHAT JAINISM IS

- > THEORY OF REALITY I: many-sidedness and the three-term definition of the real
- > THEORY OF REALITY II: six substances, soul and non-soul, matter
- > KNOWLEDGE: the inversion of direct and indirect, five kinds of knowing
- > STANDPOINT THEORY: the seven standpoints
- > CONDITIONAL PREDICATION: syāt and the sevenfold predication
- > EVALUATION: self-refutation, the absolutism charge, pluralism and realism
- > BONDAGE: action-matter as subtle matter and the mechanics of adhesion
- > LIBERATION: three jewels, discipline, fourteen stages, the perfected soul
- > RIVALS: named criticisms, replies and the answer architecture

This is a route map, not a substitute for the ten complete Basic subtopics below.

SESSION 1 - WHAT JAINISM IS: CONQUEROR (jina), FORD-MAKER (tīrthaṅkara) AND THE TEXTUAL ANCHOR

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Jainism is a liberation-centred, non-Vedic realist philosophy that explains why a naturally omniscient soul is empirically ignorant, and how disciplined conduct removes that obscuration.

Technical definition: Jaina philosophy (*jaina-darśana*) is a pluralistic realism that treats every real as a substance (*dravya*) enduring through modes (*pariyāya*), holds that reality is many-sided (*anekāntavāda*), disciplines finite judgement through standpoints (*naya*) and conditional predication (*syāt*), and explains bondage as the adhesion of subtle material action-matter (*karma-pudgala*) to the conscious soul (*jīva*), removable through the three jewels (*ratnatraya*).

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jainism is best defined as a pluralistic realism with non-absolutist finite predication and a material theory of karmic bondage: reality has many objective aspects, finite judgement reaches it only under standpoints, and liberation is achieved by removing real karmic matter rather than by acquiring divine grace.

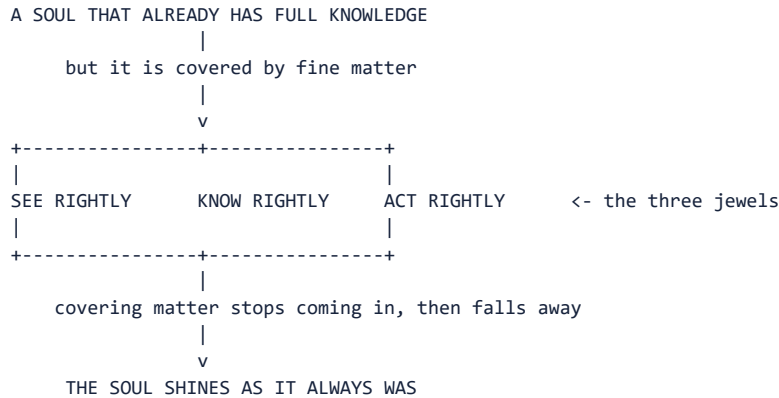
MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **conqueror (jina)** - one who has conquered the passions, not a creator
- **ford-maker (tīrthaṅkara)** - liberated teacher who re-establishes the crossing over rebirth
- **Umāsvāti / Umāsvāmī, Tattvārthasūtra***
- **three jewels (ratnatraya)** - right vision, right knowledge, right conduct
- **non-theism about creation (anīśvaravāda)**
- **Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)**

How to use them: open by naming the system, not the sect. Say that Jainism is a *darśana* with a shared systematic text, then state the three jewels as its path formula, and only then add that its religious authority rests on perfected

teachers rather than on a creator.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

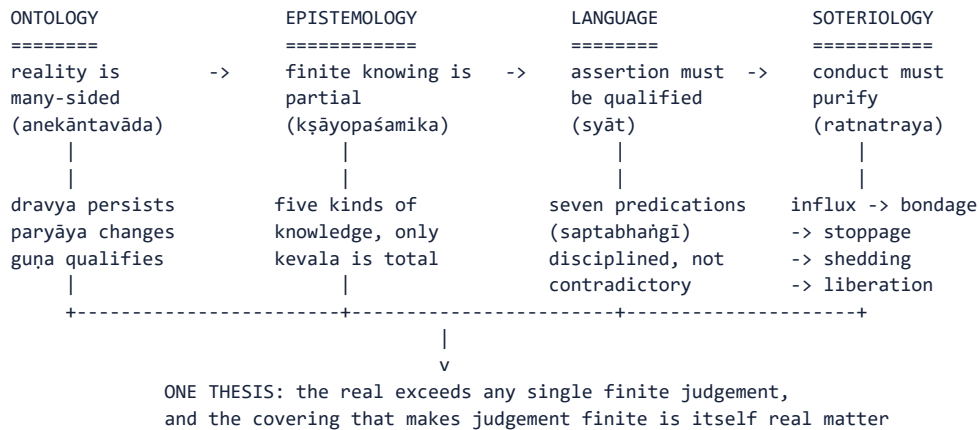


In simple words: Jainism does not ask how a soul becomes great. It asks why an already perfect knower behaves like an ignorant one. Its whole system - ontology, logic and ethics - is built to answer that single question by identifying the covering, explaining how the covering arrives, and prescribing how it is stopped and shed.

Remember first	Meaning
<i>Jina</i>	"Conqueror" of passions; the school takes its name from the title, not from a founder-god
<i>Tirthankara</i>	Ford-maker: a liberated teacher who rebuilds the crossing, twenty-four in the present cycle
<i>Tattvārthasūtra</i>	First systematic Sanskrit exposition, authoritative for both major traditions
Path formula	Right vision + right knowledge + right conduct, taken together
What Jainism denies	A creator God, not soul, ethics, rebirth or spiritual perfection

One-line memory: Jainism is the science of removing a covering from a soul that is already luminous.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE SYSTEM AS ONE ARGUMENT, NOT FOUR TOPICS



ANALYSIS: Caption. Examiners repeatedly reward candidates who show that Jaina logic is *derived*, not decorative. Many-sidedness is a claim about the object; standpoint-relativity is a claim about the knower; the *syāt* particle is a claim about the sentence; and material karma explains why the knower is limited in the first place. Answer scripts that treat *anekāntavāda* as mere tolerance lose exactly this derivation.

1. Umāsvāti / Umāsvāmī and the Tattvārthasūtra

FACT: The *Tattvārthasūtra*, also called *Tattvārthādhigama-sūtra*, of **Umāsvāti** in Śvetāmbara usage and **Umāsvāmī** in Digambara usage, is the first systematic Sanskrit exposition of Jaina philosophy and is treated as authoritative by **both** major traditions.

FACT: What it does, and why that matters in an answer:

1. It supplies a compact doctrinal grammar covering metaphysics, epistemology, ethics, bondage and liberation in one architecture.
2. Its cross-sectarian authority is unusual, because Śvetāmbara and Digambara traditions otherwise differ on canon, monastic practice and several doctrinal details.
3. It states the path through the **three jewels (ratnatraya)**: right vision (*samyag-darśana*), right knowledge (*samyag-jñāna*) and right conduct (*samyak-cāritra*).
4. It systematises the seven principles (*tattvas*), the five extended substances plus time, and the classification of knowledge (*jñāna*) - so Jainism cannot honestly be reduced either to "just ethics" or to "just seven-fold logic".

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition worth stating.** An answer improves the moment Jainism is presented as a systematic *darśana* rather than as a collection of ascetic practices. The examiner is testing whether the candidate can locate a doctrine inside a system.

CAUTION: **Sectarian-history objection.** Does a text accepted by both traditions erase real sectarian difference?

ANALYSIS: **Reply.** It does not. It supplies a shared doctrinal framework *within which* disagreements about canon, practice and interpretation continue. Cite the text as a systematic anchor, never as proof of doctrinal uniformity.

FACT: **Names to drop carefully, with what each name buys you:**

Name	Tradition / period	Use it for
Kundakunda	Digambara; <i>Samayasāra</i>	The real-standpoint / conventional-standpoint contrast (<i>nīścaya-naya</i> / <i>vyavahāra-naya</i>)
Siddhasena Divākara	Early logic	Early systematisation of many-sidedness and conditional predication
Samantabhadra	Early logic	Early defence of <i>syādvāda</i> against the contradiction charge
Akalaṅka	Mature logic	Developed Jaina theory of means of valid knowledge (<i>pramāṇa</i>)
Māṇikyanandi, Hemacandra, Yaśovijaya	Later logic	The mature indirect-knowledge tradition, including recognition and reasoning

ANALYSIS: Do **not** invent *sūtra* numbers, dates or authorship certainties. Write "the *Tattvārthasūtra* states the path through right vision, right knowledge and right conduct" - that formulation is safe and complete.

2. Conqueror, ford-maker and the shape of Jaina religious authority

FACT: "Jaina" derives from **conqueror (jina)**: one who has conquered the passions and karmic bondage. A **ford-maker (tīrthaṅkara)** is a liberated teacher who re-establishes the crossing over the cycle of rebirth (*saṃsāra*) - not a creator, not a governor of the world, and not a granter of grace.

FACT: The received framework:

1. Twenty-four ford-makers are recognised in the present cosmic cycle.
2. **Rṣabha** is named first, **Pārśva** twenty-third and **Vardhamāna Mahāvīra** twenty-fourth.
3. Mahāvīra **systematised and renewed an already existing tradition**; describing him as inventing Jainism is a factual error in the Jaina account itself.
4. Śvetāmbara and Digambara traditions differ on canon, monastic practice and some doctrinal details, while sharing the central grammar of soul, action-matter, many-sidedness, vows and liberation.

CAUTION: **Historical caution.** Mahāvīra and Pārśva function as historical anchors, but precise dates and claims about the earliest ford-makers require source-specific qualification. A philosophy answer needs the framework, not legendary chronology; do not assert regnal or birth years you cannot source.

FACT: **Philosophical consequence, and this is the examinable point:** Jainism combines an **uncreated cosmos** with religious authority grounded in **perfected teachers**. It is unorthodox (*nāstika*) because it rejects Vedic authority - not because it denies soul, ethics, rebirth or spiritual perfection.

Sense of "Veda-rejecting (<i>nāstika</i>)"	Does Jainism qualify?
Rejects the authority of the Veda - the primary classificatory sense	FACT: Yes; this is why Jainism sits with Cārvāka and Buddhism in the unorthodox column
Denies life after death - a secondary sense	WRONG: No; Jainism affirms rebirth, action-consequence and liberation
Modern vernacular "atheist"	ANALYSIS: Misleading; Sāṃkhya and Mīmāṃsā are non-theistic yet Veda-accepting

MEMORY: **Trap, and it is examined:** Jainism and Cārvāka are both *nāstika*, but for different reasons and to different depths. Cārvāka is unorthodox in **both** senses; Jainism only in the **first**.

3. Why Jainism denies a creator without denying divinity

FACT: The argument, in the order it should be written:

1. The six substances are eternal in their substantial continuity.
2. Their changing modes explain ordinary production and destruction, so no creation from nothing is needed.
3. Action-matter (*karma*) explains embodied inequality and moral consequence without divine allocation.
4. A creator therefore adds no necessary explanatory work while raising further questions about motive, material, imperfection and responsibility.
5. Liberation depends on self-purification, not on grace.

FACT: **Distinction to protect:** Jainism denies a *creator*, not divinity in the honorific sense. A conqueror (*jina*), a perfected soul (*siddha*) and a ford-maker (*tīrthaṅkara*) are worthy of reverence because of achieved perfection, not because they made or govern the universe.

ANALYSIS: **Exam formula.** Jainism is a religion of self-effort within an uncreated moral cosmos: non-theistic about creation, yet neither materialist nor spiritually negative.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Jainism should be introduced as a systematic *darśana* whose religious authority is achieved rather than creative. **Named evidence.** The *Tattvārthasūtra* of Umāsvāti / Umāsvāmī is accepted across Śvetāmbara and Digambara traditions and states the path as right vision, right knowledge and right conduct taken together; the tradition's own title-word is *jina*, "conqueror of the passions", and a *tīrthaṅkara* is a ford-maker, not a maker of the world. **Analysis.** Because authority is achieved through the destruction of obscuring action-matter, the same architecture that yields the ethics also yields the epistemology: a soul freed from obscuration knows completely, so partial knowledge is a karmic condition rather than a permanent limit of the knower. **Qualification / link.** The shared text does not erase sectarian difference, and the earliest ford-makers cannot be treated as datable history; the safe claim is doctrinal and systematic, and it is exactly the claim the question rewards.

UPSC TRAPS IN THIS SUBTOPIC

1. WRONG: Calling Mahāvīra the founder of Jainism. FACT: He is the twenty-fourth ford-maker who renewed an existing tradition.
2. WRONG: Translating *nāstika* as "atheist". FACT: The primary criterion is rejection of Vedic authority.
3. WRONG: Treating the *Tattvārthasūtra* as proof of sectarian uniformity. FACT: It is a shared systematic anchor, not a unifying canon.
4. WRONG: Reducing Jainism to non-violence. FACT: Non-violence is derived from the plurality of souls and the mechanics of bondage.
5. WRONG: Inventing *sūtra* numbers or ford-maker dates. FACT: Name the text and the doctrine, never fabricate the citation.

RAPID REVISION

- Textual anchor: **Umāsvāti / Umāsvāmī**, *Tattvārthasūtra*, cross-sectarian authority.
- Path formula: right vision + right knowledge + right conduct, jointly and not serially.

- No creator; liberated souls remain **numerically distinct** individuals.
- Unorthodox on the **Veda criterion only**, unlike Cārvāka.
- Never reduce the system to "seven viewpoints" or to "non-violence".

EXAM APPLICATION - WHERE THIS IS ASKED

- Supplies the opening two or three lines of **every** Jainism answer, including 2019 Q6(a) and 2025 Q7(c).
- Directly controls the "pluralistic and realistic" verdict demanded in **2025 Q7(c), 15 marks**.
- Keep sectarian history to two lines at most unless the question asks about sources.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | WHAT JAINISM IS - CONQUEROR, FORD-MAKER AND THE TEXTUAL ANCHOR

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

conqueror (jina) · ford-maker (tīrthaṅkara) · Tattvārthasūtra of Umāsvāti / Umāsvāmī · three jewels (ratnatraya) · non-theism about creation (anīśvaravāda) · Veda-rejecting school (nāstika)

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Eternal substances plus changing modes plus material action-consequence together explain production, inequality and liberation, so a creator does no explanatory work and religious authority becomes achieved rather than creative.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Jainism is unorthodox only on the Veda criterion, unlike Cārvāka, which is unorthodox both on Vedic authority and on survival after death.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Never call Mahāvīra the founder and never translate nāstika as atheist; write that Jainism rejects a creator while revering perfected teachers.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jainism is a pluralistic realism with non-absolutist finite predication and a material theory of karmic bondage, in which liberation is achieved by removing real karmic matter rather than by receiving divine grace.

SESSION 2 - THEORY OF REALITY I: MANY-SIDEDNESS (anekāntavāda) AND THE REAL AS ORIGINATION, DECAY AND PERSISTENCE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A real thing is neither a frozen block nor a bare series of flashes; it keeps its identity while its states genuinely change, and it has more true aspects than any single sentence can capture.

Technical definition: Many-sidedness (anekāntavāda) is the metaphysical thesis that the real object is *ananta-dharmātmakaṃ vastu*, a thing constituted by innumerable aspects; and the real (sat) is defined as that which possesses origination (utpāda), decay (vyaya) and persistence (dhrauvya) together.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

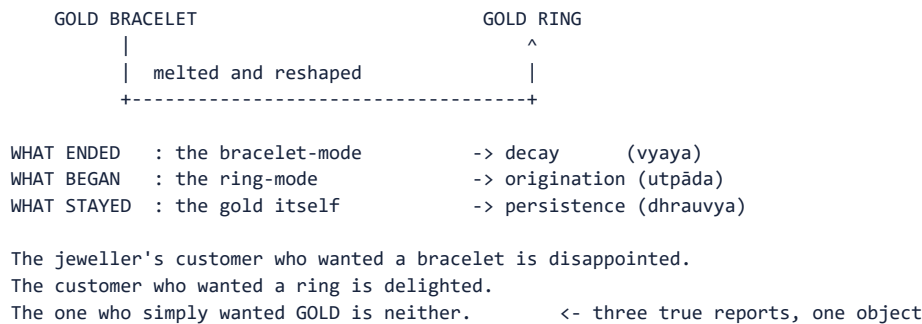
For the Jainas reality is defined, not merely described: the real is that which originates, decays and persists at once, so permanence belongs to it as substance and change belongs to it as mode - and it is precisely this composite structure that forces every finite judgement to be aspect-relative.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- many-sidedness (anekāntavāda)
- the real (sat) = origination + decay + persistence (utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya)
- substance (dravya) · quality (guṇa) · mode (paryāya)
- thing with innumerable aspects (ananta-dharmātmakaṃ vastu)
- one-sidedness (ekāntavāda) - the error being refused
- aspect-realism, not subjectivism

How to use them: state the definition of the real *first*, derive many-sidedness from it, and only then move to judgement. A script that begins with the seven predications and works backwards loses the derivation marks.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

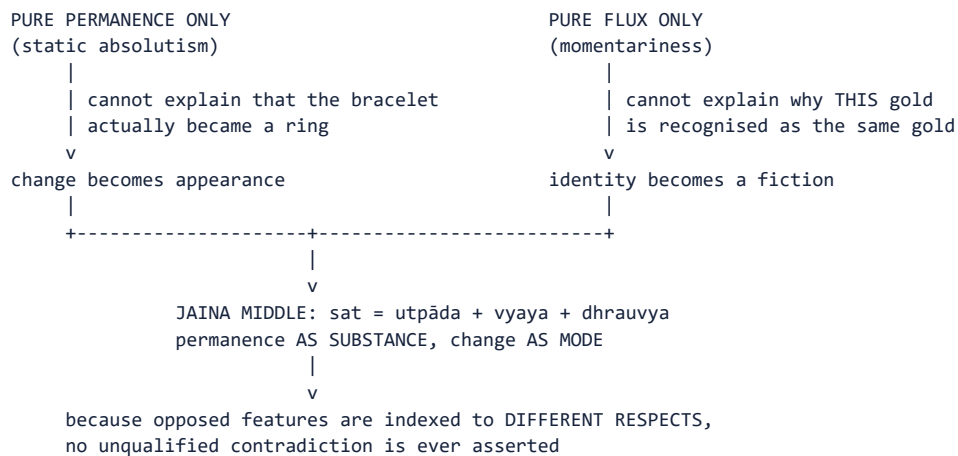


In simple words: the three onlookers are not contradicting one another; they are reporting the same object under three different aspects. Jainism generalises that ordinary situation into a metaphysics: a real thing genuinely gains a state, genuinely loses a state, and genuinely stays itself, all at the same time.

Term	Easy meaning	What it prevents
Substance (<i>dravya</i>)	The enduring bearer	Prevents collapse into pure flux
Quality (<i>guṇa</i>)	Its abiding characteristic	Prevents a bare, featureless substratum
Mode (<i>pariāya</i>)	Its changing state	Prevents a static, inert absolute
Many-sidedness (<i>anekāntavāda</i>)	Aspects are really in the object	Prevents relativism about the object

One-line memory: the substance persists while the modes originate and perish.

VISUAL: VISUAL - WHY BOTH EXTREMES FAIL



ANALYSIS: Caption. This diagram is the whole answer to "how is reality defined by the Jainas?" (2019 Q6(a)). The definition is chosen because it is the only one that saves *both* recognition and transformation, and the price of saving both is that judgement must become aspect-relative.

1. Many-sidedness stated as a metaphysical thesis

FACT: Statement. Many-sidedness (*anekāntavāda*) is the doctrine that reality is many-sided; no single unqualified proposition exhausts the nature of a real thing.

FACT: Argument, in five steps that can be written verbatim:

1. Real things endure through change and exhibit multiple aspects.
2. Human cognition usually grasps only one aspect at a time.
3. Dogmatic one-sided claims therefore distort reality.
4. A sound metaphysics must allow a plurality of aspects within one real.
5. Hence reality is non-one-sided - *anekānta*.

ANALYSIS: Presupposition. Being is richer than any single finite judgement.

FACT: **Distinction that earns marks.** Many-sidedness is **not** indecision, tolerance or diplomacy. It is a **metaphysical** claim about the complexity of the object, logically prior to any theory of predication.

FACT: **Example.** A jar is permanent as a substance across a stretch of time, changing in its modes, and describable by shape, use, material and temporal state. No one predicate says all of this at once.

FACT: **Sceptical objection.** If every object has indefinitely many aspects, knowledge may become impossible.

ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Knowledge is possible *precisely* through qualified standpoints rather than through absolutist simplification; partiality is a condition of finite knowing, not a defeat of it.

2. The real (sat) as origination, decay and persistence

FACT: **Statement.** The real (*sat*) is what possesses **origination** (*utpāda*), **decay** (*vyaya*) and **persistence** (*dhrauvya*) together - the formula usually cited as *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya-yuktaṃ sat*.

FACT: **Argument:**

1. Experience shows change: forms arise and pass.
2. Experience also shows continuity: something persists through those changes.
3. Pure permanence cannot explain transformation.
4. Pure flux cannot explain identity.
5. Therefore reality must include both persistence and modification.
6. This is articulated by saying that substance is characterised by origination, decay and permanence.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** Both common-sense identity and experienced change are philosophically significant and must be preserved rather than explained away.

FACT: **Distinction.** This differs from Buddhist momentariness, which gives primacy to flux, and from strict monisms that absorb change into mere appearance.

FACT: **The named objection.** How can opposite features - change and permanence - belong to one thing? FACT: **The reply.** They belong in **different respects**: permanence as substance (*dravya*), change as mode (*pariyāya*). This single sentence disarms the contradiction charge at its root.

3. Substance, quality and mode

FACT: **Statement.** Every substance (*dravya*) possesses **qualities** (*guṇa*), its essential and abiding characteristics, and **modes** (*pariyāya*), its changing states or modifications.

FACT: **Argument:**

1. A substance must have stable features or it would not be what it is.
2. It must also undergo modal change or it could not participate in experience.
3. Therefore it is intelligible only as substance-with-qualities-and-modes.

FACT: **Distinction, and this is examined.** *Guṇa* is **not** *pariyāya*. Qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics; modes are the changing states in which those qualities appear.

FACT: **Example.** Consciousness (*upayoga*) is a defining quality of the soul; pleasure, pain, delusion or liberated omniscience are **modes** in which the soul appears.

FACT: **Buddhist nominalist objection.** Why not speak only of changing qualities and drop the substance?

ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Because changing qualities still presuppose something whose changes they are; a series of states without a bearer cannot ground recognition or moral continuity.

Level	Jaina term	Status	Test question
Bearer	<i>dravya</i>	Persists	What is it that changed?
Abiding character	<i>guṇa</i>	Persists with the bearer	What makes it that kind of thing?
Changing state	<i>pariyāya</i>	Originates and decays	What is it doing or undergoing now?

4. Causation: identity and novelty together

FACT:/ANALYSIS: **Statement.** Jaina causation is standardly described as **both-existence-and-non-existence of the effect (sadasatkāryavāda)**: the effect exists in the cause with respect to enduring substance, and does not yet exist with respect to its new mode.

FACT: **Argument:**

1. If the effect were wholly identical with the cause, production would add nothing.
2. If it were wholly non-existent and unrelated, anything could arise from anything.
3. In transformation the underlying substance persists while an earlier mode ceases and a new mode originates.
4. Therefore the effect is continuous with the cause as substance and novel as mode.

FACT: **Example.** A clay jar is not produced from sheer nothing, because clay persists; yet the jar-form is genuinely new and was not previously present as that completed mode.

FACT: **Comparison to write in one line.** Jaina causation mediates between Sāṃkhya's pre-existence doctrine (*satkāryavāda*) and Nyāya's new-production doctrine (*asatkāryavāda*) by applying many-sidedness to causal identity.

FACT: **Objection.** Saying the effect both exists and does not exist appears contradictory. FACT: **Reply.** Existence and non-existence are indexed to different respects - substance and mode - so no unqualified contradiction is affirmed.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The Jaina definition of the real is chosen to save recognition and transformation simultaneously, and every later Jaina doctrine follows from that choice. **Named evidence.** The real is defined as *utpāda-vyaya-dhrauṇya-yuktaṃ sat*; the standard illustration is the gold that loses its bracelet-mode, gains its ring-mode and persists as gold; and the same structure yields Jaina causation as *sadasatkāryavāda*, positioned between Sāṃkhya's *satkāryavāda* and Nyāya's *asatkāryavāda*. **Analysis.** Because permanence is predicated of the substance and change of the mode, the two apparently opposed predicates never occupy the same respect, which is why the Jaina can be a realist about change without becoming a momentarist and a realist about identity without becoming a static monist. **Qualification / link.** The defence works only if the substance-mode distinction is itself granted; a Buddhist who refuses aspect-realism will say the dilemma has been renamed rather than solved, which is exactly why the question usually continues into the theory of judgement.

UPSC TRAPS IN THIS SUBTOPIC

1. WRONG: "Many-sidedness means every opinion is equally true." FACT: It means the *object* has many real aspects; judgements are still gradable.
2. WRONG: Using *guṇa* and *pariāya* interchangeably. FACT: Quality abides; mode changes.
3. WRONG: Presenting the gold example as mere illustration. FACT: It encodes the three-term definition of the real.
4. WRONG: Calling Jaina causation *satkāryavāda*. FACT: It is *sadasatkāryavāda*, and the reason is the substance/mode index.
5. WRONG: Starting the 2019 answer with the seven predications. FACT: Define the real first; judgement is the *reflection* of that definition.

RAPID REVISION

- *sat* = origination + decay + persistence, **together**.
- Substance persists; quality abides with it; mode originates and perishes.
- Many-sidedness is **ontology**, not tolerance.
- Causation: continuous as substance, novel as mode.
- The contradiction charge dies on the phrase "in different respects".

EXAM APPLICATION - WHERE THIS IS ASKED

- **2019 Q6(a), 20 marks** - "How is reality defined by the Jainas?" begins exactly here.
- **2025 Q7(c), 15 marks** - the realism half of "pluralistic and realistic" rests on this section.
- **2020 Q7(c), 15 marks** (Cārvāka-owned) - the Jaina half of the Cārvāka/Jaina contrast is this definition.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | THEORY OF REALITY I - MANY-SIDEDNESS AND THE THREE-TERM DEFINITION OF THE REAL

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

many-sidedness (anekāntavāda) · sat = utpāda + vyaya + dhrauvya · substance (dravya) · quality (guṇa) · mode (paryāya) · thing with innumerable aspects (ananta-dharmātmakam vastu) · both-existence-and-non-existence of the effect (sadasatkāryavāda)

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Pure permanence cannot explain transformation and pure flux cannot explain identity, so the real is defined as originating, decaying and persisting at once, with permanence indexed to substance and change indexed to mode.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Jaina causation therefore sits between Sāṃkhya pre-existence of the effect and Nyāya fresh production, because the effect is continuous as substance and novel as mode.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Do not equate many-sidedness with tolerance or with equal truth of all opinions; it is a claim about aspects in the object, and it is what makes qualified predication necessary rather than optional.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: For the Jainas the real is that which originates, decays and persists together, so permanence belongs to it as substance and change belongs to it as mode, and this composite structure is exactly what forces every finite judgement to be aspect-relative.

SESSION 3 - THEORY OF REALITY II: SIX SUBSTANCES, SOUL AND NON-SOUL, AND MATTER

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Jainism sorts everything that exists into six kinds of substance, splits them into the conscious and the non-conscious, and treats matter as the only substance that can be perceived by the senses.

Technical definition: Jaina ontology recognises six substances (*dravyas*) - soul (*jīva*), matter (*pudgala*), medium of motion (*dharma*), medium of rest (*adharma*), space (*ākāśa*) and time (*kāla*) - of which the first five are extended substances (*astikāyas*), while time is a substance that is **not** an *astikāya*.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jaina pluralism is not a list but an explanatory scheme: consciousness, corporeality, motion, rest, accommodation and succession each require a distinct real, and the resulting six-substance ontology is what makes Jainism irreducibly plural without becoming arbitrary.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- soul (*jīva*) / non-soul (*ajīva*)
- six substances (*ṣaḍ-dravya*); five extended substances (*pañcāstikāya*)
- space-points (*pradeśa*); world-space (*lokākāśa*) / beyond-world space (*alokākāśa*)
- matter (*pudgala*); atom (*paramāṇu*); aggregate (*skandha*)
- infinite tetrad (*ananta-catuṣṭaya*) - knowledge, perception, bliss, power
- immobile (*sthāvara*) / mobile (*trasa*) beings

How to use them: name the six, immediately flag that only five are *astikāyas*, then give each substance a one-line explanatory function. Listing without functions reads as memorisation.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

Ask six different "why" questions about one ordinary event:
a fish swims across a pond and then rests.

WHY IS THERE AN EXPERIENCER AT ALL?	-> soul (jīva)
WHY IS THERE A BODY AND WATER?	-> matter (pudgala)
WHY IS MOVEMENT POSSIBLE?	-> medium of motion (dharma)
WHY IS RESTING POSSIBLE?	-> medium of rest (adharma)
WHERE DOES ALL OF IT FIT?	-> space (ākāśa)
WHY IS THERE A BEFORE AND AN AFTER?	-> time (kāla)

In simple words: each substance answers a question that the others cannot. The media of motion and rest do **not** push or stop the fish; they are the standing conditions without which swimming and resting would be impossible at all - like water for a fish, not like a hand pushing it.

Term	Easy meaning	Frequent error to avoid
<i>dharma-dravya</i>	Condition enabling motion	It does not mean merit or virtue here

Substance	Extended substance (astikāya)?	Extension
Time	WRONG: No	A substance, but an-astikāya : it lacks extension across many space-points

FACT: **Safe doctrinal formulation**: time is a substance but not an extended substance; the *pañcāstikāya* list has five members while the *dravya* list has six.

CAUTION: **Sectarian nuance, stated with care**. Digambara authors characteristically affirm real **time-atoms (kāla-aṇus)** associated with the space-points of world-space, whereas some Śvetāmbara discussions treat the substantial independence of time as disputed or conventional. Report the dispute; do not adjudicate it.

FACT: **Named objection (Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika style)**. Media of motion and rest look mysterious and unparsimonious. ANALYSIS: **Reply**. They are not forces or pushes but **enabling conditions** required for a coherent pluralistic cosmology; a fish swims because water permits swimming, and the medium of motion is the cosmic analogue of that permission.

2. Soul and non-soul - the fundamental division

FACT: **Statement**. The most fundamental ontological distinction is between **soul (jīva)**, the conscious, and **non-soul (ajīva)**, the non-conscious.

FACT: **Argument**: experience distinguishes living, aware beings from inert entities; consciousness cannot be reduced to inert matter in Jaina thought; hence the universe divides into soul and non-soul.

FACT: **Distinctions to write**: unlike Advaita, this is not a distinction *within* one underlying Brahman; unlike Cārvāka, consciousness is not reducible to material organisation.

FACT: **The problem this immediately creates**. If the soul is immaterial, how can material action-matter affect it? That question is the engine of Session 8, and a good answer flags it here rather than pretending it does not arise.

3. The nature of the soul

FACT: **Statement**. Every soul is numerically distinct, beginningless, and intrinsically endowed with the **infinite tetrad (ananta-catuṣṭaya)** - infinite knowledge, infinite perception, infinite bliss and infinite power - although these are obscured by action-matter.

FACT: **Argument**: liberation is meaningful only if the soul has a native capacity for perfection; bondage is therefore obscuration rather than annihilation of that nature; hence the soul is intrinsically luminous but contingently covered.

FACT: **Distinction**. Jainism is pluralistic: there are **many** souls, not one universal self. It also differs from Nyāya, where the self becomes conscious through conjunction with the internal organ; in Jainism consciousness (*upayoga*) belongs to the soul intrinsically.

FACT: **The classification of living beings, which grounds Jaina ethics**:

Class	Sanskrit term	Structure
Liberated soul	mukta-jīva	Free from every karmic obstruction
Bound soul	baddha-jīva	Embodied and karmically conditioned
Immobile bound being	sthāvara	One-sense life, with touch; classically earth-, water-, fire-, air- and plant-bodied
Mobile bound being	trasa	Two-, three-, four- or five-sense beings

FACT: **Spatiality, and the objection it invites**. An embodied soul has **space-points (pradeśa)** and is co-extensive with its body, like a lamp illuminating the room it occupies: the ant's soul fills an ant-body and the elephant's soul an elephant-body without becoming material. This contraction-and-expansion doctrine explains embodied awareness, but it creates a serious objection - how can an immaterial substance possess *changing* extension?

FACT: **Sāṃkhya / Vedānta objection**. If the soul is naturally omniscient, ignorance becomes hard to explain. FACT: **Reply**. Action-matter as obscuring material is introduced precisely to explain the gap between intrinsic capacity and empirical limitation.

4. Matter - the only substance with form

FACT: **Statement. Matter (pudgala)** is the material substance and the **only** substance possessing form (*rūpa*); it includes atoms, bodies, sense-objects and karmic matter.

FACT: **Atomic structure, stated exactly:**

1. The indivisible material atom (**paramāṇu**) is the smallest unit of matter.
2. Material aggregates (**skandha**) arise through combinations of atoms.
3. Matter possesses colour, taste, smell and touch; **sound is treated as a material modification** rather than as a separate immaterial quality - an explicit contrast with Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika, where sound is the quality of ether.
4. Jaina atoms are **not** divided into permanently different elemental kinds in the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika manner; elemental differentiation belongs to developed modes and combinations.
5. Bodies, sense-organs, speech, breath, the mind as an embodied instrument, and karmic matter are all material configurations.

ANALYSIS: **Etymological aid.** *Pudgala* is commonly explained through filling or combining (*pūraṇa*) and disintegrating (*galana*) - useful because it foregrounds matter's aggregative and transformable character.

FACT: **Nyāya / Mīmāṃsā objection.** To call action-consequence "matter" seems strange. FACT: **Reply.** That strangeness is Jainism's originality: bondage is not merely a moral description but a real quasi-physical entanglement, and it is only possible because matter alone has form and can therefore adhere.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Jaina pluralism is disciplined rather than arbitrary, because each substance is admitted for a distinct explanatory task. **Named evidence.** The six substances are soul, matter, medium of motion, medium of rest, space and time; only five are extended substances, since time is *an-astikāya*; and only matter possesses form, which is why sound is classed as a material modification rather than as a quality of ether. **Analysis.** The scheme therefore answers six different questions - who experiences, what is corporeal, how movement and rest are possible, where things are accommodated and why there is succession - so removing any one member would leave a genuine explanatory gap rather than merely shortening a list. **Qualification / link.** The cost is real: the soul is said to expand and contract with the body, which Nyāya attacks as incompatible with eternality, and the substantial independence of time is presented differently across sectarian traditions, so the pluralism should be defended as explanatory rather than as self-evident.

UPSC TRAPS IN THIS SUBTOPIC

1. WRONG: "Six substances, six *astikāyas*." FACT: Six substances, **five** *astikāyas*; time is excluded.
2. WRONG: Reading *dharma* / *adharma* as merit and demerit. FACT: Here they are media of motion and rest.
3. WRONG: Treating *ākāśa* as the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika sound-substrate. FACT: In Jainism sound is material; space merely accommodates.
4. WRONG: Saying the soul is "one". FACT: Souls are innumerable and remain numerically distinct even after liberation.
5. WRONG: Treating the lamp analogy as decorative. FACT: It carries the *pradeśa* doctrine and the Nyāya objection attached to it.

RAPID REVISION

- Six substances; five extended; time is the exception.
- Soul: many, beginningless, intrinsically endowed with the infinite tetrad.
- Only matter has form; sound is a material modification.
- Immobile one-sense beings are morally significant - this is the metaphysical root of non-violence.
- Soul is co-extensive with its body; the lamp simile carries both the doctrine and its objection.

EXAM APPLICATION - WHERE THIS IS ASKED

- **2025 Q7(c), 15 marks** - pluralism is argued from the six-substance scheme and the innumerability of souls.
- **2018 Q6(c), 15 marks** - bound and liberated souls presuppose the account of the soul given here.

- **2020 Q7(c), 15 marks** (Cārvāka-owned) - Cārvāka's four elements versus the Jaina six substances is the cleanest contrast available.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | THEORY OF REALITY II - SIX SUBSTANCES, SOUL AND NON-SOUL, AND MATTER

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

soul (jīva) · non-soul (ajīva) · six substances · five extended substances (pañcāstikāya) · space-points (pradeśa) · matter (pudgala) · atom (paramāṇu) · aggregate (skandha) · infinite tetrad (ananta-catuṣṭaya)

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Each substance is admitted because it discharges an explanatory task the others cannot, so consciousness, corporeality, motion, rest, accommodation and succession each require a distinct real.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Only matter possesses form, which is why sound is a material modification in Jainism and why karmic matter can adhere to a formless soul at all.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Write six substances but five extended substances, and never read the media of motion and rest as moral merit and demerit.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina pluralism is an explanatory scheme rather than a list, because consciousness, corporeality, motion, rest, accommodation and succession each demand a distinct real, which is what makes Jainism irreducibly plural without being arbitrary.

SESSION 4 - KNOWLEDGE: THE JAINA INVERSION OF DIRECT AND INDIRECT, AND THE FIVE KINDS OF KNOWING

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Jainism reverses the usual classroom expectation: seeing a pot with the eyes is only *conventionally* direct, because it depends on organs, mind and karmic limitation; what is truly direct is what the soul knows by itself.

Technical definition: Jaina epistemology divides valid knowledge into **direct (pratyakṣa)** and **indirect (parokṣa)**, where strict directness means knowing by the soul without mediation by sense or mind; ordinary sense-cognition is therefore only **conventional direct knowledge (sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa)**, and the five kinds of knowledge (*jñāna*) are graded by the removal of knowledge-obscuring action-matter.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The Jaina theory of judgement is not a logical curiosity bolted onto a metaphysics: it follows necessarily from a theory of knowledge in which ordinary cognition is karmically partial, so that only omniscience could ever make an unconditioned assertion.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **direct (pratyakṣa) / indirect (parokṣa)**
- **conventional direct knowledge (sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa)**
- **sense-and-mind cognition (matī), verbal/scriptural knowledge (śruta), clairvoyant knowledge (avadhi), knowledge of others' minds (manaḥparyāya), omniscience (kevala)**
- **partial destruction-cum-subsidence (kṣāyopaśamika)**
- **wrong orientation (mithyā-darśana); kumati, kuśruta, vibhaṅga**
- **recollection (smṛti), recognition (pratyabhijñā), reasoning that grasps pervasion (tarka / ūha)**

How to use them: deploy "conventional direct knowledge" early. It signals that you know Jaina *pratyakṣa* is not Nyāya *pratyakṣa*, which is the single most common source of lost marks on this subtopic.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

ORDINARY EXPECTATION
=====

eyes see a pot
|
v
"this is DIRECT"

JAINA CLASSIFICATION
=====

eyes see a pot
|
| depends on: sense organ + mind
| + karmic veiling
v
CONVENTIONALLY direct only
(sāṃvyavahārika pratyakṣa)
|
v
STRICTLY it belongs with the INDIRECT

WHAT IS STRICTLY DIRECT? the soul knowing without any organ standing in between
avadhi -> manañparyāya -> kevala (limited -> wider -> total)

In simple words: the Jaina test for "direct" is not vividness but **absence of a middleman**. Eyes and mind are middlemen. Remove karmic obscuration far enough and the soul knows without them; that, and only that, is direct in the strict sense.

Term	Easy meaning	Why it matters
<i>pratyakṣa</i> (strict)	Soul knows without mediation	Explains why omniscience is the standard of full knowledge
<i>sāṃvyavahārika pratyakṣa</i>	Everyday, workable directness	Preserves ordinary life without conceding metaphysical finality
<i>kṣāyopaśamika</i>	Knowledge from partly removed veiling	The exact reason finite judgement is partial

One-line memory: directness is measured by freedom from mediation, not by brightness of appearance.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE FIVE KINDS OF KNOWLEDGE AS A LADDER OF UNVEILING

KARMIC VEIL
=====

heaviest
|
|
|
|
|
|
v
veil destroyed

KIND OF KNOWLEDGE
=====

mati - sense-and-mind
śruta - verbal / scriptural, derived from mati

avadhi - limited clairvoyant knowledge of material
manañ- - knowledge of others' mental modes
paryāya
kevala - unlimited, unmediated omniscience

CLASSIFICATION
=====

INDIRECT (parokṣa)
INDIRECT (parokṣa)

DIRECT (mukhya / pāramāthika)
DIRECT, higher than avadhi but still not total
DIRECT and COMPLETE

FALSE COUNTERPARTS under wrong orientation (mithyā-darśana):

mati -> kumati / mati-ajñāna
śruta -> kuśruta / śruta-ajñāna
avadhi-> vibhaṅga-jñāna

ANALYSIS: Caption. Read the ladder downward and the point becomes unmistakable: the five kinds are **not** five independent means of valid knowledge in the Nyāya sense. They are stations on a single curve of karmic unveiling, which is why Jaina epistemology cannot be detached from Jaina soteriology.

1. The primary division and its high-yield inversion

FACT: Statement. Jaina epistemology distinguishes **direct (pratyakṣa)** and **indirect (parokṣa)** knowledge, but uses the word *pratyakṣa* in a non-ordinary way.

FACT: Argument:

1. In the strict Jaina sense, *pratyakṣa* means knowledge the soul has directly, without mediation by senses or mind.
2. Ordinary sense-perception is therefore not ultimate direct knowledge; it is only **conventional direct knowledge (sāṃvyavahārika pratyakṣa)**.

3. Strictly, ordinary sense-and-mind cognition belongs with mediated cognition, because it depends on organs, mind, signs and karmic limitation.
4. ANALYSIS: This reverses the usual expectation that perception is the primary direct means of valid knowledge.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** Directness is measured by freedom from mediation and karmic obstruction, not by sensory vividness.

FACT: **Distinction.** Do not map Jaina *pratyakṣa* mechanically onto Nyāya *pratyakṣa*; the same word carries a different doctrinal weight.

FACT: **Nyāya objection.** Perception through sense-contact is the paradigm of direct cognition. ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Sense-contact is direct only pragmatically; metaphysically it is mediated by organs, mind and knowledge-obscuring action-matter.

2. The five kinds of knowledge, exactly

Kind of knowledge	Status	Meaning	Examinable point
Sense-and-mind cognition (mati)	Indirect / conventional	Ordinary empirical cognition	Ordinary perception is not strict <i>pratyakṣa</i>
Verbal or scriptural knowledge (śruta)	Indirect	Sign-mediated knowledge derived from <i>mati</i>	Not blind faith; it depends on prior cognition and communication
Clairvoyant knowledge (avadhi)	Direct in the strict sense	Limited knowledge of material things beyond sense-range	Direct, but bounded
Knowledge of others' mental modes (manaḥparyāya)	Direct in the strict sense	Access to others' mental states	Higher than <i>avadhi</i> , still not omniscience
Omniscience (kevala)	Direct and complete	Unlimited, unmediated knowledge	The full overcoming of cognitive obstruction

FACT: **Argument:** *mati* and *śruta* are mediated and therefore indirect in the strict classification; *avadhi*, *manaḥparyāya* and *kevala* are direct because the soul knows without ordinary sense-and-mind mediation; the series maps a graded release from karmic veiling.

FACT: **Distinction that must be written.** The five kinds are **not** five *pramāṇas* in the Nyāya sense; they are Jaina modes of knowing indexed to bondage and purification.

FACT: **Cārvāka-style objection.** *Avadhi*, *manaḥparyāya* and *kevala* are unverifiable to ordinary experience.

ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Jainism treats them as necessary consequences of its soul-and-action-matter theory; a critic who rejects that ontology may still reject them, and an honest answer records this as an external, not internal, defeat.

3. Wrong cognition - where epistemology becomes ethics

FACT: **Statement.** Jainism recognises **kumati (mati-ajñāna)**, **kuśruta (śruta-ajñāna)** and **vibhaṅga-jñāna** as wrong cognition.

FACT: **Argument:**

1. Wrongness is not always mere absence of content.
2. Cognition becomes spiritually wrong when held under **wrong orientation (mithyā-darśana)**.
3. *Kumati* is misoriented sensory-mental cognition; *kuśruta* is misoriented verbal or scriptural cognition; *vibhaṅga-jñāna* is perverted clairvoyance.
4. ANALYSIS: The content may retain descriptive accuracy while its orientation remains false because it is governed by delusion.

FACT: **Example.** A learned person may quote doctrine accurately and use it for pride, sectarian contempt or violence; the verbal cognition then functions as *kuśruta*.

FACT: **Nyāya objection.** Calling a cognition wrong because of spiritual orientation confuses truth with moral psychology. ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Bondage affects the knower as a whole; epistemic correctness without right vision remains incomplete **for liberation**, which is the only standard Jainism is claiming to apply.

4. Later Jaina logic and the indirect means of valid knowledge

FACT: **Statement.** Jainism admits **inference (anumāna)** and **testimony (śabda)** within the indirect, and later Jaina logicians give a richer account of mediated knowing.

ANALYSIS: **Content:**

1. FACT: **Akalaṅka, Māṇikyanandi, Hemacandra and Yaśovijaya** are the names to cite for the developed tradition.
2. ANALYSIS: Later Jaina logicians accept **recollection (smṛti)**, **recognition (pratyabhijñā)**, **reasoning that grasps pervasion (tarka / ūha)** and **inference (anumāna)** as valid indirect knowledge in appropriate contexts.
3. FACT: This is a notable contrast with Nyāya, which does **not** treat memory as an independent means of valid knowledge.
4. ANALYSIS: The Jaina move protects continuity, recognition and inferential preparation as genuine cognitive achievements without inflating them into omniscience.

FACT: **Distinction.** Testimony is accepted as mediated knowledge, **not** as a creator-God's revelation; Jainism remains non-theistic about creation even while accepting scripture.

FACT: **Example.** "This is the same teacher I met earlier" is not raw perception; it involves memory and recognition working together.

FACT: **Nyāya objection.** Memory merely reproduces past cognition and is not a fresh means of knowledge.

ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Recollection and recognition can be valid cognition when they successfully connect present awareness with a real object or past experience.

5. The critical link: means of knowledge -> standpoint -> conditional assertion

FACT: This is the derivation that converts a good answer into a very good one.

1. FACT: Reality is *ananta-dharmātmakaṃ vastu*: the real object has innumerable aspects, properties and modes.
2. FACT: Ordinary human cognition is **kṣāyopaśamika**, arising from the partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring action-matter, and is therefore necessarily partial.
3. FACT: A judgement made by a non-omniscient knower captures an aspect, not the whole object.
4. FACT: A partial judgement is true relative to its standpoint: this is **standpoint theory (nayavāda)**.
5. FACT: Absolutising a partial standpoint yields **one-sidedness (ekāntavāda)**, which Jainism identifies as the root error of rival schools.
6. FACT: Therefore assertion must carry the operator **syāt**, "from a certain standpoint": this is **conditional predication (syādvāda)**.
7. FACT: The sevenfold schema is the disciplined expression of that standpoint-relativity: **saptabhaṅgī**.
8. FACT: Only **omniscience (kevala-jñāna)** grasps all aspects at once, because only omniscience is no longer karmically partial.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** Finite cognition is not false because it is partial; it becomes false when it claims unconditioned finality.

FACT: **Distinction.** Jaina relativity is **not** subjectivism: the aspects are really in the object, and the limitation is in the knower.

FACT: **Śaṃkara-style objection.** If all assertions are standpoint-relative, the assertion of standpoint-relativity loses absolute force. ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Jainism accepts reflexive qualification - *syādvāda* is itself asserted *syāt* - and locates its force in disciplined anti-absolutism rather than in an unqualified dogma. Session 7 examines whether that reply succeeds.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Jaina conditional predication is an epistemological consequence, not a rhetorical device. **Named evidence.** Ordinary cognition is *kṣāyopaśamika*, arising from partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring action-matter; ordinary perception is only *sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa*; and only *kevala-jñāna*, which follows the destruction of the obscuring karmas, grasps all aspects at once. **Analysis.** It follows that unconditioned assertion is available exclusively to omniscience, so a finite knower who drops the *syāt* operator is not being decisive but is claiming a cognitive status the system says he does not possess. **Qualification / link.** The argument therefore stands or falls with the ontology of soul and obscuring action-matter; a Cārvāka who denies omniscience will read the whole apparatus as an elaborate defence of unverifiable claims, which is why "critically examine" questions must state the internal success and the external vulnerability separately.

UPSC TRAPS IN THIS SUBTOPIC

1. WRONG: Calling ordinary perception *pratyakṣa* without qualification. FACT: It is *sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa*.
2. WRONG: Listing the five kinds of knowledge as five *pramāṇas*. FACT: They are graded modes of unveiling.
3. WRONG: Forgetting the false counterparts. FACT: *Kumati*, *kuśruta* and *vibhaṅga* are examinable.
4. WRONG: Saying Jainism rejects inference. FACT: It accepts inference and testimony as **indirect**.
5. WRONG: Missing the memory contrast. FACT: Later Jaina logic admits recollection and recognition; Nyāya does not.

RAPID REVISION

- Strict directness = no organ, no mind, no veil.
- Five kinds: *mati*, *śruta* (indirect); *avadhi*, *maṇaḥparyāya*, *kevala* (direct).
- Wrong cognition is orientation-relative, not merely content-relative.
- Later logic adds recollection, recognition and pervasion-grasping reasoning.
- The chain: innumerable aspects -> partial cognition -> standpoint -> *syāt* -> sevenfold schema.

EXAM APPLICATION - WHERE THIS IS ASKED

- **2023 Q5(a), 10 marks** - the "all human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative" prompt is answered *from* this session, by separating Jaina aspect-relativity from empiricist relativism.
- **2019 Q6(a), 20 marks** - the bridge from "reality" to "judgements" is the five-step derivation in section 5.
- **2022 Q6(b), 15 marks** - the absolutism charge is met by the *kevala-jñāna* clause established here.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | KNOWLEDGE - THE JAINA INVERSION AND THE FIVE KINDS OF KNOWING

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS direct (<i>pratyakṣa</i>) · indirect (<i>parokṣa</i>) · conventional direct knowledge (<i>sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa</i>) · <i>mati</i> · <i>śruta</i> · <i>avadhi</i> · <i>maṇaḥparyāya</i> · <i>kevala</i> · partial destruction-cum-subsidence (<i>kṣāyopaśamika</i>) · wrong orientation (<i>mithyā-darśana</i>)	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Because knowledge-obscuring action-matter is only partly removed in ordinary knowers, finite cognition grasps aspects rather than wholes, so unconditioned assertion is available only to omniscience.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Jaina directness is measured by absence of mediation rather than by sensory vividness, which is why ordinary perception is only conventionally direct and why the five kinds are not five Nyāya-style means of knowledge.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Never say Jainism rejects inference and never equate Jaina <i>pratyakṣa</i> with Nyāya <i>pratyakṣa</i> ; write <i>sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa</i> explicitly.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina conditional predication follows necessarily from a theory of knowledge in which ordinary cognition is karmically partial, so that only omniscience could ever make an unconditioned assertion.

SESSION 5 - STANDPOINT THEORY (*nayavāda*): THE SEVEN STANDPOINTS

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: A standpoint is a legitimate but partial way of looking at a thing. Jainism classifies the main ways in which people take such partial views, so that disagreement can be diagnosed instead of merely continued.

Technical definition: Standpoint theory (*nayavāda*) holds that every ordinary judgement expresses a *naya*, a determinate perspective that captures one aspect of a many-sided real; classical Jainism enumerates **seven**

standpoints, running from the practical and generic to the strictly verbal and function-conditioned.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

A standpoint is not an error but an unfinished truth: it becomes error only when it forgets its own conditions, and the sevenfold classification of standpoints exists precisely to make those conditions visible before a dispute hardens into dogma.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **standpoint theory (nayavāda); standpoint (naya)**
- **naigama, saṃgraha, vyavahāra, ṛjusūtra, śabda, samabhirūḍha, evambhūta**
- **one-sidedness (ekāntavāda) and wrong standpoint (durnaya / nayābhāsa)**
- **real standpoint (niścaya-naya) / conventional standpoint (vyavahāra-naya) - Kundakunda**
- **substance-directed (dravyārthika) / mode-directed (paryāyārthika)**

How to use them: name the standpoints in order, then group them (first three substance-directed and practical, last four increasingly verbal and mode-directed). Grouping shows understanding; a bare list shows recall.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

ONE MAN. FIVE TRUE DESCRIPTIONS. NO CONTRADICTION.

"He is a human being."	-> generic class view	(saṃgraha)
"He is this particular man."	-> practical, particular view	(vyavahāra)
"He is singing right now."	-> present-state view	(ṛjusūtra)
"He is called a singer."	-> the word used of him	(śabda)
"'Singer' means one who sings."	-> the word's exact sense	(samabhirūḍha)
"He is a singer ONLY while actually singing."	-> function-in-act view	(evambhūta)

Each is TRUE under its own condition.

Each becomes FALSE the moment it says: "and nothing else is true of him."

In simple words: the standpoints move from the loosest, most practical way of speaking to the strictest, most literal one. Nobody is lying; they are answering different questions. Jainism only objects when one of them claims to be the whole story.

Group	Standpoints	Character
Practical and substance-directed	<i>naigama, saṃgraha, vyavahāra</i>	Ordinary usage, class and particular
Temporal turn	<i>ṛjusūtra</i>	Restricts attention to the present state
Verbal and mode-directed	<i>śabda, samabhirūḍha, evambhūta</i>	Increasingly strict about words and actual function

One-line memory: partiality is not falsehood; absolutised partiality is.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE SEVEN STANDPOINTS AS A NARROWING FUNNEL

WIDEST, MOST PRACTICAL

+-----+		
1 naigama	mixed practical / purposive view; blends general and particular, often through intention	
+-----+		
2 saṃgraha	generic view; attends to shared class-character	
+-----+		
3 vyavahāra	practical particular view; ordinary dealings	
+-----+		
4 ṛjusūtra	present-state view; the thing as it now is	
+-----+		
5 śabda	verbal view; attends to the expression used	
+-----+		
6 samabhirūḍha	etymological view; distinct words, distinct sense	
+-----+		
7 evambhūta	function-in-act view; the term applies only while the named function is actually being performed	
+-----+		
NARROWEST, MOST LITERAL		

<- pivot:
substance-
directed
turns into
mode-
directed

ANY standpoint that denies the others becomes a WRONG standpoint (nayābhāsa).

ANALYSIS: **Caption.** The funnel makes the examinable structure visible: the first three are broadly substance-directed (*dravyārthika*), *ṛjusūtra* is the hinge, and the last three are verbal and mode-directed (*pariyāyārthika*). Answers that reproduce this movement rather than a flat list read as analysis.

1. Standpoint theory stated

FACT: **Statement.** *Nayavāda* teaches that every ordinary judgement expresses a **naya**, a standpoint that captures one aspect of the real.

FACT: **Argument:** reality is many-sided; finite knowers rarely grasp all sides at once; therefore judgements are aspectual rather than exhaustive; therefore a doctrine of standpoints is required to explain how partial truth is possible at all.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** Partiality is not falsehood; it becomes falsehood only when the partial is absolutised.

FACT: **Distinction.** *Nayavāda* is **not** scepticism. It permits truth - qualified truth.

FACT: **Example.** A jar may be described as clay, as container, as round, as breakable, as existing-now. Each statement is true from a standpoint.

FACT: **Nyāya-style objection.** Standpoints may proliferate without limit. ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Jaina thinkers classify the principal standpoints precisely in order to discipline discourse rather than dissolve it - which is why there is a canonical list of seven and not an open-ended set.

2. The seven standpoints, exactly

Standpoint	Brief meaning	Worked illustration
Naigama naya	Common, practical or purposive standpoint; a mixed, unspecialised view that blends general and particular, often through intention	Saying "I am cooking rice" while only fetching water, because the whole purposive act is meant
Samgraha naya	Generic standpoint; emphasis on class-character	"A jar is a substance" - the class swallows the particular
Vyavahāra naya	Practical or particular standpoint; ordinary usage about specific things	"Bring that jar" - the particular is what matters
Rjusūtra naya	Momentary or present-state standpoint	"He is happy" said of the present state only, without past or future
Śabda naya	Verbal standpoint; attention to the linguistic expression used	Treating a change of word as marking a change of meaning
Samabhirūḍha naya	Etymological standpoint; strictly differentiated verbal view	Refusing to treat two synonyms as fully interchangeable because their derivations differ
Evambhūta naya	Actuality-conditioned verbal standpoint; a term applies when the function is being performed	"Singer" applies only while singing is actually occurring

FACT: **Argument.** The list shows that partiality can arise from pragmatic, generic, particular, temporal and linguistic conditioning - five different sources of one-sidedness, not one.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** Language itself contributes to one-sidedness if its scope is not critically examined.

FACT: **Distinction that is directly examined.** Do **not** confuse the **seven standpoints** with the **sevenfold predication**. The former are epistemic perspectives; the latter are structured propositional forms. The numerical coincidence is a trap, not a correspondence.

FACT: **Examiner's objection.** The verbal standpoints look over-scholastic. ANALYSIS: **Reply.** They matter because a large class of philosophical disputes are verbal absolutisations of context-bound usage; the last three standpoints are a diagnostic instrument for exactly that failure.

3. The real and the conventional standpoint

FACT: **Statement.** Kundakunda, the Digambara author associated with the *Samayasāra*, is standardly cited for the contrast between the **real standpoint (nīścaya-naya)** and the **conventional standpoint (vyavahāra-naya)**.

ANALYSIS: **Use.** The real standpoint describes the soul in its own intrinsic nature; the conventional standpoint describes it as embodied, active and karmically conditioned. Both are required: the first states what liberation restores, the second states what bondage does. Cite the pair when a question asks how the soul can be described both as pure and as bound.

FACT: **Cross-check.** The substance-directed / mode-directed pair (*dravyārthika* / *pariyāyārthika*) performs a similar service at the level of the object: the first attends to the enduring bearer, the second to changing states.

4. Standpoint and its perversion

FACT: A standpoint that asserts its own content **and** denies the remaining aspects ceases to be a *naya* and becomes a **wrong standpoint (nayābhāsa / durnaya)**. This is the technical form of **one-sidedness (ekāntavāda)**, which Jainism identifies as the shared defect of rival schools:

Rival position	Absolutised standpoint	Jaina diagnosis
Strong permanence-monism	Substance-directed view taken absolutely	Change becomes appearance
Buddhist momentariness	Present-state view (<i>rjusūtra</i>) taken absolutely	Identity becomes fiction
Extreme nominalism	Verbal standpoints taken absolutely	The object dissolves into usage
Naive generic realism	Generic view (<i>saṃgraha</i>) taken absolutely	Particulars become dispensable

ANALYSIS: Answer use. This table converts "Jainism criticises other schools" from an assertion into a diagnosis: each rival is charged with elevating one legitimate standpoint into an exclusive one.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Standpoint theory is a diagnostic instrument, not an invitation to indecision. **Named evidence.** The canonical seven run *naigama*, *saṃgraha*, *vyavahāra*, *rjusūtra*, *śabda*, *samabhirūḍha* and *evambhūta*; Kundakunda's *Samayasāra* supplies the real and conventional standpoints; and a standpoint that denies the rest is technically reclassified as *nayābhāsa*. **Analysis.** Because each rival school can be shown to have absolutised one member of that list - momentariness the present-state view, permanence-monism the substance-directed view - the Jaina critique of others becomes a single repeatable argument rather than a series of unconnected complaints. **Qualification / link.** The instrument is only as good as the classification, and a critic may reasonably ask why exactly seven standpoints are canonical rather than five or nine; the Jaina answer is pragmatic and pedagogical, so the doctrine should be defended as disciplining discourse rather than as exhausting it.

UPSC TRAPS IN THIS SUBTOPIC

1. WRONG: "Seven *nayas* = seven *bhaṅgas*." FACT: Perspectives versus propositional forms; never merge them.
2. WRONG: Presenting *naya* as opinion. FACT: A *naya* is a conditioned truth-claim about a real aspect.
3. WRONG: Ignoring *nayābhāsa*. FACT: The perversion of a standpoint is the technical name of one-sidedness.
4. WRONG: Dropping *evambhūta*. FACT: It is the strictest standpoint and the most quotable illustration.
5. WRONG: Treating *nīścaya* / *vyavahāra* as Advaita's two truths. FACT: Both remain standpoints on **one real** soul, with no sublation.

RAPID REVISION

- Seven standpoints, in order, with the funnel from practical to function-in-act.
- First three substance-directed; *rjusūtra* the hinge; last three verbal and mode-directed.
- *Nayābhāsa* = standpoint plus denial of the rest.
- Kundakunda: real and conventional standpoints for the soul.
- Standpoints ≠ predications.

EXAM APPLICATION - WHERE THIS IS ASKED

- **2021 Q7(c), 15 marks** - "Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (sapta-bhaṅgī) 'Naya'." The printed wording fuses the two doctrines, so the answer must **explain both** and expressly distinguish them.
- **2019 Q6(a), 20 marks** - standpoints are the middle term between reality and judgement.
- **2022 Q6(b), 15 marks** - the relativism charge is stated at the level of standpoints before it reaches predication.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | STANDPOINT THEORY - THE SEVEN STANDPOINTS

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS standpoint theory (<i>nayavāda</i>) · <i>naigama</i> · <i>saṃgraha</i> · <i>vyavahāra</i> · <i>rjusūtra</i> · <i>śabda</i> · <i>samabhirūḍha</i> · <i>evambhūta</i> · wrong standpoint (<i>nayābhāsa</i>) · real and conventional standpoints (<i>nīścaya-naya</i> , <i>vyavahāra-naya</i>)	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Partiality arises from pragmatic, generic, particular, temporal and linguistic conditioning, so the canonical seven standpoints classify the main routes by which a true aspect becomes an exclusive claim.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Rival schools are diagnosed rather than merely opposed, because momentariness absolutises the present-state standpoint while permanence-monism absolutises the substance-directed standpoint.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE The 2021 question prints seven-fold and <i>naya</i> together, so distinguish standpoints from predications explicitly instead of assuming the paper has merged them correctly.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: A standpoint is not an error but an unfinished truth, and it becomes error only when it forgets its own conditions, which is exactly what the sevenfold classification of standpoints is designed to prevent.

SESSION 6 - CONDITIONAL PREDICATION (syādvāda) AND THE SEVENFOLD PREDICATION (saptabhaṅgī)

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Since every judgement is made from a standpoint, every assertion should carry a marker saying "in this respect". Combining assertion, denial and inexpressibility under that marker yields exactly seven possible forms.

Technical definition: Conditional predication (syādvāda) is the doctrine that assertions must be qualified by the operator **syāt** - "in some respect", "from a certain standpoint" - and the **sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgi)** is the exhaustive schema generated by combining affirmation, negation and inexpressibility (*avaktavya*) under that operator.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The particle *syāt* is not a hedge but an index: it states the respect, substance, place, time and mode under which a predication holds, so that the seven forms of Jaina judgement record conditions of truth rather than degrees of doubt.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **conditional predication (syādvāda)**; the operator **syāt**
- **sevenfold predication (saptabhaṅgī)**; **bhaṅga** (mode of predication)
- **inexpressible (avaktavya)**
- the four indices: **substance (dravya) · place (kṣetra) · time (kāla) · mode (bhāva)**
- **own-form (svarūpa) / other-form (pararūpa)**

How to use them: write the four indices early. They are the technical device that blocks the contradiction charge, and most scripts never mention them.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

THE CLAY JAR ON THE TABLE

"The jar EXISTS." -> as clay, on this table, now, in jar-shape = syād asti

"The jar DOES NOT EXIST."
-> as gold, in another room, yesterday,
as a lump = syād nāsti

The two sentences never meet, because the four indices differ:

SUBSTANCE (dravya) : clay, not gold
PLACE (kṣetra) : this table, not that room
TIME (kāla) : now, not yesterday
MODE (bhāva) : jar-shape, not lump-shape

Contradiction needs SAME respect, SAME time, SAME sense.
syāt guarantees that this never happens.

In simple words: the Jaina is not saying "the jar sort of exists". He is saying "the jar definitely exists **as this**, and definitely does not exist **as that**", and he is putting the conditions on the record instead of hiding them.

Trap	Correct reading
<i>syāt</i> = "perhaps"	WRONG: No. It is a definite assertion restricted by standpoint
<i>syādvāda</i> = scepticism	WRONG: No. Scepticism withholds; <i>syādvāda</i> asserts with an index
<i>avaktavya</i> = mystical silence	WRONG: No. It marks failure of simultaneous unqualified expression
Seven forms = seven truth-values	WRONG: No. One truth, seven conditioned formulations

One-line memory: *syāt* fixes the respect; the seven *bhaṅgas* exhaust the combinations.

VISUAL: VISUAL - HOW SEVEN, AND ONLY SEVEN, FORMS ARISE

THREE BASIC MOVES

=====

[1] affirm	asti
[2] deny	nāsti
[4] inexpressible	avaktavya

COMBINATION LOGIC

=====

simple:	1 2 4	-> 3 forms
pair-wise:	1+2, 1+4, 2+4	-> 3 forms
all three:	1+2+4	-> 1 form
		TOTAL 7

1. syād asti	in some respect, it IS
2. syād nāsti	in some respect, it IS NOT
3. syād asti ca nāsti ca	in some respect it is AND is not (successively)
4. syād avaktavyam	in some respect it is INEXPRESSIBLE
5. syād asti ca avaktavyam	it is, and is inexpressible
6. syād nāsti ca avaktavyam	it is not, and is inexpressible
7. syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam ca	it is, is not, and is inexpressible

WHY SEVEN? three primitives taken singly, in pairs, and all together
= 3 + 3 + 1 = 7. Not an arbitrary number, and not extendable.

ANALYSIS: Caption. The combinatorial derivation is the difference between reciting the list and explaining it. Note the internal logic of forms 3 and 4: form 3 asserts existence and non-existence **successively**, under different indices; form 4 arises when both are demanded **simultaneously and without qualification**, at which point language cannot deliver a single unqualified predicate.

1. Conditional predication stated

FACT: Statement. *Syādvāda* is the doctrine that assertions should be made with the qualification **syāt** - "in some respect", "from a certain standpoint", "conditionally".

FACT: Translation trap, stated in full because it is repeatedly examined. Although *syāt* can literally suggest "perhaps" or "may be", it does **not** express probability, doubt, agnosticism or scepticism here. It marks a **definite** assertion restricted by standpoint, substance, place, time and mode. "The jar conditionally exists" is not a guess that the jar probably exists.

FACT: Argument:

1. Since reality is many-sided, categorical assertion is risky.
2. Since judgements arise from standpoints, language must register conditionality.
3. The particle *syāt* prevents absolutisation.
4. Hence *syādvāda* is the logical-linguistic expression of many-sidedness.

FACT: Distinction to write verbatim. Many-sidedness = **metaphysical** doctrine; standpoint theory = theory of **perspectives**; conditional predication = mode of **assertion**; sevenfold predication = the **formal schema** of that assertion.

FACT: Śaṃkara-style objection. Constant qualification weakens assertoric force. **ANALYSIS: Reply.** Jaina logic accepts that precision is preferable to dogmatic simplicity; and the qualification is informative, since it specifies *which* respect is in play.

2. The seven predications, exactly and in order

FACT: Statement. The *saptabhaṅgī* is the sevenfold schema of conditional predication produced by combining affirmation, negation and inexpressibility under the operator *syāt*.

1. **syād asti** - in some respect, it is.
2. **syād nāsti** - in some respect, it is not.
3. **syād asti ca nāsti ca** - in some respect, it is and it is not.
4. **syād avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is inexpressible.
5. **syād asti ca avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is and is inexpressible.
6. **syād nāsti ca avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is not and is inexpressible.
7. **syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam** - in some respect, it is, is not, and is inexpressible.

FACT: Argument: a thing may be affirmed under one standpoint; negated under another; both affirmed and negated under different references or times; called inexpressible where simultaneous exhaustive predication fails; and

combinations of these yield seven basic structured forms.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** Contraries need not violate logic when they are indexed to standpoint, time, relation or mode.

FACT: **Distinction.** "Inexpressible" does **not** mean mystical silence simpliciter. It means that an unqualified or simultaneous statement is not straightforwardly expressible.

FACT: **Example.** A clay jar exists now on the table; it does not exist as a lump of raw clay; it both is and is not under different modal descriptions; and in a complex state of transition it may be called *avaktavya*.

3. The four indices and the answer to the contradiction charge

FACT: Opposed predicates are indexed to four determinants:

Index	Sanskrit	What it fixes	Jar illustration
Substance	dravya	The material or kind under which the claim is made	It is clay; it is not gold
Place	kṣetra	The location relative to which it holds	It is on this table; it is not in that room
Time	kāla	The temporal reference	It is now; it was not yesterday
Mode	bhāva	The state or form	It is jar-shaped; it is not lump-shaped

FACT: **The formal reply.** Contradiction would arise only if affirmation and negation were made in the **same respect**, at the **same time**, in the **same sense**. The operator *syāt* blocks precisely that reading. Existence is asserted of the thing in its **own-form (svarūpa)**; non-existence is asserted of it in **other-form (pararūpa)**.

FACT: **Named critics.** Śaṅkara in the *Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya* and Rāmānuja both press the charge that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way. Session 7 develops those critiques and the Jaina replies in full.

4. The blind men and the elephant - what the parable does and does not prove

FACT: **Statement.** The familiar illustration captures the spirit of many-sidedness: each grasped part yields a partial truth wrongly elevated into a whole truth.

ANALYSIS: **What it dramatises.** The difference between **partial correctness** and **exclusive completeness**.

FACT: **Distinction.** The parable illustrates non-absolutism; it is **not** the formal doctrine, and it does not by itself establish that aspects are objectively in the elephant.

FACT: **Example.** One touches the trunk and says "the elephant is like a serpent"; another the leg and says "like a pillar". Each is conditionally right and absolutely wrong.

FACT: **Pedagogical objection.** The parable trivialises complex metaphysics. ANALYSIS: **Reply.** It is pedagogical, not probative; use it for one sentence to clarify the structure of partial truth, then return to the four indices for the argument.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The sevenfold predication is a completeness result about qualified assertion, not a licence for contradiction. **Named evidence.** Three primitives - affirmation, negation and inexpressibility - taken singly, pairwise and jointly yield exactly $3 + 3 + 1 = 7$ forms; each is governed by the operator *syāt*; and the indices of substance, place, time and mode fix the respect, so that existence is predicated in own-form and non-existence in other-form. **Analysis.** Because the indices differ in every pair of opposed predications, the schema never asserts *p* and not-*p* in the same respect, which means the classical charge of violating non-contradiction misdescribes the doctrine before evaluating it. **Qualification / link.** The defence secures consistency but not comfort: Śaṅkara can still object that a doctrine which qualifies even itself has surrendered unconditional assertoric force, so a "critically examine" answer must concede that the Jaina buys logical safety at the price of assertoric strength.

UPSC TRAPS IN THIS SUBTOPIC

1. WRONG: Translating *syāt* as "perhaps". FACT: It is a standpoint operator, not a probability marker.
2. WRONG: Giving six or eight *bhaṅgas*, or the wrong fourth. FACT: The fourth is **syād avaktavyam**.

3. **WRONG:** Treating *avaktavya* as a third truth-value. **FACT:** It marks inexpressibility under a simultaneous unqualified demand.
4. **WRONG:** Omitting the four indices. **FACT:** Without them the contradiction charge cannot be answered.
5. **WRONG:** Leading with the elephant parable. **FACT:** Use it once, briefly, after the formal account.

RAPID REVISION

- *syāt* = definite assertion **plus** stated respect.
- Seven forms: 3 simple + 3 pairwise + 1 joint.
- Fourth form is inexpressibility, not the conjunction.
- Four indices: substance, place, time, mode.
- Own-form affirms; other-form denies.

EXAM APPLICATION - WHERE THIS IS ASKED

- **2021 Q7(c), 15 marks** - reproduce all seven in order, then distinguish them from the seven standpoints.
- **2023 Q5(a), 10 marks** - the sevenfold judgement is examined against the claim that all knowledge is empirical and therefore relative.
- **2019 Q6(a), 20 marks** - this is the "view on judgements" half of the question.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | CONDITIONAL PREDICATION AND THE SEVENFOLD PREDICATION

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS conditional predication (<i>syādvāda</i>) · operator <i>syāt</i> · sevenfold predication (<i>saptabhaṅgī</i>) · inexpressible (<i>avaktavya</i>) · indices of substance, place, time and mode · own-form (<i>svarūpa</i>) and other-form (<i>pararūpa</i>)	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Three primitives of affirmation, negation and inexpressibility taken singly, pairwise and jointly generate exactly seven forms, each governed by an operator that states the respect in which the predication holds.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST Because opposed predications differ in substance, place, time or mode, the schema never affirms and denies in the same respect, so the classical non-contradiction charge misdescribes the doctrine.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Never translate <i>syāt</i> as perhaps and never present <i>avaktavya</i> as a third truth-value; state the four indices explicitly, because that is what answers Śaṃkara.
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ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The particle *syāt* is an index rather than a hedge, stating the substance, place, time and mode under which a predication holds, so the seven forms record conditions of truth rather than degrees of doubt.

SESSION 7 - EVALUATING NON-ABSOLUTISM: SELF-REFUTATION, THE ABSOLUTISM CHARGE, AND THE PLURALIST-REALIST VERDICT

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Critics say the Jaina position destroys itself: if everything must be qualified, then the doctrine of qualification must also be qualified, and then it says nothing definite. This session works out whether that objection succeeds.

Technical definition: The reflexivity problem asks whether *anekāntavāda* can be asserted without self-exemption; the absolutism charge, printed in 2022, asks whether non-absolutism covertly presupposes an absolute standpoint; and the classification question, printed in 2025, asks whether Jainism is properly described as pluralistic and realistic.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jaina non-absolutism survives the self-refutation charge by paying a price it can afford and refusing one it cannot: it accepts that its own thesis is standpoint-qualified, but it denies that qualification means indeterminacy, because the aspects being qualified are objectively in the thing.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

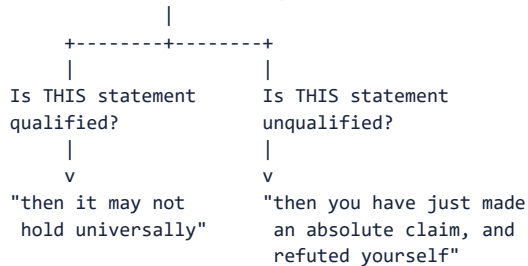
- **self-refutation charge; reflexive qualification**
- **relativism versus non-absolutism**
- **omniscience (*kevala-jñāna*)** as the internal reference point
- **ontological realism / epistemic non-absolutism**
- **qualified realism**

How to use them: separate the two halves of every criticism - the *logical* half about consistency and the *epistemic* half about assertoric force. Jainism answers the first decisively and the second only partially, and saying so is what "critically" rewards.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

THE CRITIC'S DILEMMA

"All statements must be qualified."



THE JAINA WALKS THROUGH THE LEFT HORN, NOT AROUND IT:

yes, it is qualified -- and a qualified thesis can still be TRUE, INFORMATIVE and BINDING, because what it qualifies is a real many-sidedness.

In simple words: the Jaina does not try to sneak one unqualified statement past his own rule. He accepts the rule for himself and then denies the critic's hidden assumption that a qualified claim must be a weak claim.

Half of the objection	Jaina outcome
Logical: does the doctrine contradict itself?	FACT: Answered: reflexive qualification is consistent
Epistemic: does it retain full assertoric force?	ANALYSIS: Contested: critics say force is diluted
Ontological: does relativity make objects unreal?	FACT: Answered: aspects are in the object

One-line memory: the doctrine obeys its own rule, and that obedience is its defence, not its defeat.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE THREE EXAMINED CHALLENGES SIDE BY SIDE

CHALLENGE A self-refutation / triviality	CHALLENGE B "relativism needs absolutism" (2022)	CHALLENGE C "is Jainism pluralistic and realistic?" (2025)
↓	↓	↓
if qualified, weak; if unqualified, inconsistent; if merely "views differ", trivial	universal scope looks absolute, so the doctrine seems to lean on what it attacks	plural: many souls, many substances realist: objects exist independently of our standpoints
↓	↓	↓
JAINA REPLY: accept reflexive qualification; deny that aspect-conditioned truth is the same as equal truth	JAINA REPLY: it denies ONE-SIDED EXCLUSIVISM by finite knowers, not graded comprehensiveness; omniscience (kevala-jñāna) is the internal limit-case, not a rival absolute	VERDICT: strongly pluralistic, and REALIST IN A QUALIFIED sense

ANALYSIS: Caption. The three challenges are not variants of one complaint. A dissects consistency, B dissects presupposition, and C demands a classification. Scripts that answer all three with the same paragraph lose the discrimination marks.

1. Challenge A - is many-sidedness self-refuting or trivial?

FACT: Statement. Critics argue **either** that *anekāntavāda* is self-refuting, because the claim that "all reality is many-sided" is itself made absolutely, **or** that it is trivial, because everyone already admits contextual variation.

FACT: The critic's argument, in four steps:

1. If every assertion must be qualified, the doctrine itself must be qualified.
2. If qualified, it may lose universal force.
3. If unqualified, it violates its own rule.

4. Alternatively, if it merely says that things can be looked at in different ways, it is philosophically thin.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** A doctrine of relativity must be able to explain its own status.

FACT: **The Jaina reply, in four steps:**

1. Jainism need not deny that the doctrine itself is expressible from a standpoint.
2. This does not collapse it; it exhibits the very discipline it teaches.
3. The thesis is **not** that all statements are equally true, but that truth is aspect-conditioned.
4. Its philosophical bite lies in reconciling plurality with realism, not in banal relativism.

ANALYSIS: **Honest assessment.** The consistency charge is answered. The triviality charge is answered only if the candidate shows the *work* the doctrine does - namely holding permanence and change together, and diagnosing rival schools as absolutised standpoints. Without that demonstration, the triviality charge has real force.

2. Challenge B - does non-absolutism presuppose absolutism? (2022, 15 marks)

ANALYSIS: **Statement of the challenge.** To say that reality is many-sided, one must already know absolutely that it is so; therefore *anekāntavāda* covertly presupposes absolutism.

FACT: **The challenge, formalised:**

1. The doctrine claims universal scope.
2. Universal scope appears absolute.
3. Therefore the doctrine seems to rely on the very absolutism it criticises.

FACT: **The Jaina reply, formalised:**

1. Non-absolutism does not deny more comprehensive knowledge; it denies **one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers**.
2. The doctrine is a methodological and ontological caution against *ekānta*, not a ban on all graded comprehensiveness.
3. Within Jainism, **omniscience (kevala-jñāna)** represents total knowledge, while ordinary discourse remains standpoint-bound.
4. Hence the charge succeeds only if one confuses finite judgement with omniscient cognition.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** This is a subtle and strong reply: Jainism can admit a difference between omniscience and ordinary language without abandoning its critique of dogmatic partiality. ANALYSIS: The residue is that the reply relocates rather than removes the absolute: the omniscient standpoint now carries the unconditioned status that finite discourse is denied, and a critic may press that this is exactly what the objection alleged. State both, and then give a graded verdict.

3. Challenge C - is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? (2025, 15 marks)

ANALYSIS: **Statement.** Yes, Jainism is strongly **pluralistic** and broadly **realistic**, though both labels require nuance.

FACT: **Why pluralistic:**

1. It accepts many real souls.
2. It accepts multiple irreducible substances.
3. It rejects monistic reduction.
4. Liberation is of many individual souls, not absorption into one absolute.

FACT: **Why realistic:**

1. It treats substances, qualities and modes as objectively real.
2. The external world is not illusion.
3. Knowledge aims at real objects, though only under standpoints.

ANALYSIS: **The necessary nuance.** Its realism is **qualified realism**, because judgement is standpoint-indexed. But qualification of *knowledge* does not imply unreality of the *object* - and that sentence is the hinge of the whole answer.

FACT: **Realist objection.** If all knowledge is relative to standpoint, realism weakens. ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Jainism separates **ontological realism** from **epistemic non-absolutism**: reality is objective, but finite access to it is partial.

Axis	Jaina position	Label earned
Number of ultimate reals	Many souls, six substances	Strong pluralism FACT:
Status of the external world	Real, not appearance	Realism FACT:
Status of aspects	Objectively in the thing	Aspect-realism FACT:
Status of finite judgement	Standpoint-indexed	Non-absolutism, hence qualified realism ANALYSIS:
Status of the omniscient standpoint	Unconditioned, internal to the system	Residual pressure from Challenge B ANALYSIS:

4. The graded verdict to close any critical question

Strong FACT:

1. Jainism gives one of the clearest Indian accounts of how permanence and change can both be real.
2. Many-sidedness, standpoint theory and conditional predication form a disciplined sequence from ontology to epistemology to language.
3. Its material action-matter doctrine makes ethics causally serious and connects metaphysics with ascetic practice.
4. Its non-violence follows directly from plural souls and karmic bondage, not from sentiment alone.

Weak ANALYSIS:

1. Material action-matter binding a conscious soul remains difficult for non-Jaina metaphysics.
2. Omniscience and the higher direct knowledges are hard to verify externally.
3. The system can appear over-taxonomic in karma-types, stages and standpoints.
4. Reflexively qualified conditional predication may appear to weaken its own universal claim.

Genuinely contested CAUTION:

1. Sectarian nuances about the substantial independence of time differ in presentation.
2. Modern legal-ethical evaluation of *sallekhanā* requires case-specific verification before any detail is cited.
3. Historical dating of several Jaina thinkers should not be asserted without a separate source.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The absolutism charge fails as stated but succeeds in a weaker, more interesting form. **Named evidence.** The 2022 paper prints the claim that Jaina relativism "cannot be logically sustained without postulating absolutism"; the Jaina reply distinguishes finite standpoint-bound judgement from *kevala-jñāna*, which grasps all aspects at once because knowledge-obscuring karma has been destroyed. **Analysis.** Since the doctrine denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers rather than denying comprehensiveness as such, the charge as printed equivocates between two senses of "absolute", and once the equivocation is removed the alleged self-contradiction disappears. **Qualification / link.** What survives is a genuine cost rather than a contradiction: the unconditioned status has been relocated to omniscience, so a candidate should conclude that Jainism is consistent but not standpoint-free, which is precisely the graded verdict the directive "critically examine" is asking for.

UPSC TRAPS IN THIS SUBTOPIC

1. WRONG: Answering 2022 by simply asserting that *syādvāda* is not relativism. FACT: Engage the printed claim and locate the equivocation.
2. WRONG: Treating "relativism" and "non-absolutism" as synonyms. FACT: Relativism relativises truth; non-absolutism relativises exclusive claims.
3. WRONG: Declaring Jainism realist without the qualification. FACT: Say "qualified realism" and explain the qualifier.
4. WRONG: Ignoring omniscience in the 2022 answer. FACT: It is the pivot of the reply and the site of the residual objection.
5. WRONG: Ending with summary rather than verdict. FACT: Critical directives demand a graded judgement.

RAPID REVISION

- Three distinct challenges: consistency, presupposition, classification.
- Reflexive qualification is a feature, not a bug.
- *Kevala-jñāna* answers 2022 and simultaneously creates its residue.
- Ontological realism ≠ epistemic absolutism.
- Close every critical answer with strong / weak / contested.

EXAM APPLICATION - WHERE THIS IS ASKED

- **2022 Q6(b), 15 marks** - the absolutism charge, verbatim.
- **2025 Q7(c), 15 marks** - pluralistic and realistic, critically discussed.
- **2023 Q5(a), 10 marks** - the empiricist-relativist framing is defused by the same distinction.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | EVALUATING NON-ABSOLUTISM - SELF-REFUTATION, ABSOLUTISM AND THE PLURALIST-REALIST VERDICT

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

self-refutation charge · reflexive qualification · one-sidedness (ekāntavāda) · omniscience (kevala-jñāna) · ontological realism versus epistemic non-absolutism · qualified realism

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

The doctrine accepts that it is itself standpoint-qualified and then denies the critic's hidden premise that a qualified claim must be indeterminate, because the aspects being qualified are objectively in the thing.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

The consistency charge fails, but the unconditioned status is relocated to omniscience rather than abolished, so the honest verdict is consistency without standpoint-freedom.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Do not equate relativism with non-absolutism and do not call Jainism realist without the qualifier; engage the printed 2022 wording instead of restating the doctrine.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jaina non-absolutism survives the self-refutation charge because it accepts that its own thesis is standpoint-qualified while denying that qualification means indeterminacy, since the aspects being qualified are objectively in the thing.

SESSION 8 - BONDAGE: ACTION-MATTER AS SUBTLE MATTER, AND THE MECHANICS OF ADHESION

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: In Jainism the moral residue of action is not a book-entry or an invisible force; it is extremely fine matter that is actually drawn to the soul and sticks to it, and the stickiness is supplied by the passions.

Technical definition: Action and moral consequence (karma) is a form of matter (*pudgala*): psychical action-matter (*bhāva-karma*) attracts material action-matter (*dravya-karma*), producing **psychic bondage** (*bhāvabandha*) and **material bondage** (*dravyabandha*) analysed under four parameters - type (*prakṛti*), duration (*sthiti*), intensity (*anubhāga / rasa*) and quantity (*pradeśa*).

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

The originality of Jaina soteriology lies in treating action and moral consequence not merely as a moral record but as subtle material bondage, so that liberation requires both the stoppage of fresh influx and the shedding of what has already adhered.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- material action-matter (karma-pudgala); psychical (bhāva-karma) / material (dravya-karma)
- influx (āsrava) -> bondage (bandha) -> stoppage (saṃvara) -> shedding (nirjarā) -> liberation (mokṣa)
- psychic bondage (bhāvabandha) / material bondage (dravyabandha)
- five causes: wrong vision (mithyātva), non-restraint (avirati), carelessness (pramāda), passions (kaṣāya), activity (yoga)
- eight karma-types (karma-prakṛti); destructive (ghātiyā) / non-destructive (aghātiyā)
- momentary bondage (īryāpathika) / durable bondage (sāmparāyika)

How to use them: never write "karma" alone in a Jainism answer. Write **material action-matter** and then immediately distinguish it from Nyāya's *adṛṣṭa*, Mīmāṃsā's *apūrva*, Sāṃkhya's *saṃskāra* and Buddhist *vāsanā*. That single contrast is worth more than a paragraph of description.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

A DRY CLOTH AND AN OILED CLOTH ARE WAVED IN THE SAME DUSTY ROOM.

dust in the room = fine karmic matter, everywhere available
 waving the cloth = ACTIVITY of body, speech and mind (yoga)
 the oil on the cloth = PASSIONS: anger, pride, deceit, greed (kaṣāya)

DRY CLOTH -> dust touches, does not hold -> momentary bondage (īryāpathika)
 OILED CLOTH -> dust sticks, deeply and long -> durable bondage (sāmparāyika)

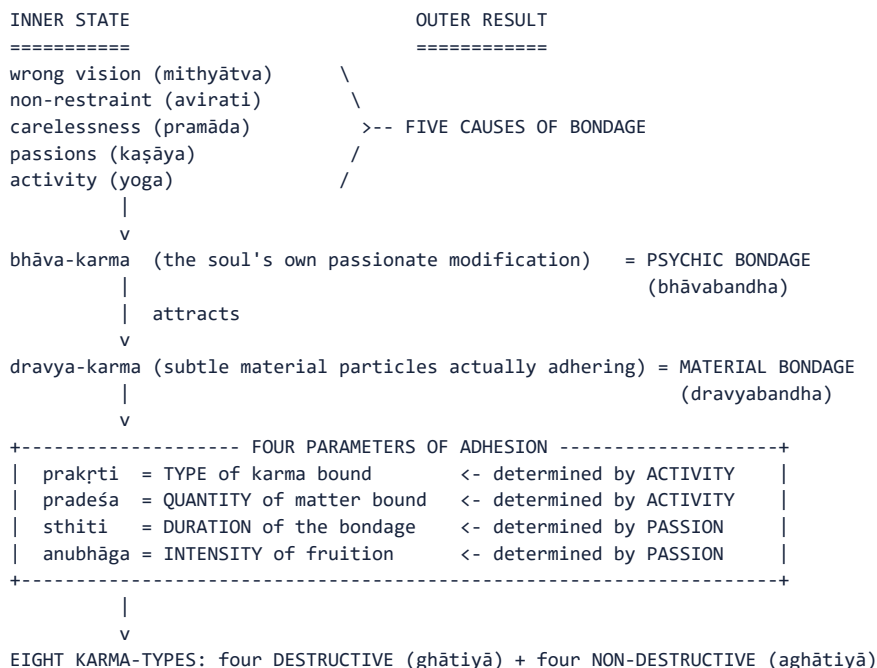
HOW MUCH dust arrives -> decided by the WAVING (activity)
 HOW LONG and HOW HARD it clings -> decided by the OIL (passion)

In simple words: activity opens the channel and determines how much matter arrives; passion determines how long it stays and how strongly it will fruit. This is why a Jain monk's careful walking binds only momentarily while an angry act binds deeply.

Term	Easy meaning
<i>āsrava</i>	Influx - karmic matter flowing toward the soul
<i>bandha</i>	Bondage - that matter actually adhering
<i>saṃvara</i>	Stoppage - closing the channel of fresh influx
<i>nirjarā</i>	Shedding - wearing away what has already adhered
<i>mokṣa</i>	Liberation - no karmic matter left at all

One-line memory: activity brings the dust; passion supplies the glue.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE COMPLETE BONDAGE MACHINE



ANALYSIS: Caption. Two divisions of labour are the examinable core. First, the inner state precedes and shapes the outer adhesion, which is why Jainism is not crude physicalism. Second, activity fixes *type and quantity* while passion fixes *duration and intensity* - the single most frequently mis-stated pairing in Jainism answers.

1. Action and moral consequence as subtle material substance

FACT: Statement. Jainism's distinctive thesis is that **action and moral consequence (karma) is a subtle material substance**, a form of matter (*pudgala*) that flows toward and binds the soul.

FACT: Argument:

1. The soul's intrinsic omniscience is obscured in empirical life.

2. That obscuration requires a real binding factor.
3. The factor is action-matter, conceived not merely as moral tendency but as fine material accretion.
4. Thus bondage is ontologically real, not merely metaphorical.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** Ethical and cognitive defilement must have a concrete causal structure.

FACT: **The trap that decides marks.** In Jainism action-matter is **material**, unlike presentations in which action-consequence is a moral force, a merit-demerit ledger or an unseen potency:

School	Name of the moral residue	Ontological status
Jainism	<i>karma-pudgala</i>	FACT: Subtle matter that adheres to the soul
Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika	<i>adr̥ṣṭa</i>	Unseen quality of the self, not matter
Mīmāṃsā	<i>apūrva</i>	Unseen potency linking ritual act and result
Sāṃkhya-Yoga	<i>saṃskāra</i>	Dispositional trace within <i>prakṛti</i>
Buddhism	<i>vāsanā</i>	Mental-causal impression, no material particle

FACT: **Nyāya-Vedānta objection.** How can matter bind a conscious, immaterial soul? ANALYSIS: **Reply.** The embodied soul is not absolutely non-spatial: it has space-points (*pradeśa*), is co-extensive with the body, and is modified by psychical action-matter; karmic matter is attracted through the passions. ANALYSIS: A residual difficulty remains, because interaction between consciousness and matter still demands explanation - and an honest answer says so.

2. The five causes of bondage

Cause	Sanskrit	Role
Wrong vision	mithyātva / mithyā-darśana	Misapprehends soul, reality and the path
Non-restraint	avirati	Leaves conduct exposed to harmful desire and action
Carelessness	pramāda	Weakens vigilance even where doctrine is known
Passions	kaṣāya	Anger, pride, deceit and greed make adhesion deep and durable
Activity	yoga	Activity of body, speech and mind opens the channel of influx

ANALYSIS: **Causal ordering, which is the analytical point.** Wrong vision and ignorance sustain the passions; activity supplies the influx-channel; passion supplies the stickiness. This prevents the material account from becoming crude physicalism: **psychical disposition determines the depth and duration of material bondage.**

3. Psychic and material bondage (2024, 15 marks)

FACT: **Statement.** Bondage has two closely related forms: **psychic bondage (bhāva-bandha)** and **material bondage (dravya-bandha)**.

FACT: **Argument:**

1. The soul first undergoes affective-volitional corruption through passion, attachment, aversion, delusion and wrong disposition.
2. This inner deformation is *bhāva-bandha*.
3. Corresponding karmic particles then attach materially to the soul.
4. This actual material adhesion is *dravya-bandha*.
5. Thus psychic and material bondage are distinct yet interlinked.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** Inner states are causally efficacious; moral psychology precedes material karmic accretion.

FACT: **Distinction to write in exactly this form:**

- **bhāva-bandha** = subjective, intentional, affective bondage - a **modification of the soul**.
- **dravya-bandha** = objective, material bondage by karmic matter - an **adhesion of matter**.

FACT: **Example.** Anger or greed in the soul is *bhāvabandha*; the karmic matter drawn and fixed by that passion is *dravyabandha*.

FACT: **Analytical objection.** Why not collapse them into one process? FACT: **Reply.** The distinction lets Jainism explain **both** moral agency and ontological consequence: one is the soul's state, the other is the karmic material result. Collapse them and either the ethics or the ontology is lost.

4. The fivefold soteriological sequence

Stage	Meaning
Influx (<i>āsrava</i>)	Karmic matter flows toward the soul
Bondage (<i>bandha</i>)	Karmic matter adheres to the soul
Stoppage (<i>saṃvara</i>)	Fresh inflow is blocked
Shedding (<i>nirjarā</i>)	Accumulated karma is worn away or exhausted
Liberation (<i>mokṣa</i>)	Complete release from all karma

FACT: **Argument:** wrong belief, passion and activity open the soul to influx; influx produces bondage; discipline blocks new inflow; austerity and purification burn off old karma; when all karmic matter is gone, liberation occurs.

FACT: **Distinction, examined repeatedly.** *Saṃvara* and *nirjarā* are **not** the same: one stops new karma, the other removes old karma.

FACT: **Example.** Damming a muddy stream that feeds a tank is like stoppage; dredging the sediment already deposited is like shedding.

5. Seven principles and nine categories

FACT: The seven **principles (tattvas)** are soul (*jīva*), non-soul (*ajīva*), influx (*āsrava*), bondage (*bandha*), stoppage (*saṃvara*), shedding (*nirjarā*) and liberation (*mokṣa*).

Enumeration	Members	Exam significance
Seven principles	Soul, non-soul, influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding, liberation	Standard liberation-sequence framework
Nine categories (<i>padārtha</i>)	The seven plus merit (puṇya) and demerit (pāpa)	Makes moral valence explicit

FACT: **Argument:** merit and demerit are ethically important because meritorious and demeritorious states affect bondage; ANALYSIS: they can also be subsumed under influx and bondage, since both are forms of karmic involvement; ANALYSIS: hence some expositions use seven for soteriological mechanics and nine for moral classification.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition that must be written.** Even **good** karma remains karmic bondage if it keeps the soul within the cycle of rebirth.

FACT: **Mīmāṃsā-style objection.** If merit is morally valuable, why treat it as part of bondage? ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Jainism distinguishes ethical improvement **within** the cycle of rebirth from final release **beyond** all karmic determination. Charity performed with attachment produces merit, but liberation requires non-attachment, not a pleasanter rebirth.

FACT: **Liberation by subtraction - the governing image.** The soul does not manufacture omniscience; it removes what obscures its intrinsic capacity. The **infinite tetrad (ananta-catuṣṭaya)** - infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power - is *revealed*, not produced. Cleaning a sooted lamp does not create light.

FACT: **Sāṃkhya / Vedānta objection.** If the soul is intrinsically omniscient, why was it obscured at all? FACT: **Reply.** The soul-karma relation is **beginningless (anādi)** but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold, there is no first temporal term, yet purification can terminate the relation.

6. The eight karma-types

Class	Karma-type	What it obscures or determines	Significance
Destructive (ghātiyā)	Jñānāvaraṇīya	Knowledge	Blocks the soul's intrinsic knowing
Destructive	Darśanāvaraṇīya	Perception or apprehension	Blocks direct awareness
Destructive	Mohanīya	Right vision and right conduct	Most dangerous, because delusion misorients the path
Destructive	Antarāya	Energy, power, capacity to act	Obstructs the soul's effective power
Non-destructive (aghātiyā)	Vedanīya	Pleasure and pain	Determines felt experience without destroying essence
Non-destructive	Nāma	Body, form, embodiment	Determines the type of body
Non-destructive	Gotra	Status or family-standing	Determines high or low status conditions
Non-destructive	Āyus	Lifespan	Determines duration of embodied life

FACT: **Argument:** the first four are destructive because they obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation and power; the last four are non-destructive because they structure embodied experience, body, status and lifespan.

Mohanīya is the most dangerous, since delusion corrupts both right vision and right conduct; it is commonly divided into *darśana-mohanīya* and *cāritra-mohanīya*.

FACT: **Distinction with a large pay-off.** The omniscient being at the **sayoga-kevalī** stage has destroyed the destructive karmas but still lives with remaining non-destructive karmas until final release. That single fact explains embodied omniscience - see Session 9.

FACT: **Buddhist objection.** The taxonomy is metaphysically heavy compared with a mental-volitional account.

ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Jainism accepts the heaviness because it wants a realist explanation of why cognition, embodiment, status, pleasure and lifespan are **all** karmically structured.

7. The four parameters of bondage

Parameter	Meaning	Principal determinant
Type (prakṛti)	Which kind of karma is bound	Activity (yoga)
Quantity (pradeśa)	How much karmic matter is bound	Activity (yoga)
Duration (sthiti)	How long the bondage lasts	Passion (kaṣāya)
Intensity (anubhāga / rasa)	How strongly it will fruit	Passion (kaṣāya)

FACT: **Consequence.** Activity **without** passion has a radically different karmic effect from activity **with** passion. This yields the contrast between **momentary bondage (īryāpathika bandha)**, arising from passion-free activity, and **durable bondage (sāmparāyika bandha)**, arising from passion-coloured activity.

FACT: **Example.** A monk's careful walking involves bodily activity, but being free from passion it binds only momentarily; an angry act binds deeply because passion fixes the karma.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** The moral weight of an action depends not only on external movement but on passion, attachment and delusion.

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. Jaina bondage theory is a moral psychology and a material physics working as one mechanism, which is why it cannot be paraphrased as "karma is action". **Named evidence.** The five causes run wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passion and activity; psychical action-matter attracts material action-matter, giving *bhāvabandha* and *dravyabandha*; and the four parameters divide labour so that activity fixes type and quantity while passion fixes duration and intensity, producing the contrast between *īryāpathika* and *sāmparāyika* bondage. **Analysis.** Because duration and intensity - the two features that actually determine future suffering - are governed by passion rather than by outward act, the doctrine explains why an identical bodily movement can be almost karmically inert in a disciplined agent and gravely binding in an angry one, which is exactly the result an ethics of intention requires. **Qualification / link.** The mechanism still owes an account of how formless consciousness and subtle matter make contact, and Nyāya presses precisely there; the defensible conclusion is that Jainism buys explanatory precision about moral consequence at the cost of an unresolved interaction problem.

UPSC TRAPS IN THIS SUBTOPIC

1. WRONG: Writing "karma" without "material". FACT: Materiality is the Jaina thesis.
2. WRONG: Assigning duration to activity. FACT: Duration and intensity belong to **passion**; type and quantity to **activity**.
3. WRONG: Equating *bhāvabandha* with mere intention and *dravyabandha* with mere deed. FACT: One is the soul's modification, the other the matter's adhesion.
4. WRONG: Treating merit as a step toward liberation. FACT: Merit improves the rebirth, not the release.
5. WRONG: Confusing stoppage with shedding. FACT: Preventive versus eliminative.
6. WRONG: Listing eight karmas without the destructive / non-destructive split. FACT: The split is what makes embodied omniscience intelligible.

RAPID REVISION

- Five causes: wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passion, activity.
- Two bondages: psychic modification, material adhesion.
- Four parameters: type and quantity from activity; duration and intensity from passion.
- Eight karmas: four destructive, four non-destructive; delusion is the worst.
- Seven principles; nine categories add merit and demerit.
- Beginningless but terminable: *anādi* yet not endless.

EXAM APPLICATION - WHERE THIS IS ASKED

- **2018 Q6(c), 15 marks** - bondage, and the bound versus liberated soul.
- **2020 Q5(a), 10 marks** - the concept of action-consequence and its bearing on liberation.
- **2022 Q5(d), 10 marks** - how the Jaina view of action-consequence bears on soteriology, critically.
- **2024 Q6(c), 15 marks** - psychic versus material bondage, verbatim.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | BONDAGE - ACTION-MATTER AS SUBTLE MATTER AND THE MECHANICS OF ADHESION

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

material action-matter (karma-pudgala) · psychical and material action-matter (bhāva-karma, dravya-karma) · psychic and material bondage (bhāvabandha, dravyabandha) · influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding, liberation · eight karma-types · destructive and non-destructive karmas · momentary and durable bondage

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Activity opens the channel and fixes the type and quantity of karma bound, while passion supplies the adhesion and fixes its duration and intensity, so inner disposition governs the severity of a real material bondage.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Jaina action-matter is therefore unlike Nyāya *adr̥ṣṭa*, Mīmāṃsā *apūrva*, Sāṃkhya *saṃskāra* and Buddhist *vāsanā*, none of which are material particles adhering to the self.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Never assign duration to activity or quantity to passion, and never treat merit as a step toward liberation rather than a better bondage.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: The originality of Jaina soteriology lies in treating action and moral consequence not merely as a moral record but as subtle material bondage, so that liberation requires both the stoppage of fresh influx and the shedding of what has already adhered.

SESSION 9 - LIBERATION: THE THREE JEWELS, THE DISCIPLINE, THE FOURTEEN STAGES AND THE PERFECTED SOUL

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Liberation is not something added to the soul. It is what remains when everything foreign has been stopped and shed. The path therefore has two jobs: close the door, and clean the room.

Technical definition: Liberation (*mokṣa*) is attained through the **three jewels (ratnatraya)** - right vision (*samyag-darśana*), right knowledge (*samyag-jñāna*), right conduct (*samyak-cāritra*) - realised through vows and disciplines that effect stoppage (*saṃvara*) and shedding (*nirjarā*), and mapped across **fourteen stages of spiritual development (guṇasthāna)** culminating in omniscience (*kevala-jñāna*) and the perfected soul (*siddha*).

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jaina liberation is a subtraction and not an acquisition: because the soul's infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power are intrinsic and merely obscured, the path is a graded removal of obscuring matter, and the liberated soul remains a numerically distinct individual rather than merging into any absolute.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- three jewels (ratnatraya)
- great vows (mahāvratā) / lesser vows (aṇuvratā)
- restraint (gupti), carefulness (samiti), virtues (dharma), contemplations (anuprekṣā), endurance of afflictions (pariṣaha-jaya), austerity (tapas)
- stages of spiritual development (guṇasthāna); ladder of suppression (upaśama-śreṇi) / ladder of annihilation (kṣapaka-śreṇi)
- embodied omniscient (sayoga-kevalī) / activity-free omniscient (ayoga-kevalī)
- perfected soul (siddha); summit of the world (siddha-śilā); voluntary passionless death (sallekhanā / santhārā)

How to use them: pair every ethical term with its karmic function. Vows are not moral decoration; they are the operational form of stoppage, and austerity is the operational form of shedding.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

A ROOM WITH AN OPEN DOOR AND A FLOOR ALREADY THICK WITH DUST

STEP 1 CLOSE THE DOOR -> stoppage (saṃvara)
vows, restraint, carefulness, virtues, contemplations, endurance
result: no NEW dust enters

STEP 2 SWEEP THE FLOOR -> shedding (nirjarā)
austerity, repentance, service, study, detachment, meditation
result: OLD dust is removed

STEP 3 THE ROOM IS THE ROOM -> liberation (mokṣa)
nothing has been added; something foreign has been removed

WHY THE ORDER MATTERS: sweeping while the door stands open is endless work.

In simple words: Jainism refuses to let ethics and metaphysics come apart. Every vow has a job in the karmic machine, and the machine has two independent problems - arrival and accumulation - so the path needs two independent remedies.

Discipline	Job
Vows, restraint, carefulness	Close the channel: stoppage
Austerity, repentance, meditation	Remove the deposit: shedding
Right vision	Aim the whole process correctly

One-line memory: stoppage is preventive, shedding is eliminative, liberation is what is left.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE FOURTEEN STAGES AS ONE ASCENT WITH ONE FALL

14	ayoga-kevalī	activity ceases; momentary final state	-> SIDDHA
13	sayoga-kevalī	OMNISCIENT while still embodied and active	
	^	destructive karmas destroyed	
12	kṣīṇa-moha	delusion DESTROYED	kṣapaka-śreṇi (annihilation)
11	upaśānta-moha	delusion only SUPPRESSED	upaśama-śreṇi -> MUST FALL
10	sūkṣma-samparāya	only subtle greed remains	
9	anivṛtti-bādara	advanced purification of gross passions	
8	apūrva-karaṇa	unprecedented purification begins	
7	apramatta-samyata	full restraint WITHOUT negligence	
6	pramatta-samyata	full restraint WITH negligence	
5	deśavirata	partial restraint; lay vows	
4	avirata samyag-dṛṣṭi	RIGHT VISION without restraint	<- the decisive breakthrough
3	miśra	mixed right and wrong orientation	
2	sāsvādāna	falling, with a lingering taste of right vision	
1	mithyā-dṛṣṭi	false vision	

TWO LADDERS FROM STAGE 8:

suppression -> reaches 11 -> NECESSARILY FALLS BACK (moha only covered)

annihilation -> reaches 12 -> proceeds to 13 and 14 (moha destroyed)

ANALYSIS: Caption. Stage 4 and stage 11 are the two places examiners probe. Stage 4 is the breakthrough of right vision **without** conduct; stage 11 is the trap of suppression, which necessarily falls back because covered delusion is not destroyed delusion. An answer that names both has understood the ladder rather than memorised it.

1. The three jewels

FACT: Statement. Liberation requires the **three jewels (ratnatraya)**: right vision (*samyag-darśana*), right knowledge (*samyag-jñāna*) and right conduct (*samyak-cāritra*).

FACT: Argument: one must first see reality correctly; then know it correctly; then live in accordance with that insight. Mere knowledge without conduct does not stop influx; mere conduct without right view lacks orientation.

FACT: Distinction. The three jewels are **not** sequential in a crude external sense; they are mutually reinforcing dimensions of one path, and the *Tattvārthasūtra* states them jointly.

FACT: Cārvāka-style objection. Is "right faith" blind belief? **FACT: Reply.** No. *Samyag-darśana* is right apprehension or trustful orientation toward truth, not irrational fideism; it is the stage-4 breakthrough that makes the rest of the ladder possible.

2. The great vows and their graded form

Vow	Basic meaning	Soteriological relevance
Non-violence (ahiṃsā)	Non-injury in thought, speech and act	Central, because injury binds karma most deeply
Truthfulness (satya)	Truthful speech	Purifies speech and intention
Non-stealing (asteya)	Taking nothing not given	Curbs acquisitive harm
Chastity (brahmacarya)	Control of sensuality	Disciplines desire
Non-possession (aparigraha)	Non-attachment to possessions	Reduces grasping and karmic adhesion

ANALYSIS: Presupposition. Ethical discipline is **metaphysically effective**, not merely socially good.

FACT: Distinction. In Jainism non-violence is not only a moral ideal but a **soteriological technology**: extreme care toward even one-sense beings follows directly from the pluralistic doctrine of souls established in Session 3.

FACT: Householder-pragmatic objection. Such rigour is too severe for ordinary life. **ANALYSIS: Reply.** Jainism distinguishes **great vows (mahāvratā)** for ascetics from **lesser vows (aṇuvratā)** for householders, preserving the ideal while allowing graded practice - which is exactly what the fifth stage of the ladder records.

3. The complete discipline of stoppage and shedding

FACT: The five vows are central but do **not** exhaust the standard discipline:

Discipline	Sanskrit	Main function
Restraint of body, speech and mind	guṇti	Controls the three channels of activity
Carefulness in movement, speech, alms-seeking, handling objects and bodily functions	samiti	Prevents negligent injury and fresh influx
Ten virtues, including forgiveness, humility, truthfulness, purity, restraint, austerity, renunciation, non-attachment and celibacy	dharma	Replaces passion with disciplined character
Contemplations on the self, impermanence, solitude, influx, stoppage and related truths	anuprekṣā / bhāvanā	Reorients cognition and weakens attachment
Patient conquest of afflictions	pariṣaha-jaya	Prevents pain, hunger, heat, cold and insult from producing passion
Right conduct	cāritra	Integrates vision, knowledge, vows and equanimity
Austerity	tapas	Stops passion and accelerates the wearing away of stored karma

FACT: **Two forms of shedding.** Natural fruition wears karma out when it matures; disciplined austerity and purification **accelerate** shedding. External austerities regulate bodily consumption and exposure; internal austerities include repentance, humility, service, study, detachment, meditation and abandonment of bodily identification.

FACT: **Distinction to write.** Stoppage is preventive; shedding is eliminative. Vows primarily close the channels of new influx, while austerity and purified conduct also exhaust karma already bound.

4. The fourteen stages of spiritual development

No.	Stage	Brief gloss
1	Mithyā-dṛṣṭi	False vision; complete wrong orientation
2	Sāsvādāna / sāsādāna	Falling condition with a lingering taste of right vision
3	Miśra / samyag-mithyā-dṛṣṭi	Mixed right and wrong orientation
4	Avirata samyag-dṛṣṭi	Right vision without full restraint
5	Deśavirata	Partial restraint, especially lay vows
6	Pramatta-saṃyata	Full restraint with negligence
7	Apramatta-saṃyata	Full restraint without negligence
8	Apūrva-karaṇa / nivṛtti-bādhara	Unprecedented purification; gross passions being transformed
9	Anivṛtti-bādhara	Further advanced purification of gross passions
10	Sūkṣma-samparāya	Only subtle greed remains
11	Upasānta-moha	Delusion suppressed, not destroyed
12	Kṣīṇa-moha	Delusion destroyed
13	Sayoga-kevalī	Omniscient embodied being with activity still present
14	Ayoga-kevalī	Activity ceases; momentary final state before perfection

FACT: **Reading the ladder:** stages 1-3 describe wrong, falling and mixed vision; stage 4 is decisive because right vision first becomes stable enough to orient the path; stages 5-7 discipline conduct through partial and full restraint; stages 8-10 refine passions from gross to extremely subtle; stages 11-12 mark the crucial difference between **suppression** and **destruction** of delusion; stages 13-14 explain how omniscience and final disembodiment are related.

FACT: **Two ladders.** The **ladder of suppression (upaśama-śreṇi)** suppresses delusion and can reach stage 11, which **necessarily falls back** because suppressed delusion is not destroyed. The **ladder of annihilation**

(**kṣapaka-śreṇi**) destroys delusion and reaches stage 12 and beyond.

FACT: **Advaita-style objection.** A fourteen-stage ladder turns liberation into a mechanical sequence rather than insight. ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Insight, conduct and karmic purification must be integrated; right vision without progressive destruction of karma is incomplete, and the ladder simply records that integration honestly.

5. Embodied omniscience and the Jaina answer to liberation-in-life

FACT: **Statement.** At stage 13 the **sayoga-kevalī** possesses omniscience while embodied, because the **destructive (ghātiyā)** karmas have been destroyed while the **non-destructive (aghātiyā)** karmas remain. Stage 14, **ayoga-kevalī**, is the momentary cessation of activity immediately before perfection.

FACT: **Distinction.** The **sayoga-kevalī** is the Jaina answer to "is liberation-in-life possible?": the embodied omniscient being is liberated-in-life in the Jaina sense, though the perfected state follows only after the remaining non-destructive karmas are exhausted.

FACT: **Example.** A lamp whose cover has been removed shines fully even before it is moved; likewise the omniscient being knows fully while still embodied.

FACT: **Rāmānuja-style objection.** Omniscience while embodied seems unintelligible if embodiment itself implies limitation. ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Jainism distinguishes destructive karmas, which obstruct essential knowledge, from non-destructive karmas, which sustain embodiment without blocking omniscience.

6. Omniscience, liberation and the condition of the perfected soul

FACT: **Omniscience (kevala-jñāna)** is perfect knowledge attained when the obstructive karmas are fully destroyed. The soul is intrinsically omniscient; ignorance is due to karmic obstruction; remove the obstruction and native luminosity manifests completely. Perfection is therefore **recovery, not production**.

FACT: **Liberation (mokṣa)** is the final state in which the soul is freed from all karmic matter, regains infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power, and rises to the **summit of the world (siddha-śilā)**, being no longer weighed down by karmic matter.

FACT: **The condition of the liberated soul - the 2018 demand, stated exactly:**

Question	Jaina answer
Does it retain individuality?	FACT: Yes. It is a siddha , numerically distinct; there is no merger
Does it retain knowledge?	FACT: Yes. Infinite knowledge and perception are fully manifest
Does it retain body or activity?	WRONG: No. Disembodied, activity-free, beyond rebirth
Does it return?	WRONG: No. Bondage is beginningless but terminable
Where is it?	FACT: At the summit of the world, in the Jaina cosmological picture

FACT: **Distinction.** Unlike Advaita liberation, this is **not** merger into impersonal Brahman. Unlike Buddhist *nirvāṇa*, it is the liberation of a distinct enduring soul.

ANALYSIS: **Modern objection.** Spatial ascent of a liberated soul may seem mythic. ANALYSIS: **Reply.** Report the cosmological picture faithfully while separating canonical doctrine from modern philosophical evaluation; do not silently secularise the doctrine.

7. Voluntary passionless death

FACT: **Statement.** **Sallekhanā** or **santhārā** is the voluntary, gradual, ritually regulated relinquishment of food and passions undertaken when death is unavoidable or bodily decline is incurable.

FACT: **Argument:**

1. Bondage tracks **passion**: passion fixes karmic matter more deeply than bare activity.
2. A death faced with equanimity minimises new influx and prevents panic, attachment and aversion from creating fresh bondage.
3. The aim is not to end life as such, but to end passion at the moment when life is already approaching its close.

4. The practice must be free from desire for death, desire to continue living, attachment to friends, recollection of pleasures and hope of reward.
5. If such motives enter, the act becomes a **transgression (aticāra)** of the vow's proper discipline.

FACT: Distinction from suicide (ātma-ghāta): suicide is passion-driven, sudden, violent, often concealed and motivated by despair or aversion; *sallekhanā* is passion-free, non-violent, gradual, supervised and public.

CAUTION: Modern legal-ethical objection. Critics in India have disputed whether *sallekhanā* is protected religious practice or an impermissible form of self-destruction. **ANALYSIS: Reply and evidence discipline.** Legal and ethical evaluation must distinguish intention, procedure, publicity, non-violence and the absence of death-desire. The controversy is a useful Paper II bridge to religion and morality, but **specific case names, holdings, dates and statutory details must not be asserted unless separately verified.**

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The Jaina path is intelligible only as the operational counterpart of the bondage mechanism, which is why its ethics cannot be detached from its metaphysics. **Named evidence.** Vows, restraint (*guṇti*), carefulness (*saṃiti*), the ten virtues, the contemplations and the endurance of afflictions all effect stoppage, while austerity effects shedding; the fourteen stages record the ascent; and the ladder of suppression necessarily falls from stage 11 because delusion there is merely covered, whereas the ladder of annihilation destroys it at stage 12. **Analysis.** Because suppression and destruction produce the same appearance but opposite futures, the doctrine gives Jainism a principled account of spiritual relapse that a purely insight-based soteriology cannot supply, and it also explains why omniscience can coexist with embodiment once only the non-destructive karmas remain. **Qualification / link.** The account remains internally taxonomic and externally unverifiable: a critic can accept the moral psychology while rejecting the karmic physics, so the strongest available conclusion is that the path is coherent within Jaina ontology rather than demonstrable outside it.

UPSC TRAPS IN THIS SUBTOPIC

1. **WRONG:** Saying the liberated soul merges into a universal consciousness. **FACT:** It remains numerically distinct.
2. **WRONG:** Treating stage 11 as an achievement. **FACT:** It necessarily falls back.
3. **WRONG:** Making the three jewels a temporal sequence. **FACT:** They are joint conditions.
4. **WRONG:** Reducing the discipline to five vows. **FACT:** Restraint, carefulness, virtues, contemplations, endurance and austerity all belong.
5. **WRONG:** Citing a specific *sallekhanā* judgment. **FACT:** Report the controversy without unverified legal detail.
6. **WRONG:** Saying omniscience requires disembodiment. **FACT:** Stage 13 is embodied omniscience.

RAPID REVISION

- Three jewels, jointly; right vision is the stage-4 breakthrough.
- Great vows for ascetics, lesser vows for householders.
- Stoppage = vows and restraint; shedding = austerity.
- Fourteen stages; two ladders; stage 11 falls, stage 12 does not.
- *Sayoga-kevalī* = embodied omniscient = the Jaina liberation-in-life.
- *Siddha* keeps individuality; no merger, no return.

EXAM APPLICATION - WHERE THIS IS ASKED

- **2018 Q6(c), 15 marks** - bound soul, liberated soul, and the condition of the liberated soul.
- **2020 Q5(a), 10 marks** - action-consequence and its bearing on liberation.
- **2022 Q5(d), 10 marks** - action-consequence and soteriology, critically discussed.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | LIBERATION - THREE JEWELS, DISCIPLINE, FOURTEEN STAGES AND THE PERFECTED SOUL

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS

three jewels (ratnatraya) · great and lesser vows · restraint (gupti) · carefulness (samiti) · austerity (tapas) · fourteen stages (guṇasthāna) · ladders of suppression and annihilation · embodied omniscient (sayoga-kevali) · perfected soul (siddha) · voluntary passionless death (sallekhanā)

2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT

Because bondage has two independent problems, arrival and accumulation, the path needs two independent remedies, so vows and restraint effect stoppage while austerity and purification effect shedding.

3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST

Liberation is subtraction rather than acquisition, so the perfected soul remains numerically distinct instead of merging into an absolute as in Advaita or dissolving as in Buddhist accounts of no-self.

4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE

Stage eleven suppresses delusion and necessarily falls back, so never present it as an achievement, and never cite an unverified sallekhanā judgment.

ANSWER-GRABBING LINE — WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM: Jain liberation is subtraction and not acquisition, because the soul's infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power are intrinsic and merely obscured, so the liberated soul remains a numerically distinct individual rather than merging into any absolute.

SESSION 10 - JAINISM AMONG ITS RIVALS: NAMED CRITICISMS, REPLIES AND THE ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

DEFINITION / WHAT THIS IS CALLED

Plain-language definition: Every major Indian school attacked Jainism at a different joint. This session collects the named attacks, the Jaina replies, and an honest verdict on how much force each attack retains.

Technical definition: The dialectical ledger (*pūrvapakṣa-siddhānta*) of Jainism records objections from Śaṃkara, Rāmānuja, Dharmakīrti-style Buddhist argument, Nyāya, Sāṃkhya-Vedānta and Cārvāka, each paired with the Jaina reply and its residual force.

ANSWER-GRABBING OPENING - WRITE/ADAPT IN THE EXAM

Jainism is best evaluated as a rigorous qualified realism: internally systematic, ethically powerful and logically subtle, yet vulnerable to external critiques of contradiction, soul-matter interaction and unverifiable higher knowledge.

MUST-WRITE KEYWORDS

- **opponent's position (pūrvapakṣa) / established conclusion (siddhānta)**
- **Śaṃkara, Rāmānuja, Dharmakīrti, Nyāya, Sāṃkhya-Vedānta, Cārvāka**
- **causal efficacy (arthakriyā)**
- **residual force** - what survives the reply

How to use them: never write "critics say". Name the critic, state the argument in its strongest form, give the Jaina reply, then grade what survives. This three-move discipline is what separates a 9 from a 12 on a 15-marker.

SIMPLE START - PLAIN-LANGUAGE GATEWAY

SIX CRITICS, SIX DIFFERENT JOINTS OF THE SAME SYSTEM

Śaṃkara	-> attacks the LOGIC	"you affirm and deny together"
Rāmānuja	-> attacks the OBJECT	"opposed real attributes in one thing"
Dharmakīrti	-> attacks the SOUL	"permanent yet changing cannot act"
Nyāya	-> attacks the SOUL'S SIZE	"eternal things do not expand"
Sāṃkhya/Vedānta	-> attacks the BEGINNING	"why was a perfect soul ever covered?"
Cārvāka	-> attacks the EVIDENCE	"none of this is perceived"

NOTICE: only the last is external to classical Indian metaphysics.
The first five accept souls or substances and still find Jainism costly.

In simple words: the criticisms are not repetitions of one complaint. Each targets a specific commitment, and the Jaina reply to each is different. Answers that give one generic defence lose the discrimination marks.

Critic	The joint attacked	Jaina defensive resource
Śaṃkara	Predication	The four indices
Rāmānuja	Aspect-realism	Substance / mode distinction
Dharmakīrti	Permanence and action	Origination-decay-persistence
Nyāya	Soul's extension	Space-points and the lamp simile

Critic	The joint attacked	Jaina defensive resource
Sāṃkhya-Vedānta	Beginningless bondage	<i>Anādi</i> but terminable
Cārvāka	Verifiability	Systematic coherence, not perception

One-line memory: name the critic, state the joint, give the resource, grade the residue.

VISUAL: VISUAL - THE INTER-SCHOOL POSITIONING GRID

	SELF	PERMANENCE/ CHANGE	CAUSATION	CREATOR	LIBERATION
JAINISM	many souls	dravya permanent paryāya changing	sadasatkārya- vāda	none	individual siddha
BUDDHISM	no ātman	momentariness	dependent origination	none	nirvāṇa, no eternal self
NYĀYA- VAIŚEṢIKA	many eternal selves	substances endure qualities change	asatkāryavāda (new production)	theistic (later)	self freed from suffering
SĀṂKHYA- YOGA	many puruṣas	puruṣa changeless prakṛti evolves	satkāryavāda (pre-existence)	Sāṃkhya none	kaivalya of puruṣa
MĪMĀṂSĀ	enduring self	world real	apūrva links act and result	none needed	varies by sub-school
ADVAITA	one ātman- Brahman	Brahman changeless world mithyā	appearance (vivarta)	Īśvara empirical	realisation of non-duality
CĀRVĀKA	body-based consciousness	material change	material regularity	none	denied

JAINA SIGNATURE: the ONLY position that makes permanence and change equally real IN THE SAME THING by indexing them to substance and mode.

ANALYSIS: Caption. Use one row, not the whole grid, in an actual answer. The grid exists so that the candidate can select the single comparison the question demands, rather than emptying a memorised table onto the page.

1. Śaṃkara's critique of many-sidedness

FACT: Statement. Śaṃkara, in the *Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya*, criticises Jaina many-sidedness by arguing that contradictory attributes cannot belong to the same thing in the same way.

FACT: The critic's argument:

1. If the same object is said to be both existent and non-existent, determinate knowledge is threatened.
2. If everything is "somehow yes and somehow no", practical action loses clear guidance.
3. If many-sidedness asserts itself absolutely, it contradicts itself.
4. If it asserts itself only conditionally, it seems to lose universal force.

ANALYSIS: Presupposition. A viable metaphysics must preserve non-contradiction and assertoric clarity.

FACT: The Jaina reply:

1. Opposed predicates are indexed to distinct standpoints: **substance (dravya)**, **place (kṣetra)**, **time (kāla)** and **mode (bhāva)**.
2. There is no contradiction unless affirmation and negation are made in the same respect, place, time and mode.
3. *Syādvāda* is itself asserted *syāt*; this reflexive qualification is a virtue, because the doctrine obeys its own rule.
4. **ANALYSIS:** A residual objection remains: if conditional predication is always qualified, critics may say it loses final assertoric force.

2. Rāmānuja's critique: opposed real attributes

FACT: Statement. Rāmānuja presses the charge that a real substance with really opposed attributes is unintelligible.

FACT: The critic's argument: a thing cannot be genuinely both F and not-F in the same meaningful sense; if the attributes are real and opposed, the substance becomes incoherent; if they are not real, Jaina realism weakens.

ANALYSIS: Presupposition. Real predication must avoid contradiction at the level of the **object**, not merely at the level of language.

FACT: The Jaina reply. Standpoint-indexing again: the same substance persists while modes arise and cease, so the opposition is between **aspects**, not within one unqualified predication.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** The reply works best if one accepts the substance-mode distinction; it is less persuasive to schools that reject such aspect-realism, and Rāmānuja is precisely such a school.

3. The Buddhist critique of a permanent-yet-changing soul

FACT: **Statement.** A Buddhist critique associated with Dharmakīrti's causal-efficacy style of argument challenges the Jaina soul as permanent yet changing.

FACT: **The critic's argument:**

1. If the soul expands and contracts with the body, it undergoes real change.
2. What undergoes real change cannot be absolutely permanent.
3. A permanent entity that changes faces the **causal efficacy (arthakriyā)** dilemma: if it acts, it changes; if it does not change, it cannot act.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** Causal efficacy and permanence are difficult to combine in one substance.

FACT: **The Jaina reply.** Origination, cessation and permanence are simultaneously real features of every real; the substance is permanent **as substance** and changing **as mode**.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** The Buddhist objection remains strong if one denies the real distinction between substance and modes - which is exactly what a momentarist does deny.

4. The Nyāya critique of the soul's extension and of material action-matter

FACT: **Statement.** Nyāya criticises the Jaina view that the soul is co-extensive with the body and expands or contracts like a lamp filling a room.

FACT: **The critic's argument:** an eternal self should not literally expand and contract; if the self has parts or space-points, its eternality seems threatened; and material action-matter is less parsimonious than an unseen moral potency such as *adṛṣṭa*.

FACT: **The Jaina reply.** Jainism invokes **space-points (pradeśa)** and the lamp simile: consciousness can pervade the body without being identical with gross matter, and karmic matter explains concrete embodiment better than a merely invisible potency.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** The reply is internally coherent within Jaina pluralism, but the interaction of a conscious, space-point-bearing soul with matter remains a debated point, and it is the same difficulty that Session 8 flagged.

5. The Sāṃkhya-Vedānta critique of intrinsic omniscience and beginningless bondage

FACT: **Statement.** Sāṃkhya and Vedānta-style objections ask why karmic matter obscures an intrinsically omniscient soul, and what began the obscuration.

FACT: **The critic's argument:** if the soul is intrinsically pure and omniscient, obscuration appears accidental and inexplicable; if karma began at some time, a first cause of bondage is required; if karma never began, liberation may seem impossible.

FACT: **The Jaina reply.** The soul-karma relation is **beginningless (anādi)** but not endless; like seed-and-tree or ore-and-gold, there is no first temporal term, yet disciplined stoppage and shedding can terminate the relation.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** The reply blocks the first-cause demand but leaves a metaphysical puzzle about why beginningless bondage is possible for an intrinsically perfect soul.

6. The Cārvāka or empiricist critique

FACT: **Statement.** A Cārvāka or modern empiricist objection rejects invisible souls, karmic particles, omniscience and the summit of the world as unverifiable.

FACT: **The critic's argument.** Ordinary perception does not disclose karmic matter, disembodied perfected souls or omniscient cognition.

ANALYSIS: **Presupposition.** Only publicly verifiable empirical entities should be admitted.

ANALYSIS: **The Jaina reply.** Jainism combines testimony, inference, moral phenomenology and the internal logic of purification to defend these doctrines, but it cannot satisfy a strict materialist who admits only gross perception.

ANALYSIS: **Assessment.** Use this objection as an **external** critique. Do not let it displace the named classical objections, which are what Indian-philosophy examiners are actually testing.

7. The three focused comparisons that questions actually demand

Jainism and Buddhism. FACT: Both are renunciant (*śramaṇa*) traditions, both challenge Vedic ritual supremacy, and both reject a creator. FACT: Jainism affirms many permanent souls and permanent-cum-changing substances, whereas Buddhism rejects a substance-self. FACT: Jaina non-violence is far more radical, because even minute living beings are souls. FACT: Jaina action-matter is material, while Buddhist action-consequence is primarily volitional or mental-causal continuity. ANALYSIS: Historically close, metaphysically opposed.

Jainism and Advaita Vedānta. FACT: Ultimate reality is plural rather than non-dual; the world is real rather than *mithyā*; souls are many rather than ultimately one; bondage is karmic material obscuration rather than *avidyā* and superimposition; and liberation produces many distinct perfected souls rather than the realisation of non-duality.

Jainism and Cārvāka. FACT: Pluralist realism with soul and action-matter against materialist minimalism; action-matter real and material against action-consequence rejected; liberation central against liberation denied; conditional predication against suspicion of inference and testimony; austerity and non-violence against this-worldly pleasure and prudence.

8. Directive decoder and the answer architecture

Directive	What is being tested	Structural move	Closing verdict
Discuss	Breadth plus coherence	Define -> explain mechanics -> add one debate	"Thus Jainism offers a coherent pluralist realism, though its metaphysical costs remain."
Examine	Doctrinal accuracy	Break into components: substance, standpoint, <i>syāt</i> , action-matter, liberation	"The doctrine is intelligible once its presuppositions are made explicit."
Critically examine	Doctrine plus objections	Present Śaṃkara, Nyāya and Buddhist objections with Jaina replies	"The reply is strong internally but not neutral across schools."
Analyse	Internal logic	Show metaphysics -> epistemology -> language -> liberation	"Its strength lies in systematic interconnection."
Evaluate	Balanced judgement	Strengths, weaknesses, residual contestation	"Persuasive as qualified realism; vulnerable on material action-matter and omniscience."
Compare	Inter-school positioning	Use axes: self, causation, means of knowledge, action-consequence, liberation	"The comparison shows Jainism as a middle path between flux and static permanence."
Distinguish	Conceptual precision	Tables: many-sidedness / conditional predication / sevenfold predication; psychic / material bondage	"The distinction prevents the standard conflations."
Bring out	Hidden relation	Show how reality is reflected in judgement, or action-matter in liberation	"The relation is constitutive, not accidental."
Do you agree?	Reasoned stance	Agree partly -> doctrine -> objections -> qualified verdict	"Agree within Jaina presuppositions; qualify from rival standpoints."

FACT: The three mark-band skeletons:

- 10 MARKS define the key term precisely -> 3-4 compact doctrinal points
-> one distinction that prevents confusion -> one evaluative line
- 15 MARKS frame the issue -> Body A: the doctrine asked for
-> Body B: structure (table, seven predications, bondage sequence)
-> Body C: one named criticism and one reply -> philosophical verdict
- 20 MARKS open by linking metaphysics and judgement
-> Section 1: define reality (dravya, guṇa, paryāya, utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya)
-> Section 2: reflection in naya, syāt, saptabhaṅgi
-> Section 3: if asked, connect to soul, action-matter and liberation
-> Section 4: assess pluralism, realism and self-refutation
-> close: realism without dogmatism

HOW TO WRITE THE PARAGRAPH - claim -> named evidence -> analysis -> qualification

Claim. The classical objections to Jainism are not variants of a single complaint, and treating them as one is the commonest structural failure in answers to critical directives. **Named evidence.** Śaṃkara attacks predication in the *Brahmasūtra-bhāṣya*, Rāmānuja attacks opposed real attributes in the object, Dharmakīrti-style argument attacks a permanent-yet-changing soul through the *arthakriyā* dilemma, Nyāya attacks the soul's expansion and contraction, and Sāṃkhya-Vedānta attacks the intelligibility of beginningless obscuration in an intrinsically omniscient soul. **Analysis.** Since each objection targets a different commitment, each Jaina reply mobilises a different resource - the four indices, the substance-mode distinction, the three-term definition of the real, the doctrine of space-points, and beginninglessness without endlessness - so a single generic defence necessarily under-answers four of the five. **Qualification / link.** The replies are internally coherent but not school-neutral, since each presupposes exactly what the critic denies; the defensible verdict is therefore that Jainism is consistent within its own realism while remaining costly to anyone who rejects aspect-realism or material action-matter.

UPSC TRAPS IN THIS SUBTOPIC

1. WRONG: Writing "critics argue" without a name. FACT: Name Śaṃkara, Rāmānuja, Dharmakīrti, Nyāya.
2. WRONG: Using the Cārvāka objection as the main critique. FACT: It is external; classical objections carry the marks.
3. WRONG: Reproducing the whole comparison grid. FACT: Select the single row the question needs.
4. WRONG: Ending with a summary. FACT: Critical directives require a graded verdict.
5. WRONG: Claiming the replies refute the critics. FACT: They neutralise the charge within Jaina premises; say so.

RAPID REVISION

- Six named critics, six different joints, six different replies.
- *Arthakriyā* is the Buddhist lever; the four indices are the Jaina lever.
- Jaina signature: permanence and change equally real in one thing, indexed differently.
- 10 / 15 / 20-mark skeletons as printed above.
- Ready verdicts: coherent pluralist realism, subtle logic, contestable karmic physics.

EXAM APPLICATION - WHERE THIS IS ASKED

- 2022 Q6(b), 15 marks and 2025 Q7(c), 15 marks - both require named objection plus reply plus verdict.
- 2020 Q7(c), 15 marks (Cārvāka-owned) - the Jainism-versus-Cārvāka row supplies the whole comparison.
- Every "critically discuss" Jainism part since 2018 has rewarded the objection-reply-verdict structure.

SUBTOPIC CLOSURE FLOW | JAINISM AMONG ITS RIVALS - NAMED CRITICISMS, REPLIES AND ANSWER ARCHITECTURE

1. KEY TERMS / DEFINITIONS opponent's position and established conclusion (pūrvapakṣa, siddhānta) · Śaṃkara · Rāmānuja · Dharmakīrti · causal efficacy (arthakriyā) · space-points (pradeśa) · beginningless but terminable (anādi) · residual force	2. MECHANISM / ARGUMENT Each classical objection targets a distinct commitment, so each Jaina reply mobilises a distinct resource, from the four indices for predication to beginninglessness for the origin of bondage.	3. CONSEQUENCE / CONTRAST The replies neutralise the charges within Jaina premises without being school-neutral, because each presupposes the very aspect-realism or material action-matter that the critic denies.	4. UPSC TRAP / ANSWER-USE Do not lead with the Cārvāka verifiability objection or empty the comparison grid onto the page; name the classical critic and select the single comparison the question demands.
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BASIC MCQS / REMEDIATION

32 original MCQs - 24 core diagnostics and 8 remedial error-targeting drills

Answer placement: each correct option was fixed independently, so the key sequence is unpatterned rather than rotated. Options are matched for length, specificity, grammar and visible formatting so that the answer cannot be spotted by shape alone. Every question carries four question-specific option explanations and one unique examiner trap.

CORE DIAGNOSTICS - 24 ITEMS

MCQ 1. The systematic anchor of Jaina philosophy

With reference to the *Tattvārthasūtra*, consider the following statements.

1. It is ascribed to Umāsvāti in Śvetāmbara usage and to Umāsvāmī in Digambara usage.
2. Its authority is confined to one of the two major traditions, which is why sectarian canons differ.
3. It states the path to liberation through right vision, right knowledge and right conduct together.

Which of the statements given above are correct?

- A. 1 and 2 only
- B. 1 and 3 only
- C. 2 and 3 only
- D. 1, 2 and 3

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it retains statement 2, which confines the text to a single tradition, whereas the *Tattvārthasūtra* is precisely the rare work treated as authoritative across both.
- **B:** Correct: the double ascription and the joint three-jewel path formula are both standard, and together they explain why the text functions as a shared systematic grammar.
- **C:** Incorrect: it drops the double ascription that names the text's cross-sectarian standing while keeping the false restriction of its authority.
- **D:** Incorrect: statements 1 and 3 are sound, but including 2 contradicts them by denying the very cross-sectarian acceptance that makes the text quotable for both traditions.

Examiner trap 1: Shared textual authority is not doctrinal uniformity; the same *sūtra* text can anchor both traditions while canon, monastic practice and several details continue to diverge.

MCQ 2. What the title-words of the tradition actually mean

In Jaina usage, the terms *jina* and *tirthaṅkara* respectively designate

- A. one who has conquered the passions and karmic bondage, and a liberated teacher who re-establishes the crossing over rebirth
- B. the creator of the ordered cosmos, and the divine agent who allots merit and demerit to embodied beings at each rebirth
- C. the first teacher of the present cycle alone, and any monk who has completed the five great vows under supervision
- D. a soul that has suppressed delusion temporarily, and a householder who has taken the lesser vows before ordination

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: *jina* is the conqueror of passions from whom the tradition takes its name, and a *tirthaṅkara* is the ford-maker who rebuilds the crossing over the cycle of rebirth.
- **B:** Incorrect: it smuggles creation and divine allotment into a system that explains inequality by action-matter and denies a creator altogether.
- **C:** Incorrect: it confuses a title of spiritual achievement with a chronological rank and with ordinary monastic completion of the vows.
- **D:** Incorrect: temporary suppression of delusion belongs to the eleventh stage, and lesser vows belong to householders; neither term is defined that way.

Examiner trap 2: Reverence for perfected teachers is not theism; Jainism honours achieved perfection while denying that any being made or governs the world.

MCQ 3. The definition of the real

In the Jaina formula *utpāda-vyaya-dhauvya-yuktaṃ sat*, the real is characterised by

- A. persistence alone, since change belongs only to appearance and never to the substance itself
- B. origination alone, since a thing is nothing more than the series of its successive productions
- C. origination, decay and persistence taken together, in one and the same real
- D. decay alone, since every determinate thing is defined by the moment at which it ceases

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: reducing change to appearance is the static-monist error that Jainism explicitly rejects, since it cannot explain why the bracelet actually became a ring.
- **B:** Incorrect: a pure series of productions is closer to momentariness and leaves recognition of the same gold across the change unexplained.
- **C:** Correct: the real is defined by origination, decay and persistence together, which is what allows permanence to be predicated of substance and change of mode.
- **D:** Incorrect: making cessation definitional inverts the doctrine, because persistence is precisely the term that blocks a purely momentary reading.

Examiner trap 3: The three terms are joint, not alternative; a script that offers "permanence with some change" has already lost the definition, because change is constitutive rather than conceded.

MCQ 4. Substance, quality and mode

Which statement correctly states the relation among substance (*dravya*), quality (*guṇa*) and mode (*pariyāya*)?

- A. Quality is the abiding characteristic of a persisting substance, while mode is the changing state in which it appears
- B. Quality and mode are two names for the same changing state, distinguished only by the standpoint of the observer
- C. Substance is an inference from modes alone, since qualities are conventional descriptions with no bearer
- D. Mode is the abiding characteristic of a substance, while quality is the momentary state it currently exhibits

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: qualities belong to the substance as abiding characteristics, whereas modes are its changing states, which is why consciousness is a quality of the soul while delusion is a mode.
- **B:** Incorrect: collapsing the two removes the distinction that lets Jainism assert permanence and change of one thing in different respects.
- **C:** Incorrect: treating the substance as a mere inference concedes the Buddhist nominalist case that Jainism answers by insisting that changes require something whose changes they are.
- **D:** Incorrect: it exactly reverses the two terms, which is the most frequent examinable confusion in this part of the syllabus.

Examiner trap 4: Consciousness is a *guṇa* of the soul; pleasure, pain, delusion and liberated omniscience are *pariyāyas* - the same soul, different states.

MCQ 5. Substances and extended substances

Which one of the following is a real substance (*dravya*) in mainstream Jaina exposition but **not** an extended substance (*astikāya*)?

- A. Space (*ākāśa*)
- B. Time (*kāla*)
- C. Matter (*pudgala*)
- D. Medium of rest (*adharma*)

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: space is an extended substance, articulated as world-space and the space beyond the world, and it accommodates the other substances.
- **B:** Correct: time is admitted as a substance but is not an extended substance, which is why the tradition speaks of five extended substances plus time.
- **C:** Incorrect: matter is extended and aggregative, and it is additionally the only substance that possesses form.
- **D:** Incorrect: the medium of rest is an extended substance co-extensive with world-space, on a par with the medium of motion.

Examiner trap 5: Six substances but five extended substances; writing "six *astikāyas*" converts a precise doctrine into an avoidable factual error.

MCQ 6. Two substances with misleading names

In Jaina ontology, *dharma-dravya* and *adharma-dravya* respectively signify

- A. accumulated merit and accumulated demerit, which jointly determine the quality of the next embodiment
- B. right conduct and wrong conduct, understood as the two moral orientations available to an embodied soul
- C. the medium that makes motion possible and the medium that makes rest possible for souls and matter
- D. the ordering principle of the cosmos and the disordering principle that produces decay within it

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: merit and demerit are *puṇya* and *pāpa*, which appear in the ninefold list of categories, not in the sixfold list of substances.
- **B:** Incorrect: conduct is treated under right conduct and the vows; the substances in question are cosmological conditions, not moral orientations.
- **C:** Correct: they are enabling conditions of movement and rest, comparable to water for a swimming fish, and they are co-extensive with world-space.
- **D:** Incorrect: no Jaina text assigns them cosmic order and disorder; they enable motion and rest without themselves pushing or halting anything.

Examiner trap 6: The same two Sanskrit words carry a moral sense elsewhere in Indian philosophy; in Jaina ontology they are strictly media, and the shift of sense is deliberately examined.

MCQ 7. The Jaina conception of the soul

Which statement best expresses the Jaina conception of the soul (*jīva*)?

- A. It is one universal consciousness that appears as many only through the beginningless operation of ignorance
- B. It is one of innumerable distinct substances, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power
- C. It is a stream of momentary cognitions with no bearer, so that personal identity is a useful conventional fiction
- D. It is an eternal substance that becomes conscious only when the internal organ is conjoined with it in embodiment

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the Advaita position; Jainism holds that souls are numerically many and remain distinct even after liberation.
- **B:** Correct: souls are innumerable, beginningless and intrinsically endowed with the infinite tetrad, which is obscured rather than absent in bondage.
- **C:** Incorrect: this is the Buddhist no-self account, which Jainism rejects because bondage and liberation require an enduring knower.
- **D:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya account of a self that knows through conjunction with the internal organ; in Jainism consciousness is intrinsic.

Examiner trap 7: Intrinsic omniscience is not empirical omniscience; the soul's infinite knowledge is present as capacity and obscured in fact, which is exactly what action-matter is introduced to explain.

MCQ 8. What is distinctive about matter

Which feature uniquely marks matter (*pudgala*) among the six substances?

- A. It alone is co-extensive with world-space and therefore accommodates every other substance within it
- B. It alone lacks space-points, which is why it can be divided indefinitely without any residue remaining
- C. It alone undergoes origination and decay, the remaining substances being exempt from modal change
- D. It alone possesses form, that is colour, taste, smell and touch, and is therefore sense-perceptible

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: accommodation is the function of space; matter occupies room rather than providing it.
- **B:** Incorrect: matter is extended and aggregative, built from indivisible atoms combining into aggregates, so indefinite division without residue is not the Jaina view.
- **C:** Incorrect: every substance has modes; origination and decay belong to the definition of the real as such, not to matter alone.
- **D:** Correct: matter is the sole substance with form, which is why sound is classed as a material modification and why karmic matter can adhere at all.

Examiner trap 8: In Jainism sound is a modification of matter, not a quality of ether; importing the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika treatment of sound here is a silent cross-school error.

MCQ 9. Ordinary perception in the strict Jaina classification

In the strict Jaina epistemological classification, ordinary sensory cognition is

- A. direct knowledge in the fullest sense, since sense-contact provides the clearest access available to an embodied knower
- B. invalid cognition, because the senses are themselves products of karmic matter and therefore systematically deceive
- C. only conventional direct knowledge, and strictly belongs with mediated cognition because it depends on sense and mind
- D. a species of scriptural knowledge, since every perceptual judgement is already structured by inherited verbal categories

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is the Nyāya expectation; Jainism measures directness by absence of mediation, not by sensory clarity.
- **B:** Incorrect: ordinary perception is valid for practical dealings, and its wrongness arises only under wrong orientation, not from the senses as such.
- **C:** Correct: ordinary perception is *sāṃvyaṭahārika pratyakṣa*, direct for practical purposes but mediated by organ, mind and karmic limitation.
- **D:** Incorrect: verbal knowledge is derived from sense-and-mind cognition rather than constituting it, so the dependence runs the other way.

Examiner trap 9: The Jaina and Nyāya senses of *pratyakṣa* differ; using the word without the qualifier "conventional" imports a rival classification into a Jaina answer.

MCQ 10. Classifying the five kinds of knowledge

Which pair is correctly classified as indirect (*parokṣa*) in the basic fivefold scheme of knowledge?

- A. Clairvoyant knowledge and knowledge of others' mental modes
- B. Knowledge of others' mental modes and omniscience
- C. Sense-and-mind cognition and clairvoyant knowledge
- D. Sense-and-mind cognition and verbal or scriptural knowledge

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: both members are strictly direct, since the soul knows without the mediation of sense or mind, even though both remain limited.
- **B:** Incorrect: both are direct, and omniscience is the complete case of directness rather than an instance of mediation.
- **C:** Incorrect: it pairs one genuinely mediated kind with one strictly direct kind, so the classification is half right and therefore wrong.
- **D:** Correct: sense-and-mind cognition and verbal or scriptural knowledge are mediated, the second being derived from the first through signs and teaching.

Examiner trap 10: Verbal or scriptural knowledge is not blind faith; it is a mediated cognition dependent on prior cognition and communication, and Jainism grades it accordingly.

MCQ 11. The order of the five kinds of knowledge

Which sequence correctly states the five kinds of Jaina knowledge in ascending order?

- A. Śruta, mati, avadhi, kevala, manañparyāya
- B. Mati, avadhi, śruta, manañparyāya, kevala
- C. Mati, śruta, avadhi, manañparyāya, kevala
- D. Avadhi, manañparyāya, mati, śruta, kevala

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it inverts the first pair and places omniscience before knowledge of others' mental modes, breaking the graded removal of obscuration.
- **B:** Incorrect: it inserts clairvoyance between the two mediated kinds, separating verbal knowledge from the sense-and-mind cognition it derives from.
- **C:** Correct: the canonical ascending order runs sense-and-mind cognition, verbal knowledge, clairvoyance, knowledge of others' mental modes, and omniscience.
- **D:** Incorrect: it places the two direct but limited kinds before the mediated kinds, reversing the logic of progressive unveiling.

Examiner trap 11: The order is not a ranking of usefulness but a curve of karmic unveiling; each step marks how much knowledge-obscuring action-matter has been removed.

MCQ 12. Jaina causation

The Jaina account of causation is best described as

- A. both-existence-and-non-existence of the effect, since the effect pre-exists as substance and is new as mode
- B. pre-existence of the effect without qualification, since nothing genuinely new can ever be produced
- C. fresh production of the effect without qualification, since the effect is entirely absent before its production
- D. dependent origination without any substrate, since causal regularity is all that causal talk records

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the effect is continuous with the cause as enduring substance and novel as fresh mode, which is many-sidedness applied to causal identity.
- **B:** Incorrect: unqualified pre-existence is the Sāṃkhya position, and it makes production add nothing at all.
- **C:** Incorrect: unqualified fresh production is the Nyāya position, and it leaves unexplained why clay yields a jar rather than anything whatever.
- **D:** Incorrect: dependence without a substrate is the Buddhist framing, which Jainism rejects because it dissolves the persisting bearer of change.

Examiner trap 12: Calling Jaina causation *satkāryavāda* is a common slip; the whole point of the Jaina label is the added respect-index that Sāṃkhya does not use.

MCQ 13. What many-sidedness asserts

The doctrine of many-sidedness (*anekāntavāda*) primarily asserts that

- A. all judgements are equally true, since standpoints cannot be ranked and disagreement is therefore merely apparent
- B. reality is unknowable in itself, so that every description reports only the classificatory habits of the describer
- C. contradictory properties genuinely belong to one thing at one time and in one and the same respect
- D. the real object possesses innumerable aspects, so no single unqualified proposition exhausts it

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: equal truth for all judgements is relativism, whereas Jainism grades judgements by whether they respect their own conditions.
- **B:** Incorrect: unknowability contradicts Jaina realism, which holds that aspects are objectively in the thing and are genuinely reached under standpoints.
- **C:** Incorrect: identity of respect is exactly what the *syāt* operator excludes; without different indices there would be a plain contradiction.
- **D:** Correct: the thesis is that the real is *ananta-dharmātmakam vastu*, so finite judgement necessarily captures an aspect rather than the whole.

Examiner trap 13: Many-sidedness is ontology before it is logic; a script that introduces it as tolerance or open-mindedness has lost the derivation that the doctrine of judgement depends on.

MCQ 14. Three doctrines, three levels

Which formulation correctly distinguishes the three doctrines?

- A. Many-sidedness is metaphysical, standpoint theory is epistemic, and conditional predication is the logical-linguistic form of assertion
- B. Many-sidedness is logical, standpoint theory is ethical, and conditional predication is the metaphysical basis of the other two
- C. Many-sidedness and conditional predication are identical, while standpoint theory is a later scholastic elaboration of both
- D. Standpoint theory is metaphysical, conditional predication is epistemic, and many-sidedness is a rule of monastic debate

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the three occupy distinct levels, and the sevenfold predication is the formal schema in which the third operates.
- **B:** Incorrect: it misassigns every level and turns standpoint theory into ethics, which no Jaina exposition supports.
- **C:** Incorrect: identifying the metaphysical thesis with the mode of assertion destroys the derivation from object to knower to sentence.
- **D:** Incorrect: reducing many-sidedness to a debating convention removes the ontological claim on which the whole system rests.

Examiner trap 14: The examiner is testing levels, not vocabulary; naming all three terms without assigning each its level scores as recall rather than understanding.

MCQ 15. The first of the seven standpoints

Which one of the following is the first member of the classical list of seven standpoints (*naya*)?

- A. *Samgraha naya*, the generic standpoint attending to shared class-character
- B. *R̥jusūtra naya*, the standpoint restricted to the thing in its present state
- C. *Naigama naya*, the mixed practical or purposive standpoint
- D. *Evambhūta naya*, the standpoint on which a term applies only during actual function

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the generic standpoint is second, and it narrows what the first standpoint leaves deliberately mixed.
- **B:** Incorrect: the present-state standpoint is fourth and forms the hinge between substance-directed and mode-directed views.
- **C:** Correct: the mixed practical or purposive standpoint opens the list, blending general and particular, often through intention.
- **D:** Incorrect: the function-in-act standpoint is seventh and the strictest, so placing it first inverts the entire funnel.

Examiner trap 15: The list moves from loosest to strictest; reciting it out of order destroys the analytical point that partiality tightens as language becomes more literal.

MCQ 16. Matching a standpoint with its emphasis

Which pairing of a standpoint with its characteristic emphasis is correct?

- A. *Vyavahāra naya* - the etymological differentiation of synonymous words
- B. *Śabda naya* - the class-character shared by every member of a kind
- C. *Samgraha naya* - the thing considered strictly as it is at the present moment
- D. *Evambhūta naya* - the term applies only while the named function is being performed

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: etymological differentiation belongs to *samabhirūḍha*, while the practical standpoint concerns ordinary dealings with particulars.
- **B:** Incorrect: class-character belongs to the generic standpoint, while the verbal standpoint attends to the expression actually used.
- **C:** Incorrect: the present-moment restriction belongs to *ṛjusūtra*; the generic standpoint deliberately abstracts from present particularity.
- **D:** Correct: on the function-in-act standpoint a person counts as a singer only while singing is actually occurring.

Examiner trap 16: The last three standpoints are all verbal, so they are easily swapped; distinguish attention to the word, to its derivation, and to the performance it names.

MCQ 17. What the particle *syāt* contributes

In the doctrine of conditional predication, the particle *syāt* is best rendered as

- A. "probably", marking that the assertion is likely but not certain on the evidence available to the speaker
- B. "in a certain respect", marking a definite assertion restricted by substance, place, time and mode
- C. "apparently", marking that the assertion holds for appearances although the thing in itself is unknown
- D. "let it be granted", marking a provisional concession made only for the purposes of a formal debate

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: probability is precisely the reading Jaina authors reject, since the assertion is definite and only its respect is restricted.
- **B:** Correct: the operator states the respect in which the predication holds, which is why it blocks absolutisation without weakening assertion.
- **C:** Incorrect: an appearance-reality split is alien to Jaina realism, in which aspects are objectively in the thing.
- **D:** Incorrect: a debating concession is temporary and strategic, whereas the operator is a permanent feature of correct assertion.

Examiner trap 17: "The jar conditionally exists" is not a guess that the jar probably exists; treating *syāt* as a hedge converts a realist doctrine into scepticism.

MCQ 18. The fourth of the seven predications

In the sevenfold predication (*saptabhaṅgī*), the fourth member is

- A. *syād asti ca nāsti ca*, in some respect it is and it is not
- B. *syān nāsti*, in some respect it is not
- C. *syād asti ca avaktavyam*, in some respect it is and is inexpressible
- D. *syād avaktavyam*, in some respect it is inexpressible

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: the successive conjunction of affirmation and negation is the third member, not the fourth.
- **B:** Incorrect: simple negation is the second member and is one of the three primitives from which the rest are built.
- **C:** Incorrect: the combination of affirmation with inexpressibility is the fifth member, which presupposes the fourth already stated.
- **D:** Correct: inexpressibility is the third primitive and stands as the fourth member, arising when affirmation and negation are demanded simultaneously and unqualifiedly.

Examiner trap 18: Three primitives taken singly, in pairs and jointly give three plus three plus one; misplacing inexpressibility breaks the combinatorial derivation that explains why there are exactly seven.

MCQ 19. The meaning of inexpressibility

In the sevenfold predication, *avaktavya* chiefly signifies that

- A. a single unqualified expression cannot convey affirmation and negation simultaneously
- B. the object in question lies wholly beyond language and can be approached only in silence
- C. the speaker suspends judgement because the available evidence is insufficient for assertion
- D. the proposition takes a third truth-value lying between plain truth and plain falsity

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: inexpressibility records a limit of simultaneous unqualified expression, not a limit of reality or of the speaker's evidence.
- **B:** Incorrect: mystical ineffability is not the Jaina claim, since the same object is expressible under each separate index.
- **C:** Incorrect: suspension of judgement is scepticism, whereas each of the seven forms is an assertion under a stated condition.
- **D:** Incorrect: a third truth-value would make the operator a semantic value rather than a standpoint index, which Jaina authors do not claim.

Examiner trap 19: Inexpressibility is a fact about one utterance, not about the thing; the same jar is perfectly expressible once the respect is separated out.

MCQ 20. Why no contradiction arises

The Jaina claim that "in some respect the jar is and is not" escapes formal contradiction because

- A. affirmation is literal while negation is figurative, so the two predicates never occupy the same logical plane
- B. the law of non-contradiction is denied outright, and Jaina logic replaces it with a rule of graded assertion
- C. one of the two predications is always merely conventional and is finally cancelled by the other
- D. affirmation and negation are indexed to different substance, place, time or mode, so the respects differ

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: no Jaina text makes negation figurative; both predications are literal and both are true under their own index.
- **B:** Incorrect: the doctrine preserves non-contradiction rather than abandoning it, which is precisely how it answers Śaṃkara.
- **C:** Incorrect: cancellation of one level by another is the Advaita structure of sublation, which Jaina aspect-realism does not employ.
- **D:** Correct: contradiction requires the same respect, time and sense, and the four indices guarantee that this identity never obtains.

Examiner trap 20: Without naming substance, place, time and mode the reply to the contradiction charge is an assertion rather than an argument, and examiners mark exactly that difference.

MCQ 21. The self-refutation objection

The standard self-refutation objection against many-sidedness argues that

- A. the doctrine cannot explain how a single soul is reborn while remaining numerically the same individual
- B. if every assertion must be qualified then the doctrine itself must be qualified, and it then loses universal force
- C. the doctrine presupposes a creator who guarantees that the many aspects of a thing form a coherent whole
- D. the seven predications are too few, since the number of aspects in a real thing is admittedly innumerable

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: personal identity across rebirth is answered by the enduring substance, and it is not what the self-refutation charge targets.
- **B:** Correct: the dilemma is that qualification appears to weaken the thesis while non-qualification appears to violate its own rule.
- **C:** Incorrect: no critic derives a creator from many-sidedness, and Jainism denies a creator on independent grounds.
- **D:** Incorrect: the number seven is derived combinatorially from three primitives and does not claim to enumerate aspects.

Examiner trap 21: The Jaina reply accepts the first horn rather than escaping the dilemma: the thesis is itself asserted conditionally, and that obedience is offered as evidence of consistency.

MCQ 22. The 2022 absolutism charge

Which is the strongest Jaina reply to the claim that non-absolutism cannot be sustained without postulating absolutism?

- A. Non-absolutism denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers, while omniscience remains the internal case of complete knowledge
- B. Non-absolutism is a purely practical maxim of debate and therefore makes no claim about reality that could be absolute
- C. Non-absolutism is asserted absolutely, and the resulting exception is accepted as the necessary cost of any general theory
- D. Non-absolutism concerns only religious language, so the objection misapplies a logical test to a devotional context

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the charge equivocates between denying exclusivism and denying comprehensiveness, and separating them dissolves the alleged contradiction.
- **B:** Incorrect: reducing the doctrine to a debating maxim abandons its ontological content and concedes the triviality charge instead.
- **C:** Incorrect: claiming an open exception is exactly what the objection alleges and would confirm rather than answer it.
- **D:** Incorrect: many-sidedness is asserted of reality generally, so restricting it to religious language misdescribes the doctrine.

Examiner trap 22: The reply does not eliminate the unconditioned; it relocates it to omniscience, and a critical answer should record that residue rather than declare a clean victory.

MCQ 23. What is distinctive about Jaina action-matter

Which statement best captures the Jaina conception of action and moral consequence (*karma*)?

- A. It is an unseen quality residing in the self that produces its result at the appointed time without material mediation
- B. It is subtle matter that flows toward the soul and adheres to it, with passion determining the depth and duration of that adhesion
- C. It is a mental impression left by volition, so that continuity of character is secured without any enduring bearer
- D. It is an unseen potency generated by ritual action alone, which links the act performed to the result eventually enjoyed

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: an unseen quality of the self is the Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika *adṛṣṭa*, which Jainism replaces with genuinely material particles.
- **B:** Correct: action-matter is a form of matter, and the pairing of activity with passion fixes what is bound and for how long.
- **C:** Incorrect: a mental impression without a bearer is the Buddhist *vāsanā*, which cannot supply Jaina material bondage.
- **D:** Incorrect: a ritual potency is the Mīmāṃsā *apūrva*, and it is neither material nor tied to the passions in the Jaina manner.

Examiner trap 23: Writing "karma" without "material" loses the single thesis that makes the Jaina account distinctive among Indian theories of moral consequence.

MCQ 24. Two forms of bondage

Which pair correctly distinguishes the two forms of bondage recognised by the Jainas?

- A. Psychic bondage is the soul's own passionate modification, while material bondage is the actual adhesion of karmic particles
- B. Psychic bondage is bondage to mental objects, while material bondage is bondage to physical objects such as wealth and body
- C. Psychic bondage occurs in ascetics who retain subtle pride, while material bondage occurs only in householders
- D. Psychic bondage is the intention behind an act, while material bondage is the external act as observed by others

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: *bhāvabandha* is a modification of the soul and *dravyabandha* is the material adhesion it attracts, and the two are distinct yet interlinked.
- **B:** Incorrect: the distinction is not between kinds of object but between the soul's state and the matter that adheres to it.
- **C:** Incorrect: both forms operate for any bound soul; the ascetic-householder difference concerns the scope of vows, not the kinds of bondage.
- **D:** Incorrect: reducing the pair to intention and outward act loses the ontological claim that karmic matter really adheres.

Examiner trap 24: Collapsing the two forms costs either the moral psychology or the ontology; the 2024 paper asks for the distinction precisely because it carries both.

REMEDIAL DRILLS - 8 ERROR-TARGETING ITEMS

MCQ 25. The five causes of bondage

Which set correctly gives the five causes of bondage recognised in Jaina soteriology?

- A. Ignorance, craving, clinging, becoming and birth
- B. Influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding and liberation
- C. Wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passions and activity
- D. Anger, pride, deceit, greed and delusion

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: this is a Buddhist chain of dependent origination and has no place in a Jaina list of causes of bondage.
- **B:** Incorrect: these are stages of the soteriological sequence, four of which are remedies or outcomes rather than causes.
- **C:** Correct: wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passion and activity are the standard five, with passion supplying adhesion and activity the channel.
- **D:** Incorrect: anger, pride, deceit and greed are the passions, so this option expands one cause into the whole list.

Examiner trap 25: The passions are one member of the list, not the list itself; a script that gives four passions plus delusion has answered a different question.

MCQ 26. What determines what in bondage

Which pairing of a bondage parameter with its principal determinant is correct?

- A. Duration is determined by activity, while type is determined by passion
- B. Intensity is determined by activity, while quantity is determined by passion
- C. Type is determined by wrong vision, while duration is determined by carelessness
- D. Type and quantity are determined by activity, while duration and intensity are determined by passion

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it reverses the division of labour, and duration is the parameter most clearly governed by the passions.
- **B:** Incorrect: it also reverses the pairing, since intensity of fruition tracks passion and quantity of matter tracks activity.
- **C:** Incorrect: wrong vision and carelessness are causes of bondage, not determinants of these four technical parameters.
- **D:** Correct: activity fixes which karma and how much, while passion fixes how long and how strongly, which is why passion-free activity binds only momentarily.

Examiner trap 26: This pairing is the technical basis of the contrast between momentary and durable bondage; reversing it silently destroys the Jaina ethics of intention.

MCQ 27. Destructive and non-destructive karmas

Which set contains only destructive (*ghātiyā*) karmas?

- A. Vedanīya, nāma, gotra and āyus
- B. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, vedanīya and gotra
- C. Jñānāvaraṇīya, darśanāvaraṇīya, mohanīya and antarāya
- D. Mohanīya, antarāya, nāma and āyus

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: all four members are non-destructive, since they determine felt experience, body, status and lifespan without obscuring essential qualities.
- **B:** Incorrect: it mixes two knowledge- and perception-obscuring karmas with two that merely structure embodiment.
- **C:** Correct: these four obstruct knowledge, perception, right orientation and power, which is why their destruction yields omniscience at the thirteenth stage.
- **D:** Incorrect: it pairs two genuinely destructive karmas with two that determine body and lifespan.

Examiner trap 27: Deluding karma is the most dangerous of the destructive group because it corrupts both right vision and right conduct; omitting it from the destructive set is a substantive error.

MCQ 28. Seven principles and nine categories

The nine categories (*padārtha*) of Jaina exposition consist of

- A. the seven principles together with substance and mode, which supply the ontological framework
- B. the seven principles together with merit and demerit, which make moral valence explicit
- C. the six substances together with influx, bondage and liberation, which complete the cosmology
- D. the seven principles together with right knowledge and right conduct, which complete the path

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: substance and mode belong to the general theory of the real and are not added to the sevenfold list.
- **B:** Correct: merit and demerit are added to the seven principles, and they can also be subsumed under influx and bondage.
- **C:** Incorrect: the six substances are a different enumeration and are not combined with three members of the sevenfold list.
- **D:** Incorrect: right knowledge and right conduct belong to the three jewels and are not counted among the categories.

Examiner trap 28: Merit is still bondage; treating it as a stage on the way to liberation confuses a better rebirth with release from rebirth altogether.

MCQ 29. Stoppage and shedding

Which statement correctly distinguishes stoppage (*saṃvara*) and shedding (*nirjarā*)?

- A. Stoppage removes karma already bound, while shedding prevents new karma from being bound at all
- B. Stoppage belongs to householders and shedding to ascetics, the two being stages of a single vow
- C. Stoppage and shedding are alternative names for the same disciplinary process, differing only by tradition
- D. Stoppage blocks fresh influx of karmic matter, while shedding wears away karma already accumulated

Answer: D.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: it exactly reverses the two functions, which is the most frequent error in answers on the soteriological sequence.
- **B:** Incorrect: both operate at every level of practice, and neither is restricted by monastic status.
- **C:** Incorrect: the sequence lists them as distinct stages precisely because bondage has two independent problems, arrival and accumulation.
- **D:** Correct: stoppage is preventive and shedding is eliminative, which is why vows and austerity are both required for liberation.

Examiner trap 29: Austerity accelerates shedding but does not replace stoppage; sweeping a room whose door stands open is the image the tradition itself invites.

MCQ 30. The eleventh stage of spiritual development

With reference to the fourteen stages, which statement is correct?

- A. The eleventh stage destroys delusion permanently and therefore leads directly to the twelfth and thirteenth stages
- B. The eleventh stage only suppresses delusion, so a soul reaching it by that ladder necessarily falls back
- C. The eleventh stage marks the attainment of right vision for the first time and is the decisive breakthrough
- D. The eleventh stage is the momentary activity-free condition immediately preceding the perfected state

Answer: B.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: destruction of delusion is the twelfth stage, reached by the ladder of annihilation rather than by suppression.
- **B:** Correct: suppressed delusion is covered rather than destroyed, so the ladder of suppression cannot hold the eleventh stage.
- **C:** Incorrect: the first stable attainment of right vision is the fourth stage, which is the decisive breakthrough of the ascent.
- **D:** Incorrect: the momentary activity-free condition is the fourteenth stage, immediately before the perfected state.

Examiner trap 30: Suppression and destruction look identical from outside and have opposite futures; the two ladders exist to explain spiritual relapse without treating it as failure of insight.

MCQ 31. Omniscience while embodied

The condition described as *sayoga-kevali* is best characterised as

- A. a soul that has suppressed all passions and awaits the fruition of its deluding karma before liberation
- B. a householder who has taken the lesser vows and attained limited clairvoyant knowledge of material things
- C. an omniscient being still embodied and active, whose destructive karmas are destroyed while non-destructive karmas remain
- D. a perfected soul at the summit of the world, disembodied and free from every trace of karmic matter

Answer: C.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Incorrect: mere suppression belongs to the eleventh stage and is incompatible with the omniscience that defines this condition.
- **B:** Incorrect: lesser vows and clairvoyance belong far lower on the ladder and involve no destruction of the obscuring karmas.
- **C:** Correct: destruction of the destructive karmas yields omniscience, while the remaining non-destructive karmas sustain embodiment and activity.
- **D:** Incorrect: the disembodied perfected soul is the *siddha*, which follows only after the fourteenth stage.

Examiner trap 31: This is the Jaina form of liberation-in-life; denying that omniscience can coexist with embodiment misreads the destructive and non-destructive division of karmas.

MCQ 32. Voluntary passionless death

Which statement about *sallekhanā* is doctrinally the safest to write in an examination?

- A. It is a gradual, supervised and passion-free relinquishment of food undertaken when death is already unavoidable or decline incurable
- B. It is a meritorious act of self-destruction that may be undertaken by any practitioner who wishes to shorten a difficult life
- C. It has been conclusively settled in Indian law as a protected religious practice, so its legal status raises no further question
- D. It is identical with suicide in every philosophically relevant respect, differing only in the vocabulary used to describe it

Answer: A.

Option explanations:

- **A:** Correct: the vow requires equanimity, supervision, gradualness and the absence of any desire for death or for continued life.
- **B:** Incorrect: a wish to shorten life is itself a passion and converts the observance into a transgression of the vow's own discipline.
- **C:** Incorrect: legal holdings must not be asserted without verification, and an examination answer should report the controversy rather than settle it.
- **D:** Incorrect: suicide is sudden, passion-driven and often concealed, whereas the vow is gradual, passionless, non-violent and public.

Examiner trap 32: The doctrinal test is the inner state, not the outward abstention; if desire for death, attachment or hope of reward enters, the act becomes a transgression rather than a fulfilment of the vow.

PYQS AND ANSWER PRACTICE

Practice status and source discipline - read once, applies to every solution below

Verified wording. Every previous-year question below is reproduced exactly as printed in the held UPSC Civil Services (Main) Philosophy Paper I question papers, 2018-2025, with the year, question number and marks as printed. **No official key exists in the repository for these descriptive questions.** The model answers are independent learner practice written to the stated word band and directive. They are never presented as official UPSC keys, and no objective answer letter is asserted for any descriptive question. **Ownership.** Nine of the ten solved questions are primary-owned by Jainism. The tenth is primary-owned by Cārvāka and is solved here because its second half cannot be answered without the Jaina conception of reality. **Word bands used.** 10 marks: 150-200 words. 15 marks: 250-300 words. 20 marks: 340-400 words.

VERIFIED PREVIOUS-YEAR QUESTIONS - TEN COMPLETE SOLUTIONS

Question, as printed: How do the Jaina philosophers explain 'bondage'? What, according to them, is the distinction between 'liberated soul' and 'bound soul'? What do the Jainas think about the condition of the 'liberated soul'? Discuss.

Demand decoded. Three explicit demands under a "Discuss" directive: the mechanism of bondage, the contrast between two classes of soul, and the positive condition of the liberated soul. Answer all three in order; the third is the one most scripts omit.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Jaina bondage is a real material event, not a moral metaphor. The soul is intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge, perception, bliss and power, yet in embodied life these stand obscured. That obscuration requires a binding factor, and Jainism identifies it as action-matter (*karma-pudgala*), a subtle form of matter drawn to the soul.

The mechanism runs through five causes: wrong vision, non-restraint, carelessness, passions and activity. Activity of body, speech and mind opens the channel of influx (*āsrava*) and determines the type and quantity of karma bound; passion supplies the adhesion and determines its duration and intensity. Bondage therefore has two faces: psychic bondage (*bhāvabandha*), the soul's own passionate modification, and material bondage (*dravyabandha*), the actual adhesion of karmic particles. The relation is beginningless (*anādi*) but not endless.

The bound soul (*baddha-jīva*) is thus an embodied, karmically conditioned knower whose native capacities are veiled and whose body, status, lifespan and felt experience are determined by the non-destructive karmas. The liberated soul (*mukta-jīva*) is one from which stoppage (*saṁvara*) has excluded fresh influx and shedding (*nirjarā*) has removed the accumulated deposit, so that nothing foreign remains.

On its condition, the Jainas are precise. The liberated soul is a perfected soul (*siddha*): disembodied, activity-free, beyond rebirth, and manifesting the infinite tetrad in full. Crucially it retains numerical individuality; there is no merger into a universal consciousness as in Advaita, and no dissolution as in accounts of no-self. Being unweighted by karmic matter it rises to the summit of the world (*siddha-śilā*).

The account is internally coherent, though the interaction of formless soul and subtle matter remains its contested joint.

Question, as printed: How is reality defined by the Jainas? How is this theory of reality reflected in their view on judgements? Discuss.

Demand decoded. The hinge word is "reflected". The examiner wants a derivation, not two separate essays. Define reality first; then show that the theory of judgement follows from that definition rather than accompanying it.

Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).

The Jainas define the real (*sat*) as that which possesses origination (*utpāda*), decay (*vyaya*) and persistence (*dhrauvya*) together. The definition is chosen to save two facts that rival definitions sacrifice. Pure permanence cannot explain that a bracelet became a ring; pure flux cannot explain why this is recognised as the same gold. Indexing permanence to substance (*dravya*) and change to mode (*pariyāya*), with quality (*guṇa*) as the abiding characteristic, secures both.

From this follows many-sidedness (*anekāntavāda*): the real is *ananta-dharmātmakaṁ vastu*, a thing constituted by innumerable aspects. Its ontology is pluralist - six substances, of which five are extended, and innumerable souls - and its causation is correspondingly qualified, the effect being continuous with the cause as substance and novel as mode.

The reflection in judgement is strict rather than analogical. Ordinary cognition is *kṣāyopaśamika*, arising from the partial destruction-cum-subsidence of knowledge-obscuring karma; it is therefore necessarily partial. A judgement by a non-omniscient knower captures an aspect, not the whole. That yields standpoint theory (*ṇayavāda*), and the tradition classifies seven standpoints, running from the mixed practical view through the generic, the particular and the present-state view to the three increasingly literal verbal standpoints. A standpoint that denies the remaining aspects ceases to be a standpoint and becomes its perversion (*ṇayābhāsa*), which is the technical form of one-sidedness

(*ekāntavāda*).

Because judgement is standpoint-bound, assertion must carry the operator *syāt*: conditional predication (*syādvāda*). Combining affirmation, negation and inexpressibility under that operator, taken singly, pairwise and jointly, yields exactly seven predications (*saptabhāṅgī*) - three plus three plus one. Opposed predications are indexed to substance, place, time and mode, so existence is asserted in own-form and non-existence in other-form; contradiction would require identity of respect, which the operator excludes.

Thus the theory of judgement is not an ornament on the theory of reality but its epistemic consequence: because the object exceeds any single finite judgement, and because the knower is karmically partial, unconditioned assertion is available only to omniscience (*kevala-jñāna*).

The derivation is powerful, though Śaṅkara's residual objection - that a doctrine which qualifies even itself weakens its assertoric force - is not fully removed.

PYQ 3 · 2020 · Q5(a) · 10 marks · Jainism

Question, as printed: Examine the concept of Karma according to Jainism. How does it bear upon their conception of Liberation?

Demand decoded. "Examine" asks for accurate componential analysis, and the second sentence demands the causal link. A definition without the bearing scores half.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

For Jainism, action and moral consequence is not an unseen quality of the self, as in Nyāya *adr̥ṣṭa*, nor a ritual potency as in Mīmāṃsā *apūrva*, nor a mental impression as in Buddhist *vāsanā*. It is subtle matter (*karma-pudgala*) that flows toward the soul and adheres to it. Psychical action-matter (*bhāva-karma*), the soul's passionate modification, attracts material action-matter (*dravya-karma*).

Adhesion is analysed under four parameters: activity fixes the type and quantity bound, while passion fixes the duration and intensity. Eight karma-types divide into four destructive, which obscure knowledge, perception, right orientation and power, and four non-destructive, which determine felt experience, body, status and lifespan.

The bearing on liberation (*mokṣa*) is direct. Since bondage is a real deposit, liberation is subtraction and not acquisition: stoppage (*saṃvara*) closes the channel and shedding (*nirjarā*) removes the accumulation. Destroying the destructive karmas yields omniscience while still embodied; exhausting the non-destructive karmas yields the perfected soul.

Liberation therefore reveals what the soul always was, rather than conferring anything new.

Question, as printed: Explain the Jaina view of seven-fold (sapta-bhaṅgī) 'Naya'.

Demand decoded. The printed wording fuses two distinct doctrines - the sevenfold predication and standpoint theory. A safe answer explains **both** and expressly distinguishes them, rather than assuming the fusion is doctrinally correct.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

The printed phrase joins two doctrines that Jaina authors keep apart, so both must be explained. Standpoint theory (*nayavāda*) concerns perspectives; the sevenfold predication (*saptabhaṅgī*) concerns propositional forms.

Standpoint theory holds that every ordinary judgement expresses a *naya*, a partial but legitimate view of a many-sided real. The classical seven are: the mixed practical or purposive standpoint (*naigama*); the generic standpoint (*saṃgraha*); the practical particular standpoint (*vyavahāra*); the present-state standpoint (*rjūsūtra*); the verbal standpoint (*śabda*); the etymological standpoint (*samabhirūḍha*); and the function-in-act standpoint (*evambhūta*), on which a person counts as a singer only while singing. The list narrows from loosest to strictest; the first three are substance-directed, the last three mode-directed and verbal, with the present-state view as the hinge.

The sevenfold predication is generated differently. Three primitives - affirmation, negation and inexpressibility - taken singly, in pairs and jointly yield exactly seven forms: *syād asti*; *syān nāsti*; *syād asti ca nāsti ca*; *syād avaktavyam*; *syād asti ca avaktavyam*; *syān nāsti ca avaktavyam*; and *syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam*. Each is governed by the operator *syāt*, which states the respect and does not mean "perhaps".

The two are related but not identical: standpoints supply the respects; predications express them in disciplined sentential form. Contradiction is avoided because opposed predications are indexed to different substance, place, time or mode. Inexpressibility marks a limit of simultaneous unqualified expression, not a third truth-value.

The doctrine is therefore a theory of conditioned assertion rather than of doubt, though critics from Śaṃkara onward hold that permanent qualification dilutes assertoric force.

PYQ 5 · 2022 · Q5(d) · 10 marks · Jainism

Question, as printed: How does Jaina view of Karma bear upon their soteriology? Critically discuss.

Demand decoded. Same subject-matter as 2020 Q5(a), but the directive adds "critically": the answer must end with an evaluation, not a description.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

Because Jaina action-matter is literally material, soteriology becomes a physics of removal rather than a programme of moral improvement. Activity opens the influx channel and fixes what and how much is bound; passion fixes how long and how strongly it fruits. Hence passion-free activity produces only momentary bondage (*īryāpathika*), whereas passion-coloured activity produces durable bondage (*sāmparāyika*).

Two remedies follow, because bondage has two problems. Stoppage (*saṃvara*), operated through the vows, restraint, carefulness, the virtues, contemplations and endurance of afflictions, blocks fresh influx. Shedding (*nirjarā*), operated chiefly through austerity, exhausts what is already bound. Merit does not substitute for either, since even good karma keeps the soul in the cycle of rebirth.

Critically, the doctrine gains real explanatory precision: it grounds an ethics of intention in a causal mechanism, and it explains graded spiritual progress. Its cost is equally real. Nyāya presses that material karma cannot intelligibly bind a formless consciousness, and a Cārvāka denies the whole apparatus as unverifiable.

The account is therefore coherent within Jaina ontology, not demonstrable outside it.

Question, as printed: 'The doctrine of Relativism of Jain Philosophy cannot be logically sustained without postulating 'Absolutism'.' Critically examine this view and give reasons in the favour of your answer.

Demand decoded. A stated view must be engaged, not paraphrased. Locate the equivocation, give the Jaina reply, then take a reasoned position and state what survives.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

The quoted view rests on an equivocation between two senses of "absolute". Jaina non-absolutism (*anekāntavāda*) denies **one-sided exclusivism** by finite knowers; it does not deny that comprehensive knowledge is possible. Once the two are separated, the alleged self-contradiction dissolves.

The charge runs: the doctrine claims universal scope; universal scope appears absolute; therefore the doctrine covertly relies on what it attacks. The Jaina reply is threefold. First, the doctrine is itself asserted *syāt*, so it obeys its own rule; reflexive qualification exhibits the discipline it teaches rather than exempting itself from it. Second, the thesis is not that all judgements are equally true but that truth is aspect-conditioned, so judgements remain gradable by whether they respect their own conditions. Third, within the system omniscience (*kevala-jñāna*) is the internal case of complete knowledge, available when knowledge-obscuring karma is destroyed; ordinary discourse remains standpoint-bound because ordinary cognition is *kṣāyopaśamika*.

It should also be said that "relativism" mislabels the position. Jainism is ontologically realist: the aspects are objectively in the thing, and only finite access to them is partial. Relativism relativises truth; non-absolutism relativises exclusive claims.

Critically, the reply succeeds against the charge as printed but does not leave the field untouched. The unconditioned status has been relocated rather than abolished: omniscience now carries the completeness that finite discourse is denied. A critic may say this concedes the substance of the objection at a higher level.

My position is therefore qualified agreement with the Jaina: the doctrine is logically sustainable and not self-refuting, but it is not standpoint-free, and honesty requires saying that its consistency is purchased by admitting one privileged cognitive state.

Question, as printed: "All human knowledge is empirical and therefore relative." Critically examine Jaina theory of sevenfold judgement (*saptabhaṅgīnaya*) in the light of above statement.

Demand decoded. The quoted proposition is an empiricist thesis. The task is to test whether the sevenfold judgement is an instance of it, and to show precisely where Jainism agrees and where it refuses.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

Jainism agrees with half of the statement and rejects the other half. It agrees that human knowledge is limited: ordinary cognition is *kṣāyopaśamika*, partial because knowledge-obscuring karma is only partly removed, and ordinary perception is only conventionally direct.

It refuses the inference to relativism. The sevenfold judgement - the seven forms generated by affirmation, negation and inexpressibility under the operator *syāt* - records the **respects** in which a predication holds, using the indices of substance, place, time and mode. Each form is a definite assertion, not a probability estimate; *syāt* does not mean "perhaps".

Critically, the difference from empiricist relativism is ontological. For the empiricist, relativity attaches to knowledge because there is no access beyond experience. For Jainism, relativity attaches to finite judgement while the aspects remain objectively in the object, and omniscience remains internally possible.

Hence the statement describes a Jaina premise, not a Jaina conclusion: partiality of knowing does not entail relativity of truth.

Question, as printed: What is the distinction between Bhāvabandha and Dravyabandha, according to the Jainas? Discuss.

Demand decoded. A single precise distinction, discussed. The answer must state both terms exactly, show their causal order, and explain why Jainism refuses to collapse them.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Jaina bondage has two forms which are distinct in nature yet inseparable in operation.

Psychic bondage (bhāvabandha) is a modification of the soul itself. Through passion, attachment, aversion, delusion and wrong disposition the soul undergoes an affective-volitional deformation. This is a state of the conscious substance, describable in the vocabulary of moral psychology.

Material bondage (dravyabandha) is the actual adhesion of karmic particles. Because matter alone possesses form, and because the embodied soul has space-points and is co-extensive with its body, subtle matter can be attracted and fixed. This is an event in the ontology of substances, not a description of an attitude.

The causal order is fixed: psychical action-matter (*bhāva-karma*) attracts material action-matter (*dravya-karma*). Inner deformation precedes and shapes outer adhesion. This is why the four parameters divide as they do - activity determines the type and quantity of matter bound, whereas passion, which is a psychic condition, determines duration and intensity. A monk's careful walking binds momentarily; an angry act binds deeply.

Jainism refuses to collapse the pair because each carries something the other cannot. Retain only psychic bondage and karma becomes a metaphor, leaving the obscuration of an intrinsically omniscient soul unexplained. Retain only material bondage and the system becomes crude physicalism in which intention is irrelevant to moral consequence.

The distinction also organises the path: stoppage works primarily on the psychic side by removing the causes of influx, while shedding works on the material deposit already formed.

Critically, the pairing preserves both agency and ontology, though the interaction of a formless soul with subtle matter - the very point Nyāya attacks - remains the doctrine's unresolved joint.

Question, as printed: Is Jaina philosophy pluralistic and realistic? Critically discuss.

Demand decoded. Two labels, both to be tested. "Critically" requires that each be affirmed with the correct qualifier rather than simply endorsed.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Jaina philosophy is strongly pluralistic and realistic, but its realism must be described as qualified.

It is pluralistic in three independent ways. Ontologically it admits six substances - soul, matter, medium of motion, medium of rest, space and time - of which five are extended. Psychologically it admits innumerable souls, each beginningless and numerically distinct. Soteriologically it holds that liberation produces many perfected souls at the summit of the world, with no merger into any absolute. Monistic reduction is refused at every level.

It is realistic in that substances, qualities and modes are objectively real; the external world is not appearance; and knowledge aims at real objects. Aspects are in the thing, not projected onto it, which is why many-sidedness (*anekāntavāda*) is an ontological thesis before it is a logical one.

The qualifier is epistemic. Because finite cognition is *kṣāyopāśamika* and therefore partial, judgement is standpoint-indexed and assertion carries the operator *syāt*. This yields the decisive formula: qualification of **knowledge** does not entail unreality of the **object**. Ontological realism and epistemic non-absolutism are separable, and Jainism holds both.

Critically, two costs deserve statement. First, Rāmānuja objects that a real substance bearing opposed real attributes is unintelligible, and a Dharmakīrti-style Buddhist presses that a permanent-yet-changing soul fails the test of causal efficacy; the Jaina reply, that the opposition is between aspects of substance and mode, persuades only those who already grant aspect-realism. Second, the pluralism is metaphysically expensive, requiring material action-matter and

intrinsically omniscient souls that a Cārvāka will reject as unverifiable.

The defensible verdict is therefore that Jainism is genuinely pluralistic and genuinely realistic, but its realism is qualified realism rather than naive realism.

PYQ 10 · 2020 · Q7(c) · 15 marks · Cārvāka (supporting routed question)

Question, as printed: Explain the differences of conception of Reality between Cārvāka and Jainism. **Routing note:** primary ownership rests with Cārvāka; it is solved here because the Jaina half of the contrast is owned by this topic and is the half most often written badly.

Demand decoded. "Explain the differences" is comparative and expository. Use fixed axes so that the contrast is systematic rather than anecdotal.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Cārvāka and Jainism differ on the definition of the real, on its inventory and on the reach of knowledge.

Definition. Cārvāka recognises as real only what is materially constituted and, in principle, perceptible. Jainism defines the real as that which possesses origination, decay and persistence together, so permanence and change are equally real in one thing, indexed to substance and mode.

Inventory. Cārvāka admits four elements - earth, water, fire and air - and characteristically rejects ether. Jainism admits six substances, five of them extended, including a conscious substance and two cosmological media that Cārvāka has no use for. Where Cārvāka has one kind of stuff, Jainism has an irreducibly plural ontology.

Consciousness. For Cārvāka, awareness emerges from the organised body, so the living body qualified by consciousness is the self. For Jainism, consciousness is the defining quality of an independent soul, and there are innumerable such souls, intrinsically endowed with infinite knowledge that karma obscures.

Moral consequence and liberation. Cārvāka rejects action-consequence, rebirth and liberation. Jainism makes action-matter literally material, so bondage is a real deposit and liberation is its removal.

Knowledge. Cārvāka restricts valid knowledge to perception and refuses inference independent standing. Jainism accepts inference and testimony as indirect, treats ordinary perception as only conventionally direct, and grades knowledge up to omniscience.

The deepest difference is methodological. Cārvāka's ontology contracts to fit one means of knowledge; Jainism's theory of knowledge expands to fit a many-sided reality. One shrinks the world to secure certainty; the other qualifies assertion to preserve the world's complexity.

ORIGINAL SOLVED MAINS PRACTICE - SIX MODELS

These six questions are original practice items written in UPSC style. They are not previous-year questions and are not represented as such.

Original 1 · 10 marks

Question: Distinguish between many-sidedness (*anekāntavāda*), standpoint theory (*nayavāda*) and conditional predication (*syādvāda*). Why is the order of derivation philosophically significant?

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

The three doctrines occupy different levels and are derived in a fixed order.

Many-sidedness is **metaphysical**: the real object is *ananta-dharmātmakam vastu*, constituted by innumerable aspects, so no single unqualified proposition exhausts it. Standpoint theory is **epistemic**: because finite cognition is partial, every ordinary judgement expresses a *naya*, one legitimate perspective among many; a standpoint that denies the rest becomes its perversion. Conditional predication is **logical-linguistic**: assertion must carry *syāt*, stating the respect in which it holds, and the sevenfold predication is its formal schema.

The order matters for two reasons. First, it makes the logic non-arbitrary. If many-sidedness came last, the *syāt* operator would look like a debating trick; derived first, it makes qualification obligatory. Second, it protects realism. The aspects are in the object; only access is partial. Reversing the order would make Jainism a theory about language

or attitude rather than about the world.

Hence a script that names the three terms but not their levels has recited without explaining.

Original 2 · 10 marks

Question: "In Jainism the moral quality of an act is fixed by passion rather than by activity." Examine this claim with reference to the parameters of bondage.

Model answer (10 marks, 150-200 words).

The claim is accurate if stated with care. Karmic bondage is analysed under four parameters. Activity of body, speech and mind determines the **type** (*prakṛti*) of karma bound and the **quantity** (*pradeśa*) of matter bound. Passion determines the **duration** (*sthiti*) and the **intensity** (*anubhāga*) of its fruition.

Since duration and intensity are the parameters that actually decide how heavily an act weighs on the future of the soul, the moral seriousness of an act tracks passion rather than mere movement. The doctrinal expression of this is the contrast between momentary bondage from passion-free activity and durable bondage from passion-coloured activity: a monk's careful walking binds only momentarily, while an angry act binds deeply.

The claim must nevertheless be qualified. Activity is not morally irrelevant, since it fixes what is bound at all, and total cessation of activity belongs only to the fourteenth stage.

The precise formulation is therefore that activity determines the karmic content while passion determines its karmic weight.

Original 3 · 15 marks

Question: Examine the Jaina claim that ordinary sense-perception is only conventionally direct. What does this reveal about the relation between Jaina epistemology and Jaina soteriology?

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

Jainism divides valid knowledge into direct (*pratyakṣa*) and indirect (*parokṣa*), but measures directness by absence of mediation rather than by sensory vividness. Ordinary sense-perception depends on sense-organs, the mind, signs and karmic limitation. It is therefore only **conventional direct knowledge** (*sāṃvyavahārika pratyakṣa*) and strictly belongs with mediated cognition. What is direct in the full sense is knowledge the soul has by itself: limited clairvoyance (*avadhi*), knowledge of others' mental modes (*manaḥparyāya*) and omniscience (*kevala*).

The claim is defensible on its own terms. It preserves ordinary life, since perception remains valid for practical dealings; it distinguishes practical adequacy from metaphysical finality; and it avoids the Nyāya assumption that sense-contact is the paradigm of directness.

What it reveals is that Jaina epistemology is not a free-standing theory. The five kinds of knowledge are stations on a single curve of karmic unveiling: *matī* and *śruta* are mediated, the remaining three progressively direct, and omniscience is the state in which knowledge-obscuring karma has been destroyed. Knowledge is therefore graded by **purity**, not by method.

Two consequences follow. First, conditional predication becomes obligatory rather than optional, because a *kṣāyopaśamika* knower cannot make an unconditioned claim. Second, wrong cognition is orientation-relative: *kumati*, *kuśruta* and *vibhaṅga* are cognitions held under wrong vision, so error is a spiritual as well as a logical category.

Critically, this integration is the system's strength and its exposure. It gives Jainism a unified account of knowing and liberation, but it makes the epistemology depend on an ontology of soul and karmic matter that an empiricist critic will refuse at the outset.

Original 4 · 15 marks

Question: "Jaina non-violence is a metaphysical consequence, not a sentiment." Critically discuss with reference to the doctrine of the soul and the mechanics of bondage.

Model answer (15 marks, 250-300 words).

The claim is well founded. Jaina non-violence (*ahiṃsā*) is derived, not asserted.

The derivation begins in ontology. Souls are innumerable and graded from one-sense immobile beings - earth-, water-, fire-, air- and plant-bodied - to five-sense mobile beings. Every one of them is a conscious substance intrinsically endowed with the infinite tetrad and currently obscured. Injury therefore falls on a knower, not on a thing.

It continues in the mechanics of bondage. Injury is characteristically produced by passion, and passion fixes the duration and intensity of karmic adhesion. Violence is thus not merely wrong by a rule; it is causally the most efficient way to deepen bondage. Non-violence, conversely, is an operation of stoppage: it closes the channel through which the heaviest karma enters.

The doctrine is graded rather than utopian. Ascetics take the great vows; householders take the lesser vows; and carefulness in movement, speech, alms-seeking, handling objects and bodily functions extends the principle into ordinary conduct. Extreme care toward one-sense beings is an implication of the ontology, not an excess of feeling.

Critically, two points deserve statement. First, the derivation is only as strong as its premises: a critic who denies that plants or elemental bodies house souls will accept the ethics while rejecting its scope. Second, the account is intention-sensitive rather than consequence-sensitive, which is a philosophical choice with costs of its own.

Nevertheless, the central contention holds: Jaina non-violence follows from plural souls and karmic mechanics, and treating it as sentiment removes precisely the argument that makes it distinctive among Indian ethical positions.

Original 5 · 20 marks

Question: Analyse the Jaina fourteen stages of spiritual development. How do the two ladders explain spiritual relapse, and what does this show about the relation between insight and conduct in Jainism?

Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).

The fourteen stages (*guṇasthāna*) map the soul's movement from false vision to final liberation, and they are graded by karmic condition rather than by external observance.

Stages one to three describe wrong, falling and mixed orientation. Stage four, right vision without restraint, is the decisive breakthrough: right vision (*samyag-darśana*) becomes stable enough to orient the path even though conduct has not yet followed. Stage five introduces partial restraint through lay vows. Stages six and seven mark full restraint with and then without negligence. Stages eight to ten describe progressive purification of the passions, from unprecedented purification through advanced purification to the condition in which only subtle greed remains. Stages eleven and twelve mark the crucial difference between suppression and destruction of delusion. Stage thirteen is the embodied omniscient being, and stage fourteen the momentary activity-free condition immediately preceding the perfected state.

The two ladders explain relapse without treating it as mere failure. On the ladder of suppression (*upaśama-śreṇī*), delusion is covered rather than removed; such a soul may reach the eleventh stage, but because suppressed delusion retains its potency the fall is necessary, not accidental. On the ladder of annihilation (*kṣapaka-śreṇī*), delusion is destroyed, so the twelfth stage is stable and the ascent continues to omniscience.

Three philosophical consequences follow. First, appearance and condition come apart: two souls may look identical at the tenth stage and have opposite futures, which is why Jainism refuses to identify spiritual attainment with observable conduct alone. Second, insight and conduct are interdependent rather than alternative. Right vision at stage four is genuine yet insufficient; conduct without right vision has no orientation; and the ladder records the joint operation of the three jewels. Third, omniscience is decoupled from disembodiment: destroying the destructive karmas yields omniscience at stage thirteen, while the non-destructive karmas sustain body, status, lifespan and felt experience until the end.

Critically, an Advaita-style objection holds that a fourteen-stage ladder mechanises liberation, substituting a karmic audit for insight. The Jaina reply is that insight which does not destroy karma has not yet done its work, and that the ladder simply records the difference between a covered and a destroyed defilement.

The scheme is therefore best evaluated as a psychology of purification with an unusually honest account of relapse, and its taxonomic weight is the price of that honesty.

Original 6 · 20 marks

Question: "Jainism preserves the reality of the world at the cost of the simplicity of logic; Advaita preserves the simplicity of logic at the cost of the reality of the world." Critically examine this comparison.

Model answer (20 marks, 340-400 words).

The comparison is illuminating but requires correction on both sides.

On the Jaina side it is broadly accurate. Jainism refuses to treat either permanence or change as appearance. The real is defined as originating, decaying and persisting together, so both are secured - but the price is that predication must be indexed. Assertion carries the operator *syāt*; opposed predications are separated by substance, place, time and mode; and the exhaustive schema of qualified assertion contains seven forms rather than a simple affirmation and denial. Ontological economy is sacrificed too: six substances, innumerable souls and material action-matter are admitted because each performs explanatory work. The world is saved, and logic becomes intricate.

On the Advaita side the statement needs care. Advaita does not abandon the world; it grades it. The world is empirically real and only ultimately *mithyā*, and sublation, not denial, is the operative notion. What Advaita gains is a single ultimate reality with a straightforward account of contradiction: opposed characterisations belong to different levels, and the lower is finally cancelled. So the accurate formulation is that Advaita preserves logical simplicity by admitting **levels of reality**, whereas Jainism preserves ontological plurality by admitting **respects of predication**.

That reformulation locates the real difference. Both schools face the problem of apparently opposed predicates. Advaita separates them **vertically**, by rank, with the lower cancelled at realisation. Jainism separates them **horizontally**, by aspect, with nothing cancelled at all. Vertical separation buys a simple logic and requires a doctrine of appearance; horizontal separation buys an unqualified realism and requires a doctrine of conditional assertion.

Critically, each pays where the other saves. Śaṅkara charges that Jaina qualification erodes assertoric force and that a doctrine which qualifies even itself cannot claim universal scope. The Jaina replies that reflexive qualification is obedience rather than exemption, and counter-charges that treating the world as ultimately *mithyā* purchases simplicity by demoting the very reality it set out to explain. Neither charge is answerable from a neutral standpoint, because each presupposes what the other denies.

The defensible verdict is that the quoted comparison identifies a genuine trade-off but mislabels the Advaita side. Jainism trades logical simplicity for unqualified realism; Advaita trades ontological plurality, not the world itself, for a single unsublated real.

OPTIONAL ADVANCED DEPTH - NOT REQUIRED FOR A CORE ANSWER

Placement note. Everything below is enrichment. A complete, full-marks answer to any verified 2018-2025 Jainism question can be written from the Basic block and the practice sections alone. Use at most one or two lines from this block, and only in the evaluative paragraph of a 15- or 20-marker after the core case is complete.

1. Is the sevenfold predication a logic, or a discipline of assertion?

ANALYSIS: The interpretive issue. Is the sevenfold schema best read as a proto-many-valued logic, as a modal system, or as context-indexed qualified assertion?

ANALYSIS: Two readings.

- *Modern formalising reading:* the seven forms display a sophistication that invites comparison with many-valued or paraconsistent evaluation, and inexpressibility is treated as a distinct semantic value.
- *Classical reading:* the forms are standpoint-conditioned speech disciplined by an ontological many-sidedness; *syāt* is an index of respect, not a truth-value, and inexpressibility marks the failure of a single unqualified utterance rather than a gap in truth.

ANALYSIS: The strongest extra objection and its counter-reply. *Objection:* seven predications collapse into contradiction once formalised. *Reply:* the predications differ by standpoint, time, respect or mode, so they are not brute simultaneous contradictories; formalisation must carry the index, and a formalism that drops it has changed the subject.

ANALYSIS: **Answer use.** One line only, in evaluation: "read as a discipline of indexed assertion rather than as a many-valued logic, the schema is consistent, though its formalisation remains debated."

2. The spatiality of the soul

ANALYSIS: **The interpretive issue.** How can an immaterial conscious substance fit bodies of different size while remaining numerically the same soul?

ANALYSIS: **Two readings.**

- *Literal ontological reading:* the soul really contracts and expands with embodiment, possessing space-points that redistribute.
- *Restrained reading:* the doctrine marks embodiment-capacity and co-extension without materialising the soul, so "size" is a mode of embodied individuality rather than gross magnitude.

ANALYSIS: **Objection and counter-reply.** *Objection:* a non-material reality should not have size-properties at all.

Reply: extension here is a mode of embodied individuality, not gross physical magnitude in the materialist sense; the lamp simile is meant to convey pervasion, not volume.

ANALYSIS: **Answer use.** Deploy only if a question asks directly about the soul's spatiality or presses the Nyāya objection; otherwise the Basic block's treatment is sufficient.

3. Many-sidedness beside Buddhist anti-essentialism

ANALYSIS: **The interpretive issue.** Does Jaina non-absolutism resemble Madhyamaka emptiness, or is it a distinct realist pluralism?

ANALYSIS: **Two readings.**

- *Jaina reading:* real substances persist through real modes, so non-absolutism operates inside a realist ontology.
- *Madhyamaka foil:* all *dharma*s are empty of own-being, so no substance survives the analysis at all.

ANALYSIS: **Objection and counter-reply.** *Objection:* if every statement is conditional, Jainism secretly requires an absolute standpoint. *Reply:* the Jaina can concede an ontological real while denying that finite judgements exhaust it unconditionally - which is precisely the distinction developed in the Basic block for the 2022 question.

ANALYSIS: **Answer use.** This comparison sharpens an evaluation but must never replace the printed Jaina doctrine; it is also a useful guard against writing "Jainism is like Buddhism" in comparative questions.

4. Controlled Western comparison

Comparison	Point of contact	Disanalogy that must be stated
Many-sidedness and perspectivism	ANALYSIS: Both deny a simple view from nowhere for ordinary knowers	FACT: Jainism is realist: aspects are in the object; perspectivism is often read anti-realist
Conditional predication and non-classical logics	ANALYSIS: Seven forms resemble non-classical evaluation	FACT: <i>Syāt</i> is a standpoint-operator, not a third truth-value; inexpressibility is not a truth-value gap
Many-sidedness and dialectic	ANALYSIS: Both allow opposites within the real	FACT: Dialectical opposites are sublated into a higher synthesis; Jaina aspects coexist without sublation
Non-violence and reverence for life	ANALYSIS: Both widen moral concern toward life	FACT: Jaina non-violence is grounded in souls, action-matter and liberation, not in ethical reverence alone
Jaina souls and monads	ANALYSIS: Both are plural centres carrying their own history	FACT: Jaina souls interact with karmic matter and vary in embodied extension; monads do not interact materially
Material action-matter and mechanistic psychology	ANALYSIS: Both seek causal explanation of conduct and character	FACT: Jaina action-matter is subtle moral matter tied to liberation, not value-neutral mechanism

ANALYSIS: **Rubric.** Western parallels are illustrative only and never a substitute for the Jaina argument. Use at most one or two lines, and only after the Jaina case is complete.

5. What not to over-study

ANALYSIS: Full sub-classification trees of the standpoints, cosmographic enumerations, sectarian numerology, and exhaustive sub-varieties of the eight karma-types are **not** answer targets once the owner's realism-relativism-bondage triad is secure. Depth here buys nothing that the Basic block has not already delivered, and it consumes the time an answer needs for its evaluative paragraph.

CONSOLIDATED REGISTER NOTES

Function of this section. These are compressed revision notes for the final pass before an examination. They do not repeat the teaching introductions; they retain definitions, exact terminology, sequences, distinctions, objections, traps, PYQ routes and answer spines in recall form. The Basic and Optional-Advanced distinction is preserved throughout: everything here is core unless explicitly marked optional.

A. System identity

- **Definition:** pluralistic realism with non-absolutist finite predication and a material theory of karmic bondage.
- **Syllabus (verbatim):** *Jainism : Theory of Reality; Saptabhanginaya; Bondage and Liberation.*
- **Textual anchor:** *Tattvārthasūtra* of **Umāsvāti / Umāsvāmī**; authoritative for both major traditions; CAUTION: shared authority ≠ doctrinal uniformity.
- **Names:** Kundakunda (real / conventional standpoints); Siddhasena Divākara, Samantabhadra (early logic); Akalaṅka, Māṇikyanandi, Hemacandra, Yaśovijaya (mature means-of-knowledge tradition).
- **Titles:** *jina* = conqueror of passions; *tīrthaṅkara* = ford-maker, liberated teacher, **not** creator; twenty-four in the present cycle; Rṣabha first, Pārśva twenty-third, Mahāvīra twenty-fourth and a **renewer**, not a founder.
- **Classification:** *nāstika* on the **Veda criterion only**; rebirth, action-consequence and liberation are all affirmed.
- **Non-theism:** *anīśvaravāda* about creation; reverence is for achieved perfection.

B. The real

- **Formula:** *sat* = *utpāda* + *vyaya* + *dhrauvya* - origination, decay and persistence **together**.
- **Why:** pure permanence cannot explain transformation; pure flux cannot explain identity.
- **Illustration:** gold - bracelet-mode ends, ring-mode begins, gold persists.
- **Many-sidedness (anekāntavāda):** the real is *ananta-dharmātmakaṃ vastu*; ontology **before** logic.
- ANALYSIS: Not tolerance, not equal truth of all opinions, not indecision.

C. Substance, quality, mode; the six substances

- **dravya** persists · **guṇa** abides with it · **pariyāya** originates and decays.
- **Six substances:** soul (*jīva*), matter (*pudgala*), medium of motion (*dharma*), medium of rest (*adharma*), space (*ākāśa*), time (*kāla*).
- **Five extended substances (astikāya); time is not an astikāya.** CAUTION: Digambara accounts characteristically affirm time-atoms; some Śvetāmbara discussions treat the substantial independence of time as disputed.
- *dharma* / *adharma* here = media of motion and rest, **not** merit and demerit.
- **Causation:** *sadasatkāryavāda* - continuous as substance, novel as mode; between Sāṃkhya *satkāryavāda* and Nyāya *asatkāryavāda*.

D. The soul

- Innumerable, beginningless, numerically distinct; consciousness (*upayoga*) intrinsic.
- **Infinite tetrad (ananta-catuṣṭaya)**: infinite knowledge, perception, bliss, power - obscured, not absent.
- **Taxonomy**: liberated (*mukta*) / bound (*baddha*); immobile one-sense (*sthāvara*: earth-, water-, fire-, air-, plant-bodied) / mobile (*trasa*: two- to five-sense).
- **Spatiality**: has space-points (*pradeśa*), co-extensive with the body, lamp simile; ANALYSIS: invites the Nyāya objection about a changing eternal.
- **Matter**: only substance with form (*rūpa*); atom (*paramāṇu*), aggregate (*skandha*); **sound is a material modification**, not a quality of ether.

E. Knowledge

- **Direct (pratyakṣa) / indirect (parokṣa)** - directness = absence of mediation.
- Ordinary perception = **sāmvyavahārika pratyakṣa**, conventionally direct only.
- **Five kinds, ascending**: *matī* -> *śruta* (indirect) -> *avadhi* -> *manahparyāya* -> *kevala* (direct).
- **Wrong cognition**: *kumati*, *kuśruta*, *vibhaṅga* - held under wrong orientation (*mithyā-darśana*).
- **Later logic admits**: recollection (*smṛti*), recognition (*pratyabhijñā*), pervasion-grasping reasoning (*tarka / ūha*), inference (*anumāna*), testimony (*śabda*). Contrast: Nyāya denies memory the status of an independent means of knowledge.
- **Ordinary cognition is kṣāyopāśamika** - the exact reason judgement is partial.

F. Standpoints

- **Seven, in order**: *naigama* · *saṃgraha* · *vyavahāra* · *ṛjusūtra* · *śabda* · *samabhirūḍha* · *evambhūta*.
- Funnel: loosest and practical -> strictest and function-in-act; first three substance-directed, *ṛjusūtra* the hinge, last three verbal and mode-directed.
- **Perversion**: standpoint + denial of the rest = *nyāyabhāsa* / *durnaya* = one-sidedness (*ekāntavāda*).
- **Kundakunda**: real standpoint (*nīścaya-naya*) / conventional standpoint (*vyavahāra-naya*); ANALYSIS: not Advaita's two levels, since nothing is sublated.
- **Rival diagnosis**: momentariness absolutises *ṛjusūtra*; permanence-monism absolutises the substance-directed view.

G. Conditional predication and the sevenfold predication

- **syāt*** = "in a certain respect"; a **definite** assertion with a stated index; **never** "perhaps".
- **Seven forms**: *syād asti* · *syān nāsti* · *syād asti ca nāsti ca* · **syād avaktavyam** · *syād asti ca avaktavyam* · *syān nāsti ca avaktavyam* · *syād asti ca nāsti ca avaktavyam*.
- **Derivation**: three primitives singly (3) + in pairs (3) + jointly (1) = 7.
- **Four indices**: substance (*dravya*) · place (*kṣetra*) · time (*kāla*) · mode (*bhāva*); own-form (*svarūpa*) affirms, other-form (*pararūpa*) denies.
- **Inexpressibility**: limit of a **single unqualified simultaneous** utterance; not a third truth-value, not silence.
- **Blind men and the elephant**: pedagogical, not probative; one sentence only.

H. Evaluating non-absolutism

- **Self-refutation charge**: qualified -> weak; unqualified -> inconsistent. **Reply**: accept the first horn; reflexive qualification is obedience, and aspect-conditioned truth ≠ equal truth.
- **Absolutism charge (2022)**: universal scope looks absolute. **Reply**: the doctrine denies one-sided exclusivism by finite knowers, not comprehensiveness; *kevala-jñāna* is the internal complete case. ANALYSIS: Residue: the unconditioned is relocated, not abolished.
- **Pluralism and realism (2025)**: pluralistic on substances, souls and liberated individuals; realist on substances, qualities, modes and the external world; ANALYSIS: **qualified realism**, because judgement is standpoint-indexed. Key line: qualification of knowledge ≠ unreality of the object.

I. Bondage

- **Action-matter is material:** *karma-pudgala*. Contrast: Nyāya *adr̥ṣṭa*, Mīmāṃsā *apūrva*, Sāṃkhya *saṃskāra*, Buddhist *vāsanā* - none of them material particles.
- **Five causes:** wrong vision (*mithyātva*) · non-restraint (*avirati*) · carelessness (*pramāda*) · passions (*kaṣāya*) · activity (*yoga*).
- **Two forms:** psychic bondage (*bhāvabandha*) = the soul's modification; material bondage (*dravyabandha*) = the adhesion of particles. *Bhāva-karma* attracts *dravya-karma*.
- **Four parameters:** type (*prakṛti*) and quantity (*pradeśa*) <- **activity**; duration (*sthiti*) and intensity (*anubhāga* / *rasa*) <- **passion**.
- **Consequence:** momentary bondage (*īryāpathika*) from passion-free activity; durable bondage (*sāmparāyika*) from passion-coloured activity.
- **Eight karma-types:** destructive (*ghātiyā*) - *jñānāvaraṇīya*, *darśanāvaraṇīya*, *mohanīya* (worst; *darśana*- and *cāritra-mohanīya*), *antarāya*; non-destructive (*aghātiyā*) - *vedanīya*, *nāma*, *gotra*, *āyus*.
- **Relation is anādi** - beginningless yet terminable; seed-and-tree, ore-and-gold.

J. Liberation sequence

- **Sequence:** influx (*āsrava*) -> bondage (*bandha*) -> stoppage (*saṃvara*) -> shedding (*nirjarā*) -> liberation (*mokṣa*).
- **Seven principles (tattva):** soul, non-soul, influx, bondage, stoppage, shedding, liberation. **Nine categories (padārtha):** the seven **plus merit (puṇya) and demerit (pāpa)**. Merit is still bondage.
- **Stoppage is preventive; shedding is eliminative.** Both are required.
- **Liberation by subtraction:** the infinite tetrad is revealed, not produced; sooted lamp cleaned, not lit.

K. Ethics and the fourteen stages

- **Three jewels (ratnatraya):** right vision · right knowledge · right conduct - **jointly**, not serially.
- **Five vows:** non-violence (*ahiṃsā*), truthfulness (*satya*), non-stealing (*asteya*), chastity (*brahmacarya*), non-possession (*aparigraha*); **great vows (mahāvratā)** for ascetics, **lesser vows (aṇuvratā)** for householders.
- **Wider discipline:** restraint (*guṇti*), carefulness (*saṃiti*), the ten virtues, contemplations (*anuprekṣā*), endurance of afflictions (*pariśaha-jaya*), right conduct (*cāritra*), austerity (*tapas*).
- **Fourteen stages:** 1 *mithyā-dṛṣṭi* · 2 *sāsvādāna* · 3 *miśra* · 4 *avirata samyag-dṛṣṭi* (**breakthrough**) · 5 *deśavirata* · 6 *pramatta-saṃyāta* · 7 *apramatta-saṃyāta* · 8 *apūrva-karaṇa* · 9 *anivṛtti-bādara* · 10 *sūkṣma-samparāya* · 11 *upaśānta-moha* (**suppressed -> necessarily falls**) · 12 *kṣīṇa-moha* (**destroyed**) · 13 *sayoga-kevalī* · 14 *ayoga-kevalī*.
- **Two ladders:** suppression (*upaśama-śreṇi*) reaches 11 and falls; annihilation (*kṣapaka-śreṇi*) reaches 12 and continues.
- **Embodied omniscience:** *sayoga-kevalī* = the Jaina liberation-in-life; destructive karmas destroyed, non-destructive karmas remain.
- **Liberated soul (siddha):** disembodied, activity-free, beyond rebirth, **numerically distinct**, at the summit of the world (*siddha-śilā*); no merger, no return.
- **Voluntary passionless death (sallekhanā / santhārā):** gradual, supervised, passion-free, undertaken when death is unavoidable; distinguished from suicide (*ātma-ghāta*) by intention, procedure, publicity and non-violence; desire for death or life makes it a transgression (*aticāra*). CAUTION: Do not assert legal holdings.

L. Criticism, comparison and answer discipline

Named critic	Objection	Jaina reply	ANALYSIS: Residual force
Śaṃkara	Many-sidedness allows contradiction and cannot assert itself consistently	Predicates indexed to substance, place, time, mode; <i>syādvāda</i> asserted <i>syāt</i>	Reflexive qualification may seem to weaken assertoric force
Rāmānuja	A real substance with opposed real attributes is unintelligible	Opposition is between aspects of substance and mode	Depends on granting aspect-realism
Dharmakīrti / Buddhist	Permanent-yet-changing soul fails the causal-efficacy (<i>arthakriyā</i>) test	<i>Utpāda-vyaya-dhrauvya</i> : permanent as substance, changing as mode	Strong if the substance-mode distinction is denied
Nyāya	Soul's expansion and material action-matter are unparsimonious	Space-points and the lamp simile; matter explains embodiment	Consciousness-matter interaction remains unresolved
Sāṃkhya / Vedānta	Intrinsic omniscience plus beginningless obscuration is puzzling	<i>Anādi</i> but terminable through stoppage and shedding	No account of why beginningless bondage is possible
Cārvāka / empiricist	Souls, karmic matter, omniscience are unverified	Inference, testimony and systematic coherence	Unpersuasive to strict perception-only materialism

- **Comparative one-liners.** *Buddhism*: no self, momentariness, non-material action-consequence - historically close, metaphysically opposed. *Advaita*: one self, world *mithyā*, merger in liberation. *Nyāya-Vaiśeṣika*: many eternal selves, fresh production of the effect, later theism. *Sāṃkhya*: many changeless *puruṣas*, evolving *prakṛti*, pre-existent effect. *Cārvāka*: body-self, no action-consequence, no liberation.
- **PYQ rail, 2018-2025 (nine owned).** 2018 Q6(c) 15 - bondage, bound / liberated soul. 2019 Q6(a) 20 - reality and judgement. 2020 Q5(a) 10 - action-consequence and liberation. 2021 Q7(c) 15 - sevenfold *naya*. 2022 Q5(d) 10 - action-consequence and soteriology. 2022 Q6(b) 15 - relativism and absolutism. 2023 Q5(a) 10 - sevenfold judgement and empiricist relativity. 2024 Q6(c) 15 - psychic and material bondage. 2025 Q7(c) 15 - pluralistic and realistic. **Supporting routed:** 2020 Q7(c) 15 - Cārvāka and Jaina conceptions of reality (Cārvāka-owned).
- **Ready verdicts.** *10 marks*: Jainism is a pluralistic realism that avoids both pure permanence and pure flux by making every real a unity of substance and mode. *15 marks*: its genius lies in connecting many-sided reality with conditional judgement, but material action-matter and omniscience remain philosophically contestable. *20 marks*: Jainism is best evaluated as a rigorous qualified realism - internally systematic, ethically powerful and logically subtle, yet vulnerable to external critiques of contradiction, soul-matter interaction and unverifiable higher knowledge.
- **Directive discipline.** Discuss -> define, mechanics, one debate. Examine -> componential accuracy. Critically examine -> named objection, reply, graded verdict. Compare -> fixed axes. Distinguish -> tables. Never end a critical answer with a summary.

COMPLETE TOPIC ASCII MASTER FLOW DIAGRAM

This is the terminal-friendly, data-complete master flow. It is authored separately from the graphical package and is validated against the same Basic, Advanced and PYQ ledger.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 1/12: Identity, sources and the shape of the system

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 1/12: Identity, sources and the shape of the system

CENTRAL QUESTION: why does a soul that is intrinsically omniscient behave as an ignorant one?

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v

THE ANSWER THAT ORGANISES EVERYTHING: something REAL is covering it, and that covering is subtle MATTER which arrives through activity and sticks through passion

|

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v		
TITLE-WORDS	TEXTUAL ANCHOR	CLASSIFICATION
jina -> conqueror of passions	Tattvarthasutra of Umasvati (Svetambara) / Umasvami (Digambara)	Veda-rejecting (nastika) on the VEDA CRITERION ONLY
tirthankara -> ford-maker, liberated teacher	first systematic Sanskrit exposition; authoritative	rebirth, action-consequence and liberation are AFFIRMED
NOT a creator for BOTH traditions		-> unlike Carvaka, which is nastika in BOTH senses
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TWENTY-FOUR FORD-MAKERS in the present cycle

Rsabha first · Parsva twenty-third · Vardhamana Mahavira twenty-fourth

Mahavira RENEWED an existing tradition -> never call him the founder

[CONTESTED] precise dates and the earliest ford-makers require separate verification

|
v

NO CREATOR, BUT ACHIEVED AUTHORITY (anisvaravada about creation)

substances are eternal -> modes explain production and destruction

action-matter explains inequality -> a creator does no explanatory work

liberation depends on self-purification, not grace

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v

NAMES TO DEPLOY

Kundakunda (Samayasara) -> real standpoint / conventional standpoint

Siddhasena Divakara, Samantabhadra -> early logic of many-sidedness

Akalanka, Manikyanandi, Hemacandra, Yasovijaya -> mature means-of-knowledge tradition

ANSWER LINE -> "Jainism is a pluralistic realism with non-absolutist finite predication and a material theory of karmic bondage."

TRAP -> shared textual authority is NOT doctrinal uniformity across the two traditions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 2/12: The definition of the real - permanence through change

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 2/12: The definition of the real – permanence through change

DEFINITION: sat = utpada + vyaya + dhrauvya (origination + decay + persistence)
the three terms are JOINT, never alternative

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v                                     v
WHY NOT PURE PERMANENCE?              WHY NOT PURE FLUX?
the bracelet really did become a ring;  THIS gold is recognised as
change would collapse into appearance  the same gold; identity
-> static monism cannot explain transformation  would become a fiction
+-----+-----+
      v

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THE GOLD CASE, READ AS A DEFINITION AND NOT AS AN ILLUSTRATION
bracelet-mode ENDS -> vyaya (decay)
ring-mode BEGINS -> utpada (origination)
gold PERSISTS -> dhrauvya (persistence)
three onlookers, three true reports, one object, no contradiction

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v               v               v
SUBSTANCE (dravya)  QUALITY (guna)  MODE (paryaya)
the enduring bearer  abiding characteristic  changing state
"what changed?"      "what kind of thing?"    "what is it doing now?"
consciousness is a GUNA of the soul; delusion and liberated omniscience are PARYAYAS
+-----+-----+
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MANY-SIDEDNESS (anekantavada): the real is ananta-dharmatmakam vastu
innumerable aspects in one real -> no single unqualified proposition exhausts it
ONTOLOGY FIRST, logic afterwards

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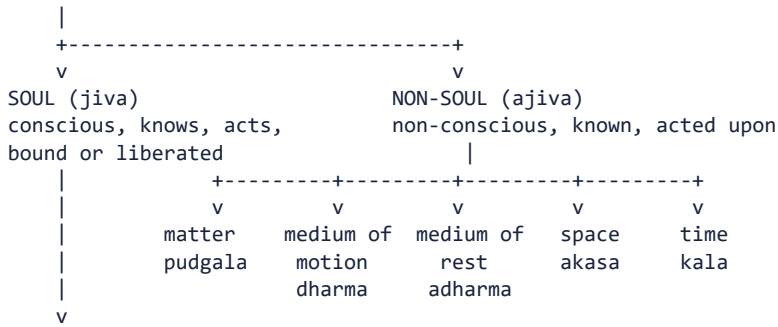
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CAUSATION FOLLOWS: sadasatkaryavada
effect CONTINUOUS with cause as substance • NOVEL as mode
between Samkhya satkaryavada (pre-existence) and Nyaya asatkaryavada (fresh production)
ANSWER LINE -> "The real originates, decays and persists at once, so permanence belongs
to it as substance and change as mode."
TRAP -> calling Jaina causation satkaryavada drops the respect-index that defines it.

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ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 3/12: Six substances and the extension test

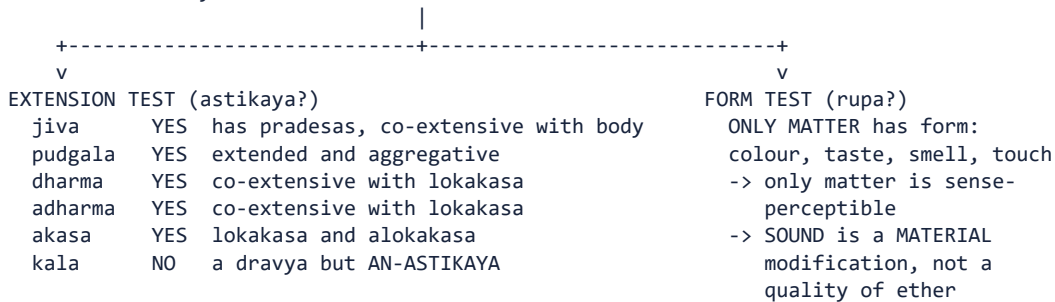
ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 3/12: Six substances and the extension test

EVERYTHING THAT IS



SIX SUBSTANCES, EACH ANSWERING A QUESTION THE OTHERS CANNOT

soul -> why is there an experiencer at all?
matter -> why is there body, sense-object and karmic accretion?
dharma -> why is movement possible? <- an ENABLING CONDITION, not a push
adharma -> why is rest possible? <- an ENABLING CONDITION, not a brake
akasa -> where does everything fit?
kala -> why is there a before and an after?



SAFE FORMULA -> six substances, FIVE extended substances (pancastikaya) plus time
[CONTESTED] Digambara accounts characteristically affirm time-atoms (kala-anus);
some Svetambara discussions treat the substantial independence of time as disputed
TRAP -> dharma / adharma here are MEDIA of motion and rest, never merit and demerit.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 4/12: The soul - nature, taxonomy, spatiality

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 4/12: The soul – nature, taxonomy, spatiality

SOUL (jiva): innumerable · beginningless · numerically distinct · never merged
consciousness (upayoga) is INTRINSIC, not acquired through an internal organ

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INFINITE TETRAD (ananta-catustaya) – present as CAPACITY, obscured in FACT
infinite knowledge · infinite perception · infinite bliss · infinite power
-> bondage is OBSCURATION, not annihilation; liberation is REMOVAL, not addition

|

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LIBERATED (mukta-jiva)
free of every karmic
obstruction

v

BOUND (baddha-jiva)
embodied and karmically
conditioned

v

MORAL CONSEQUENCE
every one-sense being is a
KNOWER, so injury falls on
a conscious substance
-> this is the metaphysical
root of non-violence

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IMMOBILE (sthavara) MOBILE (trasa)
one-sense, touch two- to five-sense
earth-, water-, fire-,
air-, plant-bodied

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SPATIALITY: the soul has space-points (pradesa) and is CO-EXTENSIVE with its body
lamp simile -> the lamp fills the room it occupies without becoming the room
ant-soul fills an ant-body; elephant-soul fills an elephant-body

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THE OBJECTION THIS INVITES (Nyaya, and Dharmakirti in another form)

an eternal self should not literally expand and contract
if it has parts or pradesas, its eternality looks threatened

JAINA REPLY -> extension is a MODE of embodied individuality, not gross magnitude;
permanence is predicated of substance, change of mode

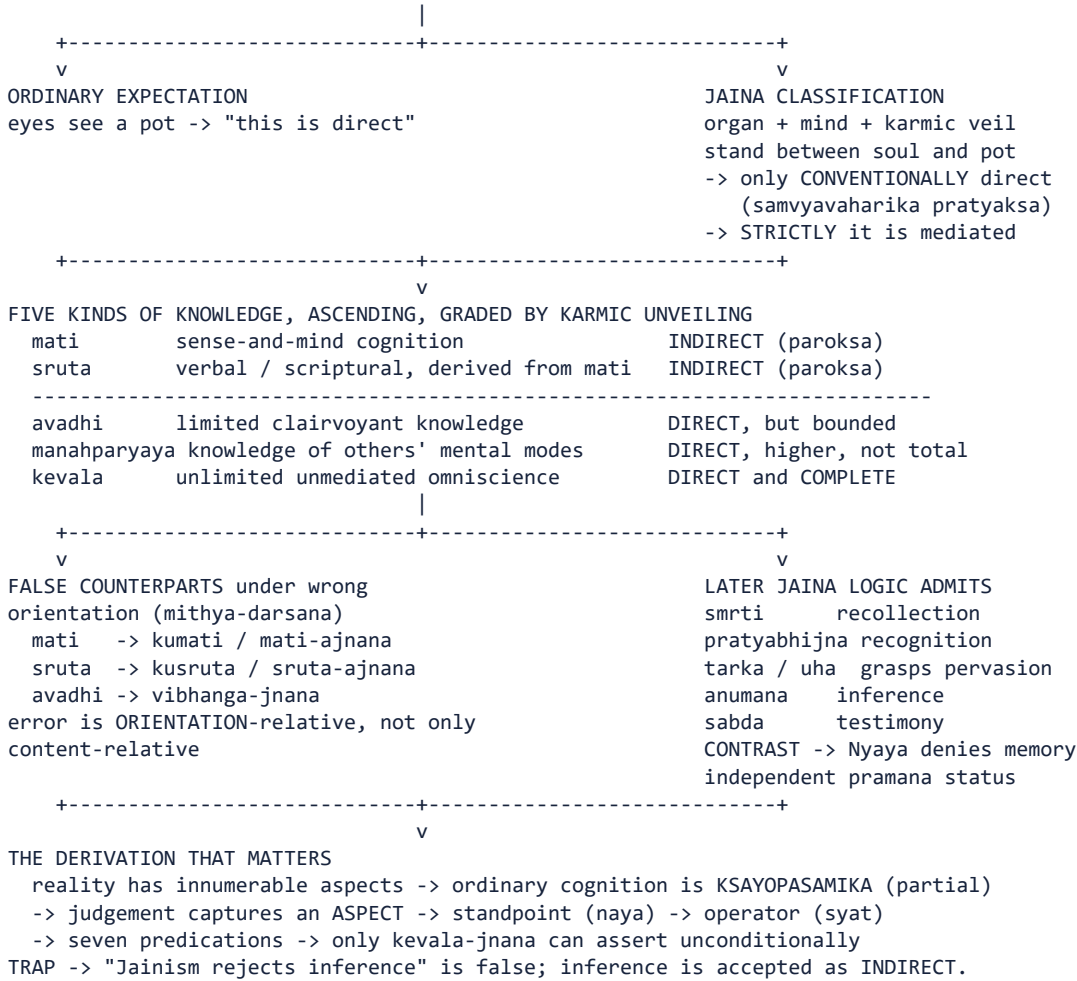
ANSWER LINE -> "Souls are innumerable and intrinsically luminous; bondage covers what
liberation uncovers."

TRAP -> intrinsic omniscience is CAPACITY, never empirical omniscience of the bound soul.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 5/12: Knowledge - the inversion and the five kinds

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 5/12: Knowledge – the inversion and the five kinds

JAINA TEST FOR DIRECTNESS: absence of a MIDDLEMAN, not vividness of appearance



ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 6/12: Standpoint theory - the seven standpoints

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 6/12: Standpoint theory – the seven standpoints

A STANDPOINT (naya) IS AN UNFINISHED TRUTH, NOT AN ERROR

it becomes error only when it denies the remaining aspects

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THE FUNNEL: LOOSEST AND MOST PRACTICAL -> STRICTEST AND MOST LITERAL

+-----+		
1 naigama	mixed practical / purposive; blends general and particular	
2 samgraha	generic; attends to shared class-character	
3 vyavahara	practical particular; ordinary dealings	
+-----+		
4 rjusutra	present-state; the thing as it now is	<- THE HINGE
+-----+		
5 sabda	verbal; attends to the expression used	
6 samabhirudha	etymological; distinct words, distinct sense	
7 evambhuta	function-in-act; "singer" applies only while singing occurs	
+-----+		

SUBSTANCE-
DIRECTED

MODE-
DIRECTED

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PERVERSION: standpoint + denial of the rest = NAYABHASA / DURNAYA

this is the technical form of one-sidedness (ekantavada)

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+-----+		
v	v	v
MOMENTARINESS	PERMANENCE-MONISM	EXTREME NOMINALISM
absolutises rjusutra	absolutises the substance-	absolutises the verbal
-> identity becomes	directed view	standpoints
a fiction	-> change becomes	-> the object dissolves
	appearance	into usage
+-----+		

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KUNDAKUNDA'S PAIR (Samayasara): niscaya-naya / vyavahara-naya

real standpoint -> the soul in its own intrinsic nature

conventional -> the soul as embodied, active and karmically conditioned

NOT Advaita's two levels: BOTH describe ONE real soul, and NOTHING is sublated

TRAP -> seven standpoints are NOT the seven predications; perspectives vs propositions.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 7/12: Conditional predication and the sevenfold predication

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 7/12: Conditional predication and the sevenfold predication

THE OPERATOR syat = "in a certain respect"

a DEFINITE assertion with its condition stated

NOT "perhaps", NOT probability, NOT doubt, NOT scepticism

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WHY EXACTLY SEVEN? three primitives, taken singly, in pairs, and all together

singly : asti · nasti · avaktavya = 3

in pairs : asti+nasti · asti+avaktavya · nasti+avaktavya = 3

jointly : asti+nasti+avaktavya = 1

TOTAL = 7

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THE SEVEN, IN ORDER

1 syad asti in some respect, it IS

2 syan nasti in some respect, it IS NOT

3 syad asti ca nasti ca successively, it is AND is not

4 syad avaktavyam in some respect, it is INEXPRESSIBLE

5 syad asti ca avaktavyam it is, and is inexpressible

6 syan nasti ca avaktavyam it is not, and is inexpressible

7 syad asti ca nasti ca avaktavyam it is, is not, and is inexpressible

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THE FOUR INDICES THAT BLOCK CONTRADICTION

dravya substance -> the jar IS clay, IS NOT gold

ksetra place -> IS on this table, IS NOT in that room

kala time -> IS now, WAS NOT yesterday

bhava mode -> IS jar-shaped, IS NOT lump-shaped

existence asserted in OWN-FORM (svarupa) · non-existence in OTHER-FORM (pararupa)

contradiction needs SAME respect, SAME time, SAME sense -> syat guarantees it never holds

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INEXPRESSIBILITY (avaktavya) = failure of ONE unqualified SIMULTANEOUS utterance

NOT mystical silence · NOT a third truth-value · NOT suspension of judgement

BLIND MEN AND THE ELEPHANT -> pedagogical only; one sentence, then return to the indices

ANSWER LINE -> "syat is an index, not a hedge: the seven forms record conditions of truth rather than degrees of doubt."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 8/12: Evaluating non-absolutism - three distinct challenges

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 8/12: Evaluating non-absolutism – three distinct challenges

CHALLENGE A: SELF-REFUTATION OR TRIVIALITY

if qualified -> weak; if unqualified -> inconsistent; if merely "views differ" -> thin

JAINA REPLY -> walk through the FIRST horn: the thesis IS asserted syat

reflexive qualification is OBEDIENCE, not exemption

aspect-conditioned truth is NOT equal truth for all opinions

[ANALYSIS] the triviality charge is answered only by SHOWING the work the doctrine

does: holding permanence and change together, and diagnosing rivals as absolutised nayas

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CHALLENGE B: "RELATIVISM NEEDS ABSOLUTISM" (2022, Q6(b), 15 marks)

critic -> universal scope looks absolute, so the doctrine leans on what it attacks

reply 1 -> it denies ONE-SIDED EXCLUSIVISM by finite knowers, not comprehensiveness

reply 2 -> ordinary cognition is ksayopasamika; kevala-jnana is the INTERNAL complete case

reply 3 -> "relativism" mislabels it: relativism relativises TRUTH, non-absolutism

relativises EXCLUSIVE CLAIMS

[ANALYSIS] the charge equivocates on "absolute"; once separated, the contradiction goes

[RESIDUE] the unconditioned is RELOCATED to omniscience, not abolished -> say so

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CHALLENGE C: "PLURALISTIC AND REALISTIC?" (2025, Q7(c), 15 marks)

PLURALISTIC -> six substances · innumerable souls · many siddhas · no monistic reduction

REALISTIC -> substances, qualities and modes objectively real · world not illusion

aspects are IN the object, not projected onto it

QUALIFIER -> judgement is standpoint-indexed -> QUALIFIED REALISM

KEY LINE -> qualification of KNOWLEDGE does not entail unreality of the OBJECT

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GRADED VERDICT TO CLOSE ANY CRITICAL ANSWER

STRONG permanence-and-change; disciplined ontology-to-language sequence;

causally serious ethics; derived non-violence

WEAK soul-matter interaction; unverifiable higher knowledges; heavy taxonomy;

possible dilution of assertoric force

CONTESTED sectarian treatment of time; legal status of sallekhana; dating of thinkers.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 9/12: Bondage - the complete mechanism

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 9/12: Bondage – the complete mechanism

FIVE CAUSES OF BONDAGE

mithyatva	wrong vision	-> misapprehends soul, reality and path
avirati	non-restraint	-> leaves conduct exposed
pramada	carelessness	-> weakens vigilance even where doctrine is known
kasaya	passions	-> anger, pride, deceit, greed: DEPTH and DURATION
yoga	activity	-> body, speech, mind: the CHANNEL of influx

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bhava-karma (the soul's own passionate modification) = PSYCHIC BONDAGE (bhavabandha)

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dravya-karma (subtle material particles actually adhering) = MATERIAL BONDAGE (dravyabandha)

WHY BOTH ARE NEEDED -> keep only the first and karma becomes a metaphor;
keep only the second and intention becomes irrelevant to moral consequence

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FOUR PARAMETERS OF ADHESION – THE DIVISION OF LABOUR THAT IS ALWAYS EXAMINED

prakrti	TYPE of karma bound	<- ACTIVITY (yoga)
pradesa	QUANTITY of matter bound	<- ACTIVITY (yoga)
sthiti	DURATION of bondage	<- PASSION (kasaya)
anubhaga	INTENSITY of fruition	<- PASSION (kasaya)

CONSEQUENCE -> iryapathika bandha (momentary, passion-free activity)
samarayika bandha (durable, passion-coloured activity)
dry cloth gathers no dust; the oiled cloth holds it

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EIGHT KARMA-TYPES

GHATIYA (destructive)		AGHATIYA (non-destructive)	
jnanavaraniya	obscures knowledge	vedaniya	pleasure and pain
darsanavaraniya	obscures perception	nama	body and embodiment
mohaniya	obscures right vision	gotra	status conditions
	AND right conduct	ayus	lifespan
	-> WORST; divided into		
	darsana- and caritra-		
antaraya	obstructs power		

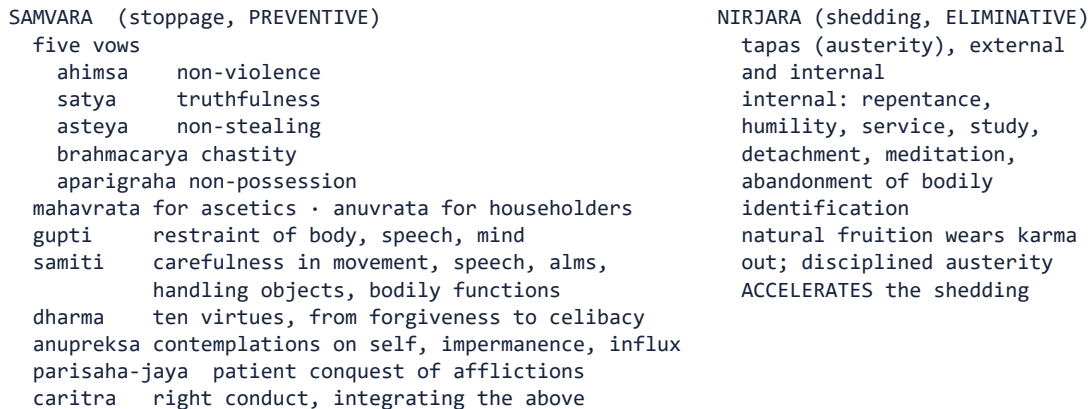
-> destroying the GHATIYA group yields OMNISCIENCE while still embodied (stage 13)

CONTRAST -> Nyaya adrsta • Mimamsa apurva • Samkhya samskara • Buddhist vasana
none of these is MATTER adhering to the self

TRAP -> never assign duration to activity or quantity to passion.

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 10/12: The path – stop the influx, then shed the deposit
THE ROOM WITH AN OPEN DOOR AND A DUSTY FLOOR
sweeping while the door stands open is endless work -> the path needs TWO operations

sweeping while the door stands open is endless work -> the path needs TWO operations



asrava -> bandha -> samvara -> nirjara -> moksa

asrava -> bandha -> samvara -> nirjara -> moksa

NINE PADARTHAS : the seven PLUS punya (merit) and papa (demerit)

NINE PADARTHAS : the seven PLUS punya (merit) and papa (demerit)

samyag-darsana right vision • samyag-jnana right

samyag-darsana right vision • samyag-jnana right

LIBERATION BY SUBTRACTION -> cleaning a sooted lamp does not create the light

LIBERATION BY SUBTRACTION -> cleaning a sooted lamp does not create the light

that remains."

that remains."

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 11/12: The fourteen stages (gunasthana), omniscience and the siddha

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 11/12: The fourteen stages (gunasthana), omniscience and the siddha

14	ayoga-kevali	activity ceases; momentary final state	-> SIDDHA
13	sayoga-kevali	OMNISCIENT while still embodied and active	
	^	ghatiya karmas destroyed; aghatiya karmas still sustain body, status, lifespan	
12	ksina-moha	delusion DESTROYED	<- ksapaka-sreni, the ladder of annihilation
11	upasanta-moha	delusion only SUPPRESSED	<- upasama-sreni, and it NECESSARILY FALLS
10	suksma-samparaya	only subtle greed remains	
9	anivrtti-badara	advanced purification of gross passions	
8	apurva-karana	unprecedented purification begins; the two ladders diverge here	
7	apramatta-samyata	full restraint WITHOUT negligence	
6	pramatta-samyata	full restraint WITH negligence	
5	desavirata	partial restraint; lay vows	
4	avirata samyag-drsti	RIGHT VISION without restraint	<- THE DECISIVE BREAKTHROUGH
3	misra	mixed right and wrong orientation	
2	sasvadana	falling, with a lingering taste of right vision	
1	mithya-drsti	false vision	

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WHY THE TWO LADDERS MATTER PHILOSOPHICALLY

suppression and destruction look IDENTICAL from outside and have OPPOSITE futures
-> Jainism can explain spiritual RELAPSE without calling it a failure of insight
-> attainment is a karmic CONDITION, not an observable performance

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THE LIBERATED SOUL (siddha) – the exact 2018 demand

individuality RETAINED, numerically distinct; NO merger into a universal consciousness
knowledge infinite knowledge and perception fully manifest
body/activity NONE; disembodied and activity-free
return NONE; bondage is anadi (beginningless) yet TERMINABLE
location rises to the summit of the world (siddha-sila)
CONTRAST -> not Advaita merger into Brahman; not liberation without an enduring self

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SALLEKHANA / SANTHARA – voluntary passionless death

gradual · supervised · public · non-violent · undertaken when death is already unavoidable
free from desire for death, desire to live, attachment, recollection of pleasure, reward
if such motives enter -> aticara, a TRANSGRESSION of the vow
vs atma-ghata (suicide): sudden, passion-driven, violent, often concealed
[CONTESTED] do NOT assert case names, holdings, dates or statutory detail.

ASCII MASTER FLOW - PANEL 12/12: Objections, comparative map, PYQ rail and answer spine

ASCII MASTER FLOW – PANEL 12/12: Objections, comparative map, PYQ rail and answer spine

SIX NAMED CRITICS – SIX DIFFERENT JOINTS, SIX DIFFERENT REPLIES, SIX RESIDUES

Sankara	predication	-> four indices; syadvada asserted syat [RESIDUE] assertoric force may be diluted
Ramanuja	opposed real attributes	-> opposition holds between substance and mode [RESIDUE] requires granting aspect-realism
Dharmakirti	permanent-yet-changing soul, arthakriya	-> utpada-vyaya-dhrauvya: permanent as substance, changing as mode [RESIDUE] strong if substance/mode is denied
Nyaya	soul's expansion material karma	-> pradesas and the lamp simile; karma explains embodiment better than an invisible potency [RESIDUE] consciousness-matter contact unexplained
Samkhya/ Vedanta	omniscience plus beginningless obscuration	-> anadi but terminable by samvara and nirjara [RESIDUE] no account of why it was possible
Carvaka	nothing here is perceived	-> inference, testimony, systematic coherence [RESIDUE] external critique; never lead with it

v

COMPARATIVE MAP – USE ONE ROW, NEVER THE WHOLE TABLE

BUDDHISM no self · momentariness · non-material action-consequence · nirvana
ADVAITA one self · world mithya · avidya and superimposition · merger
NYAYA-VS many eternal selves · fresh production of the effect · later theism
SAMKHYA many changeless purusas · evolving prakrti · pre-existent effect
CARVAKA body-self · no action-consequence · no liberation · perception only
JAINA SIGNATURE -> the only position making permanence and change EQUALLY REAL in one thing, by indexing them to substance and mode

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PYQ RAIL 2018-2025 (nine owned, one routed)

2018 Q6(c) 15 bondage, bound vs liberated soul	2022 Q5(d) 10 karma and soteriology
2019 Q6(a) 20 reality reflected in judgements	2022 Q6(b) 15 relativism/absolutism
2020 Q5(a) 10 karma and liberation	2023 Q5(a) 10 sevenfold judgement
2020 Q7(c) 15 Carvaka vs Jaina reality [routed]	2024 Q6(c) 15 bhava-/dravyabandha
2021 Q7(c) 15 the sevenfold naya	2025 Q7(c) 15 pluralist and realist?

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ANSWER SPINE

OPEN define the real, then say the logic FOLLOWS from it
BODY ontology -> knowledge -> standpoint -> syat -> seven predications
bondage -> two forms -> four parameters -> stoppage and shedding -> stages
TEST one NAMED objection with its reply, and the residue stated honestly
CLOSE "realism without dogmatism" – qualified realism, ethically serious and logically subtle, yet metaphysically costly.